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Happening today

● **SC WILL** hear a plea by former minister and DMK leader V Senthil Balaji seeking anticipatory bail in a case pertaining to alleged irregularities in TASMAC.

● **DELHI HC** will hear an appeal by Umar Khalid challenging the trial court's July 4 decision to dismiss his bail application.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



Shouldn't there be show of fairness: SC on PM panel choosing CEC

Office of PM has sanctity attached to it, counters Centre

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, July 30

QUESTIONING THE appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs) by a three-member committee comprising the Prime Minister, a Union Minister and the Leader of Opposition, the Supreme Court on Thursday asked "should there be no show of fairness" in the procedure.

The bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and S C Sharma was hearing petitions challenging the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, which provides for their selection by the three-member panel.

Defending the law, the Centre, represented by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, said it would be wrong to assume that the PM and the minister would "not act in the interest of democracy" because they have a "numerical majority" in the selection procedure.

Mehta submitted that the office of the PM has a "sanctity attached" to it and doubting the decision of the selection committee would undermine the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE WORLD P 16

DRONE STRIKE NEAR SUEZ RAISES MORE SECURITY THREATS

● **CM HIMANTA** SEEKS CENTRAL RELIEF AND REHABILITATION PACKAGE

'Not even our grandfathers saw this': Upper Assam reels as floods wash away villages

Swati Mishra & Rajat Sain
Nepalikhuti (Sivasagar), July 30

"THE 19TH is cursed for Assam," sighs cab driver Sumo on the way from Dibrugarh to Sivasagar. "Zubeen Da (singer Zubeen Garg) left us on the 19th... and then, on the 19th, came this flood that swept everything away."

In Lower Assam, flooding is practically a season. It arrives every year, sometimes forgiving, sometimes merciless. But

DAY AFTER LOK SABHA, RAJYA SABHA PASSES BILL BY VOICE VOTE AS OPPOSITION WALKS OUT

House clears anti-paper leak Bill, PM says nobody will be spared

Kharge raises police action on protesters: 'If Shah cannot answer, he should resign'



Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge in Rajya Sabha, Thursday.

Divya A, Nikhil Ghaneekar, Damini Nath & Jatini Anand
New Delhi, July 30

A DAY after it was cleared by the Lok Sabha, the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, which provides for stricter punishment for paper leaks, was discussed and passed by the Rajya Sabha through voice vote on Thursday.

Hours later, Prime Minister Narendra Modi posted a video on Instagram in which he assured that "any paper mafia, paper leak gang, gang which tries to play with the future of the youth of the country would not be spared".

Underlining that his government had delivered on its promise to bring a tough law, he said: "We are taking step after

step towards creating a reliable education system, whether it is the creation of a task force, fast-track courts, taking suggestions from states... A nationwide reform in education sector has become compulsory... work in this direction will continue."

Earlier, before Union Minister Jitendra Singh could respond to the debate on the Bill in the Rajya Sabha, INDIA bloc MPs walked out, demanding that Home Minister Amit Shah make a statement on the police action against protesting students last week. Singh said it was unfortunate that the MPs who had spoken most vociferously during the debate had walked out.

Referring to the Opposition members raising the issue of police action on students,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Police rules allow pellet gun use, can look at specific cases, says SC

CJI bench to Govt: Preserve ammunition log of RAF personnel on Delhi protest duty

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, July 30

STATING THAT the existing police regulations allow the use of pellet guns in exceptional circumstances for crowd control, the Supreme Court on Thursday said they can only be banned if these rules are found to be unconstitutional. The

court, however, said it was open to examining specific allegations of misuse on a case-by-case basis.

The bench, led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, was hearing petitions — filed by Yashovardhan Azad, former Intelligence Bureau Special Director and Central Information Commissioner, and two per-

sons who allegedly sustained pellet gun injuries during the recent student protests in the Capital — seeking a ban on the use of pellet guns when dealing with civilian crowds.

The bench, which included Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, also directed the Centre to preserve the ammunition log of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) personnel deployed during the protest march to Parliament on July 20. The court issued notices to

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

POLITICS PAGE 6



PARLIAMENT CLEARS BILL MAKING INSULT TO VANDHE MATARAM A PUNISHABLE OFFENCE

WHY CENTRE IS HOLDING BACK KEY BILLS AS LOGJAM IN HOUSE CONTINUES

Delhi govt: No action on NEET protesters, except those with criminal past

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 30

AFTER FOUR BJP-ruled states — Maharashtra, West Bengal, Assam and Bihar — began withdrawing cases against NEET-UG protesters following the Cockroach Janta Party's threat of a fresh stir, Delhi followed suit on Thursday.

In an order issued by the Home Department, the govern-

ment approved the withdrawal of 13 FIRs registered in connection with the CJP-led protests, stating that no action will be taken against those who participated. However, this won't include those with criminal antecedents.

"As of 6 pm on 29.07.2026, a total of 13 cases were registered by Delhi Police in connection with the protests relating to the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

From govt to pvt: In 3 yrs, 1.54 lakh J&K Bank accounts were not linked to PAN

Data dump leads Income Tax sleuths to 'systemic failure'; bank says compliance report submitted to RBI

Ritu Sarin
New Delhi, July 30

AN INCOME Tax probe has found that 1.54 lakh accounts were opened with J&K Bank between 2021 and 2024 without any PAN details linked to them. And, deposits in such accounts with transactions touching Rs 15 lakh or more in a financial year totalled Rs 4.88 lakh crore, records investigated by *The Indian Express* show.

So much so that in its final report submitted late last year, the I-T Department said the probe's findings point to a "systemic failure" and a "significant red flag", warning that the unlinked accounts, with their substantial transaction volumes, present "a staggering potential avenue for tax evasion".

Most of the accounts under the I-T scanner were Savings Bank accounts, opened merely by filling Form 60, a "declaration form" used by people without PAN cards. The IT probe found that these non-PAN-linked accounts included:

● 32,498 Government-linked

● Crunching numbers

₹4.88 lakh crore

Deposits in accounts not linked to PAN with transactions of Rs 15 lakh+ in a financial year

Accounts not linked to PAN

Govt-associated Private

32,498 1.25 lakh

10,464: Private accounts with credits of ₹50 lakh or more in a financial year

E. EXPLAINED

Under watch

The J&K Bank accounts not linked to PAN form less than 1 per cent of the bank's over-2 crore accounts base. But the range of such accounts, from corporate entities to those linked to government schemes, has brought them under the tax scanner.

Indian hockey ditches iconic blue for saffron; not consulted: 5 players, official

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 30

SINCE 1928, the Indian hockey team has played in different shades of blue or white almost every time at a major tournament. That will change next month.

When Harmanpreet Singh and Salima Tete lead the men's and women's teams for the World Cup, starting August 15 in Belgium and the Netherlands, the players will swap the iconic blue jersey that has defined the national side for a saffron-coloured one.

Hockey India said the "primary consideration was technical" since the blue uniform



Indian men's hockey team will be seen in their new jersey at the World Cup in the Netherlands and Belgium next month. @THEHOCKEYINDIA

fron-coloured one.

Hockey India said the "primary consideration was technical" since the blue uniform

blended with the blue turf and made it difficult for a player to spot a teammate easily.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Fudged records to political meddling: CAG red-flags cyclone relief under TMC

Raises questions over classification of 'damaged houses', grants to those rejected

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 30

THE USE of identical photographs for multiple claims, incorrect classification of damaged houses, duplicate transactions worth Rs 18.07 crore, and grants sanctioned on the recommendations of local political leaders.

These are some of the irregularities that the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has flagged in its report on relief distribution and restoration work in West Bengal following Cyclone Amphan in 2020.

The CAG has noted that the Trinamool Congress (TMC) government's estimates of damage were "not supported

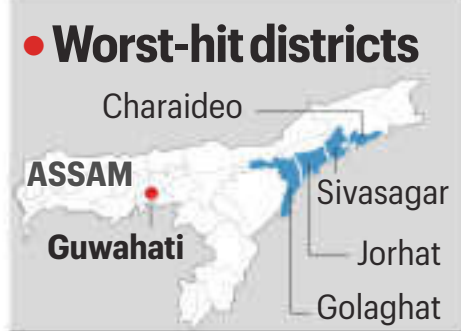
by proper evidence".

The auditor analysed 31,457 photographs and found that in 3,126 cases identical photographs were uploaded against the names of multiple beneficiaries. This suggested that undue house-building grants might have been extended, though the exact amount could not be quantified because the photographs were not linked to beneficiary forms, the CAG said. Using a data analytics tool to parse through the records of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



In Nepalikhuti village in Assam's Sivasagar district. RAJAT SAIN



Upper Assam doesn't know that rhythm. So, when heavy rains in the Naga Hills broke over the region on July 19, it caught everyone completely off guard.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PARLE FROM TOMORROW, **LOL** WITH SWEET AND SALTY **KRACKJACK JOKES.**

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9 DEAD IN MARCH 18 BLAZE

Bronto Skylift failed, crew not trained — magisterial inquiry report on Palam fire

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 30

BRONTO SKYLIFT (hydraulic crane) of the Delhi Fire Services (DFS) failed during the rescue operation after its boom became entangled in overhead cables and banners, no backup high-reach rescue equipment was available and firefighters had to rely on a manual ladder that could not reach the third floor balcony – these are the major findings of a magisterial inquiry into the March 18 fire in a four-story building in Palam that killed nine people, including three children, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The report was submitted by District Magistrate (South West) Mekala Chaitanya Prasad to the Home department last month. The file is now proposed to be placed before the Lieutenant Governor for consideration, officials said.

“The Bronto Skylift (BS-III) failed at the scene – most likely due to cables/wires/banners entangled in its boom and no effective second line of defence (an alternative tall ladder) was immediately available... a manual ladder could not reach the third-floor balcony,” the report said.

The inquiry also found that the crew assigned to operate the skylift had never received formal training from the authorised dealer since the machine was procured in 2006. “They learned informally from predecessors,” the report said.

It added that maintenance logs of the skylift shows no prior faults were reported despite it being used in operations at IGI Airport, Tilak Nagar and Palam during incidents of fire.

Further, the report highlighted several lapses by the MCD and other agencies,



At the site of the blaze in Palam. FILE

which resulted in the tragedy. It blamed the MCD for allowing commercial activity on the building’s first floor though the licence permitted commercial use only in the basement and ground floor.

As per the report, the fire probably originated from an MCB box located on the ground and first floor stairs, a point where around six electrical connections were concentrated. It added that the fire “spread rapidly, aggravated by combustible cosmetic stock”.

While a short circuit is considered the probable cause of the fire, the report said this cannot be confirmed until the forensic report is received because the electrical installation was extensively damaged.

The report recommended disciplinary action against MCD licensing inspector Narendra Dabas for failing to check violation of license conditions.

“Dabas, who was working under the supervision of assistant commissioner Najafgarh Zone also failed in his duty to remove aerial banners on roads,” it added.

According to the report, firefighters had to manually clear

low-hanging cables and banners with the help of local residents before positioning the Bronto Skylift.

It also flagged that the assistant electrical inspector, who led the inspection, had received no technical training since he joined the Fire department in 2012. “...admitted he had never been able to determine the cause of fire in any of 8-9 prior inspections – a serious capability gap in a statutory technical role,” the report highlighted.

It recommended that a technical expert committee be set up to investigate the Bronto Skylift’s failure, ensure deployment of backup high-rise rescue equipment at major fires and filling up of 853 vacant posts in the Fire department on priority.

Highlighting that the fire could not be controlled due to “unauthorised cabling” in the area, the report recommended: “Bring all local cable/Internet service providers under a regulatory framework... Make provider name-marking on cables compulsory for identification of violators, consider road width as a criterion (while deciding on installing) overhead (or) underground cabling...”

Delhi Police chief sets priorities for force; stresses result-oriented policing, timely complaint disposal

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 30

NEWLY APPOINTED Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar has asked his colleagues to maintain the highest standards of integrity, professionalism and ethical conduct, irrespective of their ranks.

At an interaction with senior officers on July 18, Kumar underlined a set of policing priorities for various districts and units. He stressed visible policing, timely complaint disposal, integrity in administration and better coordination among agencies.

The meeting was attended by special commissioners, joint

commissioners, additional commissioners, and deputy commissioners.

“He (CP Kumar) told officers that the Delhi Police is counted among the finest police forces in the country, a standing that is tested every day under intense scrutiny and in an increasingly complex operating environment. But its reputation and image have to be restored through credible, visible and result-oriented policing on the ground,” a senior police officer, who attended the meeting, said.

One of the key directions issued at the meeting was to make basic policing a priority for every officer.



Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar FILE

On integrity and institutional accountability, Kumar underlined a zero-tolerance approach towards corruption, unethical practices and undesirable conduct.

Kumar clearly conveyed

that “strict action will be taken against erring officials”, adding that supervisory officers should maintain continuous oversight over subordinate staff.

“He asked [officers] to ensure transparency, fairness and objectivity in transfers and postings, and administrative decisions. There will not be any instance, under any circumstances, of transfers/postings against illegal gratification,” the officer added.

Officers were also directed to monitor platforms for feedback, intelligence and ground-level sentiment, and use official handles for public communication and grievance redressal. Kumar cautioned that organ-

isational goals should guide the use of social media and that it should not be used for “self-promotion”.

“He said in the meeting that a manpower audit is also to be conducted in every unit to assess optimal utilisation of available strength, followed by rationalisation of deployment,” the officer said.

On grievance redressal, Kumar directed that an open-door policy be followed by all officers, with complainants given proper access to senior officials. “Complaints must be disposed of within defined timelines, and feedback on action taken should be shared with complainants,” the officer said.

CJP stir: Noida woman booked for ‘abusive’ remarks against PM

Drishti Jain
New Delhi, July 30

THE NOIDA Police has lodged a zero FIR against a woman for allegedly making “objectionable remarks” against Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Cockroach Janta Party’s (CJP) protest at Jantar Mantar on July 23, officers said on Thursday. The complaint was filed by Smriti Singh, a resident of Ghaziabad on Wednesday at the Expressway Police station against Ruchika Singh, a resident of Noida, an officer said.

In the complaint, Smriti alleged that Ruchika used abusive and objectionable language against Modi. The complaint further alleged that the remarks did not only “undermine the dignity of the constitutional office”, “but also deliberately intended to spread hatred and disrupt public peace.”

The police have registered a case under sections 352 (intentional insult to provoke breach of peace), 353(1) (statements conducing to public mischief) and 356(1) (defamation) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the officer added.

A zero FIR means that a complaint can be filed at any police station irrespective of the place of alleged crime or where the incident took place, post which it is transferred to the police station of the concerned jurisdiction.

According to officers, the FIR has been transferred to the Parliament Street Police station. “The accused is a resident of Faridabad, and used to stay in Noida. We have transferred the FIR to the concerned jurisdiction where further investigation will take place,” an officer added.

This comes amid the Delhi Police also filing an FIR over “objectionable and defamatory” social media posts targeting the PM during protests at Jantar Mantar and asking social media platforms to take down such content.

A case under charges of criminal intimidation, public mischief, and defamation has been lodged at the Special Cell IFSO (Intelligence Fusion and Strategic Operations) unit in connection with the matter, *The Indian Express* had reported.

Govt to introduce Land Records Bill, issue smart cards to all properties

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 30

TO CREATE a unified database of its own, the Delhi government is set to introduce a Delhi Land Records Bill 2026, under which it will conduct a survey of all residential and commercial properties in both rural and urban areas and digitise the records. The digitised land records will be linked to the government’s Family Card initiative, which is aimed at creating a unified database of Delhi’s households, to streamline the distribution of welfare schemes, healthcare benefits and other government services.

Speaking about the survey, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, “The entire Delhi will be surveyed and mapped using aerial and drone surveys.”

Gupta said that every household in the city will be issued a unique property card and a family Aadhaar card, and if any family sells their property, the property card will be transferred to the new owner.

Mentioning that the Delhi government had already prepared smart property cards for 30 rural villages under the SVA-MITVA scheme, Gupta said that the government, building



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. X/@CMDELHI

on this experience, will now undertake a comprehensive survey of land and properties across the NCT.

“Currently, the survey work has been started on a pilot basis in rural areas. Information will be gathered about land belonging to farmers and eliminate disputes ... It is, in a way, like an Aadhaar card for land,” the CM said.

“Every property in Delhi will now get a secure and authentic digital identity. This will make property records across the Capital more transparent, well-organised and technologically secure. The government will also convene a special session of the Delhi Legislative Assembly in connection with the Bill,” Gupta added.

“A digital record will be cre-

ated for every floor of every building, ensuring that no property in the Capital remains outside the scope of the exercise... For decades, the absence of a systematic land records system has caused difficulties in proving ownership, property transactions, inheritance, securing loans, building plan approvals and resolving disputes pending before courts. Authenticated digital property records will eliminate ambiguity, improve transparency and significantly reduce land-related disputes,” she said.

The CM said that the aim is also to lay a strong foundation for Delhi’s future digital governance framework. She further said that the Delhi Land Records Bill is currently in the approval stage after an extensive review by the Group of Ministers.

The family card, to be provided to every household in Delhi, will bear details of members, their caste, occupation, mention if they are availing any benefits under any welfare scheme, vaccination records and other essential information. Officials said that this can be used as a proof by people seeking benefits under various social welfare schemes of the Delhi government.



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New Delhi

Likely before fast-track court: Paper leak cases impacted after judge moved out at key stages

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 30

THE FAST-TRACK court of Special Judge Anu Grover Baliga will take up the CBI's 20,000-page chargesheet in the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case on Monday.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the setting up of fast-track courts to ensure swift and stringent punishment for exam fraud in the midst of the students' protest demanding accountability for the NEET leak.

Besides the NEET case, Judge Baliga's court is also likely to take up other exam fraud cases.

Here are three cases which had come before Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (ACJM) Neetu Nagar of Rouse Avenue Courts before the judge was deputed to the National Green Tribunal last month.

2003 CAT paper leak

STATUS: Still at the stage of

"arguments on charge" before a Rouse Avenue Magistrate Court. This is the stage before the framing of charges. Trials start after charges are framed.

AFFECTED CANDIDATES: More than 1.25 lakh candidates had applied for the Common Admission Test scheduled for November 23, 2003. The test was cancelled, and held in February 2004.

WHAT HAPPENED: On November 22, a day before the exam, the Delhi Police was tipped off that the paper had been leaked. The CBI, which took over the probe, zeroed in on a hotel in Mahipalpur in south-west Delhi, where it seized various sections of the alleged question paper from individuals.

Investigators recorded the statements of candidates who claimed that Rs 2 lakh to Rs 4 lakh had been demanded from them for the "leaked paper".

The CBI submitted the chargesheet in 2004.

PROGRESS OF CASE: From May 2019, when the case

was transferred to the Rouse Avenue Court, to May 2026, there were nine hearings every year on average. The Covid-19 pandemic contributed to the delay.

On June 3 this year, ACJM Nagar reserved her order on the charges due to the "heavy cause list" and because "no time was left". The ACJM said the order would be passed on June 26. However, on June 22, she was deputed to the NGT's Principal Bench in New Delhi, where she is currently Deputy Registrar. The case is now before a 'link' judge, who is also a Magistrate at the Rouse Avenue Court.

2023 AIIMS NORCET-4 leak

STATUS: Arguments on charge were heard for about a year, but not completed. They will now be heard afresh by the fast-track court.

AFFECTED CANDIDATES: Around 90,000.

WHAT HAPPENED: The exam to recruit nurses in AIIMS and four other hospitals in



The recent protest at Jantar Mantar over 2026 NEET paper leak. FILE

Delhi was held on June 3, 2023. Two days later, a leak was alleged on social media. Screenshots, allegedly of a candidate's console, were posted. On June 6, the Associate Dean (Exams), AIIMS, filed a complaint against one Ritu, and Gian Jyoti Institute of Management and Technology, Phase-II, Mohali. The CBI filed an FIR alleging that a computer at the institute was used by or on behalf of Ritu for the "purpose of cheating".

The CBI alleged a criminal conspiracy to "rig the examination process by using unfair Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

means in favour of accused candidates against illegal monetary consideration". It claimed that the accused had informed others that they "would get the answers before 30 minutes of completion of the examination".

PROGRESS OF CASE: On August 28, 2023, Magistrate Deepak Kumar 2 took cognisance of the chargesheet. Later, the case came to ACJM Nagar, who had replaced Kumar.

ACJM Nagar was hearing arguments on charge when she was deputed to the NGT last month. She last heard argu-

ments on June 9.

2024 UGC NET paper leak

STATUS: CBI has filed a closure report, which the court has refused to accept.

AFFECTED CANDIDATES: The alleged leak impacted more than 9 lakh candidates who appeared for the exam in 317 cities.

WHAT HAPPENED: The eligibility exam for entry-level teaching jobs in colleges and admission to PhD courses was held on June 18, 2024. On June 19, the Education Ministry cancelled the exam after "inputs from National Cyber Crime Threat Analytics Unit of Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)...prima facie indicate[d] that the integrity of the...examination may have been compromised".

In July, the CBI found that the alleged evidence on which the Education Ministry had acted was "doctored". This alleged "evidence" was a pur-

ported screenshot of the paper that was circulated on Telegram around 2 pm on the day of the exam, with messages and comments suggesting the paper had been leaked before the first session of the exam.

PROGRESS OF CASE: The CBI filed a closure report in January 2025, saying it had found no evidence of a leak. It said that forensic experts had established that the purported screenshot was created by a school student using a mobile phone application. After the report was filed, 13 hearings were held. On May 15, 2026, ACJM Nagar asked CBI to explain why it had filed a closure report even though its own findings showed that a suspect had collected money from candidates by "luring them with leaked question papers".

The explanation furnished by the investigating officer is yet to be considered by the court. After ACJM Nagar was deputed to NGT, the case was heard once by a link judge. The next date of hearing is August 6.

Umar Khalid moves HC for third time seeking bail

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 30

FOR THE third time, activist Umar Khalid has moved the Delhi High Court, seeking bail in the larger conspiracy case of Northeast Delhi riots in 2020. He has been booked under the stringent Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Khalid's appeal challenging the trial court's July 4 decision to dismiss his bail application is listed for hearing before a bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Vikas Mahajan on Friday.

The HC had earlier rejected his bail plea twice – in October 2022 and September 2025. Both times, the Supreme Court had upheld the HC order.

Khalid, arrested in September 2020, was booked under UAPA for being one of the "masterminds" of the riots that had left 53 people dead and more than 700 injured. Besides him, activist Sharjeel Imam, among others, was also booked in the case.

The SC, in its order on January 5, had refused bail to Khalid and Imam, but granted bail to five other co-accused while establishing the "hierarchy of participation". In this hierarchy, Khalid and Imam were classified to be on a "higher footing" compared to the five others who were granted bail by the SC.

The trial court, while rejecting Khalid's and Imam's bail pleas on July 4 had observed that it "has no option but to follow" the January 5 judgment of the Supreme Court, whereby the petitions of both the applicants were dismissed. The SC had also observed no change in their circumstances to allow a fresh plea for bail, the trial court had added.

Khalid, a former JNU student leader, has been booked for offences under the IPC, Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, Arms Act and UAPA.

Govt plans random, door-to-door visits to verify women eligible for Lakshmi Yojana

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 30

THE DELHI government is planning to conduct door-to-door, random verification of women found eligible for the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, under which beneficiaries will receive a monthly financial assistance of Rs 2,500, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

As part of the verification process, the government will check whether applicants meet the scheme's eligibility conditions – whether they have more than three living children, if they are residents of Delhi and registered voters of the city, if they pay income tax, are they in the 21-60 years age group, whether their family's income is up to Rs 2.5 lakh per annum and if they receive any other financial aid from the Centre or the state, among others.

The three-child cap is a first-of-its-kind exclusion criteria introduced by the Delhi government for its social welfare schemes.

"The application process is very simple and easy. People can submit their information from anywhere. Verification is necessary to ensure only eligible beneficiaries receive the assistance," a senior government functionary said.

The functionary added that the Women and Child Development (WCD) department might engage a third-party agency to conduct the random checks. "The objective is to ensure that the scheme reaches the needy and deserving beneficiaries while maintaining transparency in the implementation process."

Asked about the three-child cap, the senior functionary said, "Some Opposition parties are trying to give it (three-child

cap) a religious angle but they are wrong. Be it a Hindu or Muslim, it is one's choice on how many children they want to have..."

Besides, this might be a step towards better family planning and population control, the functionary said. "People these days are educated and follow family planning. But in many lower middle class families, women are still pressured to have four-five children until they have a boy..."

"For family planning and population control, you have to take steps somewhere... The government has come up with a proper financial plan with two bifurcations – the woman can either invest the Rs 2,500 and get a lumpsum amount with interest after three years or she can invest Rs 1,500 and spend the rest through a digital card," the functionary said.

"This gives her the right to decide where she wants to spend her money... In many families, husbands pressure them... take their money to buy alcohol and tobacco... We want our mothers and sisters to independently use their money," the senior functionary added.

According to officials, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who holds the WCD portfolio, has specially said that the scheme should empower women and also that their health is a priority.

The scheme, approved by the Cabinet on Tuesday, was one of the major poll promises made by the BJP in the run-up to the Assembly elections in 2025.

A portal for registration under the scheme will be launched on August 1 and the disbursement of first instalment will begin from Raksha Bandhan, said officials.



ABHINAV SAHA

For the Kanwariyas

Tents being built for Kanwariyas along Delhi-Meerut Expressway as Thursday marked the beginning of Sawan month and the Kanwar Yatra.

Love, lies and fake gold: An extramarital affair that led to a Rs 3-crore loan fraud

Pragnesh
New Delhi, July 30

IT BEGAN with a phone call received from a wrong number.

Around 2015, Pankaj Kumar, a gold appraiser at non-banking financial company (NBFC) Sai Corporation in Delhi, received a call from a woman who had dialled the wrong number. The two stayed in touch and eventually began an affair. Pankaj, however, was already married with two children.

He soon found out that it was difficult to support both his family and the woman on his salary. The result: he went on to siphon money from his company, orchestrating a gold loan fraud worth more than Rs 3 crore over six years. During this time, he transferred around Rs 90 lakh to bank accounts linked to the woman in multiple transactions.

According to the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of the Delhi Police, between 2019 and 2025, Pankaj and his colleague in Sai Corporation, S P Bansal, created 683 fake gold loan accounts



Accused Pankaj Kumar

using forged KYC documents and artificial jewellery. Loans worth over Rs 3 crore were allegedly taken in the names of 28 people, many of them former customers of the company.

Pankaj was arrested on July 7. Bansal is out on bail.

The alleged fraud came to light during an internal audit at Sai Corporation in August 2025.

Pankaj had worked as a gold appraiser with the company for over a decade. His job was to verify the jewellery to be used as collateral by checking its hallmark and weight before approving loans and storing the ornaments in the company's lockers. "One of the company's di-

rectors, Dr R K Tandon, said that there were discrepancies in the accounts Pankaj was handling. Following this, he was transferred to another branch, but refused to join work. The company then ordered an audit," said an officer.

During the audit, when Pankaj was questioned about gold worth nearly Rs 14 lakh that was missing from the company's lockers but found mention in the official records, he allegedly lost it. "He allegedly shouted and stormed out of the office. He never came back," the officer said.

"Pankaj facilitated the creation of fake gold loan accounts by appraising fake and artificial gold ornaments as genuine and using forged KYC documents and fake customer identities," said Special Commissioner of Police (EOW) Nupur Prasad.

The company got an FIR lodged. When an EOW team led by DCP Amit Verma started going through company records, they found that the story began around 2015 when he received the call from a wrong

number. "The woman was from Delhi. The two started talking and entered into a relationship," said the officer. At that time, Pankaj, now in his 40s, lived with his wife and two children in Rohini's Budh Vihar.

"We traced the money that Pankaj had siphoned from the bank. One of the transactions was of Rs 16 lakh, which was credited to the woman's account in 2019," said the officer.

According to the police, between 2019 and 2025, Pankaj transferred over Rs 90 lakh to multiple accounts linked to the woman. "He said there was no other way for him to take care of her and his family at the same time," the officer said.

When police tracked people whose identities were used to secure the fraudulent loans, they found that many were former customers of Sai Corporation. "Two of them were Suresh, an MCD worker, who lives in Rajouri Garden, and his wife. He used their details to create two accounts," said the officer.

Pankaj and Bansal were eventually arrested.

• Skywatch



Forecast: July 31, 2026

Generally cloudy sky, possibility of very light rain

MAX: 34-36

1.6°C below normal

MIN: 25-27

0.1°C below normal

• **Sunrise:** 5:43 AM (August 1)

• **Sunset:** 7:13 PM (July 31)

• **Moonrise:** 8:22 PM (July 31)

• **Moonset:** 7:59 AM (August 1)

• AQI Tracker



Alipur

Moderate

AQI: 151



Anand Vihar

Moderate

AQI: 145



Najafgarh

Satisfactory

AQI: 92



JNU

Satisfactory

AQI: 67

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

MCD signs deal with OIL to set up 2 compressed biogas plants

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, July 30

TO CONVERT 800 tonnes per day (TPD) of wet waste into biogas and organic fertilisers, the Municipal Corporation Delhi (MCD) and the Oil India Limited (OIL) on Thursday signed an MoU in the presence of the Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Mayor Praveesh Wahi for the establishment of two bio-methanation based compressed biogas (CBG) plants, officials said.

According to an official statement, two Bio-CBG plants with a combined processing capacity of 800 TPD will be established in the first phase. A 500-TPD plant will be developed on 10 acres of land at Tehkhand, while a 300-TPD plant will be set up on seven acres at Okhla, an official said.

These facilities will scientifically process segregated organic waste to produce CBG and organic fertiliser, contributing to cleaner and more sustainable waste management, the official added.

Gupta said that addressing Delhi's civic challenges "requires coordinated efforts by the Centre, the Delhi government, local bodies, public sector enterprises, the private sector and civil society".

"Delhi generates nearly 13,500 metric tonnes of solid waste every day, while the existing processing capacity remains inadequate, leading to the accumulation of landfill mountains over the years. The two CBG plants with a combined capacity of 800 TPD will provide a sustainable solution by converting wet waste into biogas and organic fertiliser, benefiting the environment, promoting clean energy, and supporting the agricultural sector," Gupta also said.

Wahi said, "Not a single rupee will be spent by the MCD. The cost of around 400 crores and operation of the plants will be borne by OIL and MCD will provide land for the plant site."

• FASTER INTERCHANGES, LINKS TO OLD CITY AND DWARKA EXPRESSWAY

Gurgaon's upcoming 28-km Metro line will make your daily commute easier

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 30

FOR COMMUTERS in Gurgaon, changing Metro lines could soon mean a walk across platforms instead of a trip outside the station. The city's upcoming 28.5-km loop will create seamless interchanges with existing and upcoming transit networks while extending connectivity to areas of Old Gurgaon that have remained outside the Metro grid.

Running in a continuous loop, the line will start at Millennium City Centre on Delhi Metro's Yellow Line. It will cover areas such as Sector 45, Cyber Park, Subhash Chowk, Palam Vihar, Udyog Vihar Phase 1,

Cyber City, before terminating at Sector 101 on the Dwarka Expressway spur. (see map)

After inspecting the entire alignment Monday, Chander Shekhar Khare, Managing Director of Gurugram Metro Rail Limited (GMRL), outlined the project's two key engineering solutions: high-capacity multi-modal transfer hubs that will allow passengers to change trains within a common concourse, and double-decker elevated tracks for the narrow stretches of Old Gurgaon.

The biggest interchange points on the 27-station ring line are planned at Cyber City and Millennium City Centre. At Cyber City, engineers are de-

signing a terminal station equipped with a double vestibule. It will allow commuters to hop directly between the new GMRL line, the existing Rapid Metro, and the upcoming Delhi-Alwar rapid rail corridor inside a single, paid concourse.

At Millennium City Centre, the new line will connect with Delhi Metro's Yellow Line through a platform-to-platform interchange. Additional multi-modal integration points are planned at Subhash Chowk to link with the proposed Bhondsi line; at Hero Honda Chowk for the Delhi-SNB RRTS; at Sector 5 for the Gurugram Railway Station; and at Sector 10 for a planned mega bus terminal.

• THE NEW METRO LOOP



GMRL is attempting an ambitious spatial fix along the stretch from Sector 7 to Cyber

City. As the line will pass through congested residential pockets where roads are narrow,

GMRL and the Gurgaon Metropolitan Development Authority are evaluating double-decker station designs at Baighera Road and Sector 21.

By stacking Metro tracks directly above existing road flyovers within the same median footprint, the project aims to avoid aggressive land acquisition while preventing severe traffic chokepoints. While the ring completes a full circuit through the city's commercial nerve centers, Old Gurgaon and the Dwarka Expressway belt will gain the most from this layout.

For decades, densely populated areas such as Sectors 3, 4, 5, 7, 9, Basai, and Palam Vihar were entirely omitted from the Metro

grid. This loop brings Old Gurgaon directly onto the map, connecting residential neighbourhoods directly to office hubs in Cyber City and Udyog Vihar.

The Dwarka Expressway belt will also get a direct link through a two-station spur line from Basai Village to Sector 101.

Work on the ground is moving into heavy construction mode. The first Rs 1,503-crore package (Package CC-01), awarded to Dilip Buildcon-Ranjit Buildcon joint venture, covers a 15.2-km stretch and has a 30-month construction timeline.

Casting yards are operational, producing precast concrete segments for the elevated viaduct, while piling and pier

work is underway between the GMDA office and Hero Honda Chowk. The narrow Old Gurgaon stretch, designated as Priority-2, is being prepped for the next phase with World Bank funding assistance.

According to timelines discussed in meetings chaired by Union Minister Rao Inderjit Singh, GMRL has set August 2028 as the completion deadline for the primary Millennium City Centre-Sector 9 corridor. Officials are pushing contractors to complete major civil structures in Package 1 by late 2027 to allow early trial runs. As of July 21, the 28.5-km project had achieved around 11% physical progress, officials said.

Citing need for Central funds, Kerala UDF reverses stand on PM SHRI

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, July 30

KERALA'S RULING Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) Thursday decided to implement the Union Government's Pradhan Mantri Schools for Rising India (PM SHRI) scheme in state-run schools — a significant U-turn for a coalition that had once strenuously opposed it.

After a UDF meeting on Thursday, alliance convener and Congress MP Adoor Pra-

kash said the coalition had decided to implement the Bharatiya Janata Party-led Centre's PM SHRI in Kerala schools. "The previous LDF government had signed an MoU with the Centre. Hence, the present government cannot withdraw from it. The UDF government will take forward the project to get the fund, which is not a magnanimity of the Centre. A UDF sub-committee will finalise the schools where the project has to be implemented," he said.

It is a significant departure from the UDF's previous stance.

As Opposition, it had criticised the scheme, accusing the previous LDF government of facilitating the Sangh Parivar's "saf-ronisation" of education by signing the MoU with the Centre.

Ally IUML's, one of the scheme's most vocal critics, stance is also softened, which now holds the education portfolio. In the run-up to the polls, the IUML had warned that the scheme would be "abandoned" if it was voted to power. They justified this by arguing that Kerala needs the central funds while safeguarding the rights

in the field of education.

The shift comes at a time of financial constraints and rising education arrears in Kerala, which stand at Rs1,466 crore. It has prompted the LDF and UDF governments to change their previous positions.

In Kerala, 33 Kendriya Vidyalayas and 14 Navodaya Vidyalayas are part of the scheme. Under PM SHRI, states have to bear 40% of the project expenditure. So far, 13,095 schools, from primary to higher-secondary level, across 776 districts have become part of the scheme.

‘Obsessed’ with changing colours: Naveen on new Hockey jerseys

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, July 30

QUESTIONING HOCKEY India's decision to change the national hockey team's jersey from its traditional blue to saffron, former Odisha chief minister Naveen Patnaik Thursday alleged that the move was made under pressure from the BJP government in the state.

The Odisha government is the official sponsor of the team.

Patnaik said on X that the Odisha BJP government has shown an "obsession" with changing the colours of build-

ings, buses and even bridges.

"I strongly condemn this attempt by BJP Odisha to politicise a national game like hockey. It has deeply hurt the sentiments of lakhs of sports lovers across the country and the pride with which Odisha has supported national hockey," noted Patnaik.

"Our blue jersey is to us what the iconic stripes are to Argentina and the yellow jersey is to Brazil. It is etched in our collective memory. Any change in this colour, is a crass attempt to erase our priceless sporting legacy. National symbols are meant to unite us, not divide," he said.



दिल्ली प्रौद्योगिकी विश्वविद्यालय
DELHI TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
(Formerly Delhi College of Engineering)
Shahbad Daultapur, Bawana Road, Delhi – 110042

OPEN TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of Hon'ble Vice Chancellor, Delhi Technological University (DTU), Delhi Officer In-Charge (Purchase Section), invites bids under a two-bid system (Technical and Financial Bid) in Delhi Technological University from an authorized Firm/OEM for the purchase of the following item:

Sr. No.	Description	GeM Bid ID
1	Gas Analyser (Lab equipment)	GEM/2026/B/7738400
2	High-End Desktop Computer	GEM/2026/B/7798153
3	Workstation with Graphic Card	GEM/2026/B/7811907

The details are available on the GeM Portal. Firms must submit their offer only through the GeM Portal in two bid system. The bid document is also available for viewing on the website of DTU, www.dtu.ac.in. For any query, please contact us at the telephone no. 011-27871018.

Note:- Corrigendum, if any, will be issued through the GeM portal only.

TATA STEEL LIMITED Registered Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001 India Tel.: 91 22 6665 8282 • Email: cosec@tatasteel.com • Website: www.tatasteel.com CIN: L27100MH1907PLC000260 NOTICE Extract of Standalone Financial Results for the quarter ended on 30th June 2026 ₹ Crore				
Particulars	Quarter ended on 30.06.2026	Quarter ended on 31.03.2026	Quarter ended on 30.06.2025	Financial year ended on 31.03.2026
	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
Total revenue from operations	36,896.55	38,447.96	31,014.36	1,39,720.22
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	6,112.02	6,477.98	4,776.84	22,451.96
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	5,820.52	6,345.93	4,557.76	21,353.10
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax	4,535.59	4,659.74	3,523.25	16,065.13
Total comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	3,477.29	(143.12)	6,743.37	13,295.44
Paid-up equity share capital [Face value ₹ 1 per share]	1,248.60	1,248.60	1,248.60	1,248.60
Reserves excluding revaluation reserves				1,34,284.71
Securities premium reserve	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24
Net Worth	1,35,822.61	1,32,345.31	1,30,287.29	1,32,345.31
Paid-up Debt Capital	15,159.95	15,159.21	15,157.00	15,159.21
Debt Equity Ratio	0.49	0.48	0.46	0.50
Earnings per equity share:				
Basic earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	3.63	3.74	2.82	12.87
Diluted earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	3.63	3.73	2.82	12.87
Debenture Redemption Reserve	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	4.27	6.42	1.34	2.85
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	7.68	8.27	6.91	8.08

Extract of Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter ended on 30th June 2026					₹ Crore
Particulars	Quarter ended on 30.06.2026	Quarter ended on 31.03.2026	Quarter ended on 30.06.2025	Financial year ended on 31.03.2026	
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	
Total revenue from operations	60,794.29	63,270.13	53,178.12	2,32,139.94	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	4,183.01	5,150.42	3,199.20	17,001.15	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	3,837.53	4,810.37	3,067.08	15,968.69	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax	2,385.24	2,965.00	2,007.36	10,885.82	
Total comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	2,336.83	3,755.68	4,351.52	16,377.93	
Paid-up equity share capital [Face value ₹ 1 per share]	1,247.44	1,247.44	1,247.44	1,247.44	
Reserves (excluding revaluation reserves) and Non controlling interest				1,02,533.01	
Net Worth	1,01,054.51	98,768.46	91,464.44	98,768.46	
Debt Equity Ratio	0.80	0.79	0.91	0.82	
Earnings per equity share:					
Basic earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	1.86	2.34	1.67	8.65	
Diluted earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	1.86	2.34	1.67	8.65	
Debenture Redemption Reserve	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.03	0.92	0.98	0.98	
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	4.53	5.27	3.69	4.72	

Note:

The above is an extract of the detailed format of Standalone and Consolidated financial results for the quarter ended on 30th June 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated results for the quarter ended on 30th June 2026 are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges (www.nseindia.com/www.bseindia.com) and the Company's website (www.tatasteel.com).



Sd/-
T V Narendran
Chief Executive Officer &
Managing Director
Mumbai, July 30, 2026

Sd/-
Koushik Chatterjee
Executive Director &
Chief Financial Officer

TATA STEEL

**ICL Fincorp**

This is an advertisement issued pursuant to Regulation 30(1) of the SEBI (Issue and Listing of Non-Convertible Securities) Regulations, 2021 as amended, for information purpose only.


(Please scan the QR code to view the Prospectus)

ICL FINCORP LIMITED

ICL Fincorp Limited ("our Company" or "the Company" or "the Issuer" or "ICL") was originally incorporated as 'Jawahar Finance Limited' at Chennai, a public limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated December 9, 1991, issued by RoC. The name of our Company was changed to 'Irinjalakuda Credits & Leasing Company Limited' pursuant to a fresh certificate of incorporation dated April 26, 2004, issued by the RoC. Later, the name of our Company was changed to 'ICL Fincorp Limited' pursuant to a fresh certificate of incorporation dated May 8, 2016, issued by the RoC. Our Company holds a certificate of registration dated June 09, 2016, bearing registration number B-07.00437 issued by the Reserve Bank of India ("RBI") to carry on the activities of a non-banking financial company without accepting public deposits under Section 45 IA of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. For further details about our Company, see "General Information" on page 39 of the Prospectus and "History and Certain Other Corporate Matters" on page 127 of the Prospectus.

Registered Office: Plot No. C308, Door No. 66/40, 4th Avenue, Ashok Nagar, Chennai- 600 083, Tamil Nadu, India; **Tel:** +91 44 4208 2381, 2958 0014; **Corporate Office:** ICL Fincorp Limited, Main Road, Irinjalakuda, Thrissur – 680121, Kerala, India; **Tel:** +91 480 267 0400, 282 8071, 283 1305; **Corporate Identification Number:** U65191TN1991PLC021815; **PAN:** AAACJ1806C; **E-mail:** info@iclfincorp.com; **Website:** www.iclfincorp.com; **Company Secretary and Compliance Officer:** Visakh T.V.; **Email:** cs@iclfincorp.com; **Tel:** +91 480 267 0400, 282 8071, 283 1305; **Chief Financial Officer:** Madhavankutty Thekkedath; **Email:** cfo@iclfincorp.com; **Tel:** +91 480 267 0400, 282 8071, 283 1305;

PUBLIC ISSUE OF UP TO 10,00,000 SECURED, REDEEMABLE, NON-CONVERTIBLE DEBENTURES (NCDs) OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1,000 EACH
NOTICE TO INVESTORS

This notice is with reference to the public issue of up to 10,00,000 secured, redeemable, non-convertible debentures of face value of ₹1,000 each, ("NCDs") at par, for an amount up to ₹5,00,000 thousand ("Base Issue Size") with an option to retain oversubscription of up to ₹5,00,000 thousand aggregating up to ₹10,00,000 thousand (the "Issue") by ICL Fincorp Limited ("Company") in accordance with Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue and Listing of Non-Convertible Securities) Regulations, 2021, as amended (the "SEBI NCS Regulations"), the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, as amended from time to time, and rules made thereunder the SEBI Circular no. SEBI/HO/DDHS/DDHS-PoD/P/CIR/2025/0000000137 dated October 15, 2025, as amended ("SEBI Master Circular"). The Company has filed prospectus dated July 28, 2026 ("Prospectus") with the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu at Chennai ("RoC"), Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") and BSE Limited ("BSE") (the "Stock Exchange"). THE ISSUE IS NOT PROPOSED TO BE UNDERWRITTEN.

ISSUE PROGRAMME
ISSUE OPENS - AUGUST 10, 2026 (MONDAY)
ISSUE CLOSES - AUGUST 21, 2026 (FRIDAY)*

*The Issue shall remain open for subscription on Working Days from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time), during the period indicated in the Prospectus, except that the Issue may close on such earlier date or extended date as may be decided by the Board of Directors of our Company or the Finance and Management Committee, subject to relevant approvals (subject to a minimum period of two working days and a maximum period of ten working days from the date of opening of this Issue).

In the event of an early closure or extension of the Issue, our Company shall ensure that notice of such early closure or extension is given to the prospective investors through an advertisement in a national daily newspaper and a regional daily newspaper in Tamil Nadu where the registered office is located, with wide circulation on or before such earlier date or extended date of closure. Application Forms for the Issue will be accepted only from 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) or such extended time as may be permitted by the Stock Exchange, on Working Days during the Issue Period. On the Issue Closing Date, Application Forms will be accepted only between 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. and uploaded until 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time) or such extended time as may be permitted by the Stock Exchange.

Allotment on "first come first serve basis" #
#As per the SEBI Master Circular, the allotment in this issue is required to be made on the basis of date of upload of each application into the electronic book of the Stock Exchange. For further details refer section titled "Issue Related Information" on page 258 of the Prospectus.

In accordance with the provision of and requirement under Section 30 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Regulation 30(1) of the SEBI NCS Regulations, the Company has published statutory advertisement dated July 30, 2026 on their website at www.iclfincorp.com on which contains the disclosures as per Schedule V of the SEBI NCS Regulations ("Statutory Advertisement"). The Statutory Advertisement can be viewed through the QR code and web link given below:
<https://www.iclfincorp.com/fileupload/pGSAP0XdJN>


(please scan this QR code to view the detailed advertisement)

Capitalized terms not defined herein shall have the same meaning as assigned to such terms in the Prospectus.
All the potential investors are advised to please provide attention to the above mentioned update and take an informed decision accordingly.

For ICL Fincorp Limited
SD/-
K.G. Anilkumar
(Chairman & Managing Director) DIN: 00766739

Place : Irinjalakuda
Date : 30/07/2026

**Government of West Bengal**

**Developed West Bengal, Developed India**

**Prosperous Farmers, Progressive Bengal**

A landmark initiative of the Government of West Bengal

Additional Subsidy on Agri-Pump Electric Connections

₹2 additional subsidy per unit

provided by the State Government

To reduce the cost of farming and enhance farmers' income, the State Government has decided to provide an additional subsidy of **₹2** per unit on electricity for agricultural pump connections.

How farmers will be benefited?

- Lower Irrigation Costs**
Additional subsidy of ₹ 2 per unit will reduce the cost of irrigation.
- Higher Farm Income**
Lower input costs, better savings and more income.
- Agricultural Growth**
Affordable and dependable electricity will enable productive farming.
- Village Development**
Prosperous farmers, prosperous Bengal.

Affordable Power, Prosperous Farmers, Brighter Future

Empowering Agriculture. Energising Rural Growth.

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Department of Agriculture
Government of West Bengal

Department of Power
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**WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY DISTRIBUTION COMPANY LIMITED**
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Regd. Office: Vidyut Bhavan, Block-D, Sector-II, Bidhanagar, Kolkata - 700 091
CIN : U40109WB2007SGC113473, www.wbsedcl.in



Mango Party For All

AMID THE stand-off between the Treasury Benches and the Opposition in Parliament, a get-together hosted by Congress leader Shashi Tharoor at his official residence in the Capital saw a unique mix of guests on Wednesday. Although rain and the ruckus in the Lok Sabha played a spoiler, Tharoor's 'Mango & Chaat Party' saw a decent attendance of MPs from around 15 parties, diplomats from 35 embassies and a cross-section of government officials and mediapersons. The guests were seen engaging in political and non-political discussions while relishing a spread of mangoes. The BJP was represented by senior MPs Rajiv Pratap Rudy and Shashank Mani Tripathi. Many Congress MPs could not reach in time because of the developments in the Lok Sabha after Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi took on the government over the recent police crackdown on protesters at Jantar Mantar. Union Minister Jitendra Singh and BJP MP Tejasvi Surya, who were in the House, conveyed their good wishes while regretting their inability to attend the get-together, said sources.

E20 petrol can reduce fuel economy by 2-6%: Gadkari

New Delhi: Petrol blended with 20% ethanol (E20) can reduce fuel economy by 2 to 6% depending on the vehicle category and vintage, Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari informed Parliament on Thursday.

The Union Minister, however, argued that tests for engine durability on a dynamometer and on-road vehicle tests have not shown any failures due to E20.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Gadkari said E20 fuel provides better acceleration, improved ride quality and approximately 30% lower carbon emissions compared to E10 fuel. "The fuel efficiency of vehicles may be reduced by 2 to 6% depending on the vehicle category and vintage. The tests for engine durability on a dynamometer and vehicle tests on road have not shown any failures due to E20," the minister said. PTI

Amid Opp protests, House clears Bill criminalising insult to Vande Mataram

Centre calls it a 'Bill of national pride'; DMK says it reflects 'communal outlook'

DeepTIMAN TIWARY
New Delhi, July 30

THE LOK Sabha on Thursday passed the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 amid protests by the Opposition over the police "excesses" on protesters at Jantar Mantar and the Ram Temple donation theft row.

The Bill was cleared in about 15 minutes during the post-lunch sitting after repeated adjournments since morning amid the din. Throughout the brief debate, Congress and Samajwadi Party members continued sloganeering from the Well of the House. The DMK was the only Opposition party to participate in the discussion.

Moving amendments to the Bill, DMK MP A Raja alleged that the Bill reflected a "communal outlook".

"Today is a very dangerous day for Parliament and the country. I have carefully gone through the reasons and objects of the Bill... One person and one song [are] important for this country having a communal outlook. Why did Partition happen? One person... and one song...," he said. Raja sought to make "a legal point", but the Chair did not allow him to continue and put his amendment to vote, which was defeated. Joining the debate, DMK MP Kanimozhi alleged that the Bill was a "Hindutva agenda masquerading as nationalism" and accused the government of trying to "impose nationalism through law". She argued that the Constituent Assembly had consciously accepted only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram and said making all six stanzas mandatory would undermine the country's secular character. Referring to Tamil Nadu's long-standing state song, she said the legislation disrespected states with their own official songs and accused the government of using the issue to polarise the country. Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai rejected the criticism, asserting that the legislation was "a Bill of national pride" and was "not against any state, ideology or person". He said the government respected all state

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MoS Nityanand Rai (above) and DMK MP A Raja (right) speak in Lok Sabha on Thursday. ANI

Not an ordinary Bill" but one that intended to ensure that people, particularly school students, could express respect for both the National Anthem and the National Song "without any hurdle". He said the president of the Constituent Assembly, Dr Rajendra Prasad, had given an assurance that Jana Gana Mana



MoS Nityanand Rai (above) and DMK MP A Raja (right) speak in Lok Sabha on Thursday. ANI

Participating from the Treasury Benches, BJP MP Sambit Patra said the amendment was "not an ordinary Bill" but one that intended to ensure that people, particularly school students, could express respect for both the National Anthem and the National Song "without any hurdle". He said the president of the Constituent Assembly, Dr Rajendra Prasad, had given an assurance that Jana Gana Mana



that intended to ensure that people, particularly school students, could express respect for both the National Anthem and the National Song "without any hurdle". He said the president of the Constituent Assembly, Dr Rajendra Prasad, had given an assurance that Jana Gana Mana

EXPRESS special

Why govt is holding back key Bills as Parliament logjam continues

Liz Mathew

New Delhi, July 30

WITH THE Opposition intensifying its protests against alleged police excesses against student protesters and the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the government appears to be slowing down on its legislative agenda for the moment. The government, insiders said, is waiting for the Opposition to get back to allowing Parliament to function before taking up crucial pieces of legislation next week.

The Centre on Thursday managed to get the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — also known as the Vande Mataram Bill — passed amid the din in the Lok Sabha. The Bill saw a brief discussion involving only two members: Union Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai and DMK MP Kanimozhi. While Rai defended the legislation saying all six stanzas of the song were needed to ensure "Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat (One India, Best India)", Kanimozhi termed it "a Hindutva agenda masquerading as nationalism".

"It is against federalism. You cannot impose nationalism by bringing a law, the song goes against the secularism of the country. The founding fathers had the wisdom to stop only



During the debate on Vande Mataram Bill on Thursday, DMK MP Kanimozhi said it is against federalism, and the song goes 'against secularism'. ANI

with two stanzas, but today you are trying to polarise the country by... making it a criminal offence if we do not sing all the six stanzas," she said.

The government deferred the consideration and passage of the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill. According to sources, the Bill, which was deferred on the request of the Opposition, is now likely to be taken up in the Lower House on Monday. It proposes to increase the SC's sanctioned strength from 33 to 37 judges.

"Many Opposition parties did not want a detailed discussion on the Vande Mataram Bill as the optics of vehemently opposing it could have been politically damaging, while backing it would have hurt their

support base," a BJP leader said.

The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, passed by the Rajya Sabha on Wednesday, makes the intentional disruption of the national song a criminal offence, punishable with up to three years' imprisonment. The Bill has placed several parties, including the Congress and the SP, in a difficult position, with Muslim organisations strongly opposing it.

BJP sources said the Treasury benches are expected to introduce the MSME Development Act, 2006 (Amendment) Bill and the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill next week. "We do not want to rush these Bills. We want the Opposition to discuss crucial pieces of legislation such as the FCRA Bill. That is why the government is taking its time before bringing it up," a BJP leader said.

The FCRA Bill seeks to amend the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010, which regulates the acceptance and utilisation of foreign contributions and foreign hospitality to "ensure that such inflows do not adversely affect national interest... or national security". The Opposition and minority groups have alleged that the proposed amendments would adversely affect in-

stitutions run by minority communities, including Christians.

The proposed amendments to the MSME Development Act seek to introduce mandatory digital invoicing, strengthen safeguards against delayed payments and ensure faster settlement of disputes. The changes are aimed at improving liquidity and reducing the long payment delays that often leave small businesses short of working capital.

Government sources also indicated that repeated adjournments and the loss of working hours could delay the government's plans to take up the 131st Constitution Amendment Bill, which seeks to increase the number of seats in the Lok Sabha. The Bill is linked to the implementation of the Women's Reservation law and the Delimitation Bill during the ongoing Monsoon Session, scheduled to conclude on August 13.

Two other key legislations — the 130th Constitution Amendment Bill and the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025 — have also been delayed.

Senior BJP leader and Lok Sabha Chief Whip Sanjay Jaiswal said the government would be compelled to pass the Bills amid the pandemonium if the Opposition continued its protests.

and Vande Mataram would enjoy equal respect, but the promise has not been fulfilled over the past 76 years because of the Congress leadership.

Earlier, while introducing the Bill, Rai had described it as "not just a statutory amendment" but "a commitment to India's soul, cultural heritage, national consciousness and the ideals of the freedom struggle". Invoking Vande Mataram composer Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, Swami Vivekananda and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, he said Prime Minister Narendra Modi was fulfilling the vision of according Vande Mataram its rightful place in national life. Rai recalled that Patel had asked classical vocalist Omkarnath Thakur to sing the full Vande Mataram on All India Radio on the morning of August 15, 1947, and said freedom fighters, including Chandrashekhar Azad, Ram Prasad Bismil and Ashfaqullah Khan, had gone to the gallows with "Vande Mataram" on their lips.

The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill is the first legislation to be passed by both Houses of Parliament in the ongoing Monsoon Session, which has seen frequent disruptions by the Opposition mainly over the NEET paper leak issue.

Govt on UN Rapporteurs' SIR concern: Due process followed

New Delhi: Almost three months after three United Nations Special Rapporteurs wrote to the government, raising concern over large-scale deletion of electors and alleged discrimination through the SIR, the Union government acknowledged the communication on Thursday, informing the Rajya Sabha that the exercise was "carried out by following the due process of law without prejudice to any group or community". ENS

Figuratively, Dubai 15th dist of Kerala, says CPM MP as JDU's Jha claims foreign role in CJP stir

DeepTIMAN TIWARY
New Delhi, July 30

JD(U) MP Sanjay Kumar Jha on Thursday alleged foreign involvement in the Jantar Mantar agitation, triggering protests from the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha.

Participating in a discussion on the The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, Jha said while the Cockroach Janata Party protests were underway, he had seen a Malayalam television channel reporting that "some Dubai-based businessmen had secured travel tickets for 23 people and helped them participate in the protests".

"What relation did these people have with NEET? The demand of students and their sentiments are genuine. But it is a matter of investigation as to who were the people who infiltrated the protest and were trying to hijack it," Jha said.

The remarks immediately sparked protests from the Opposition benches, led by MPs from Kerala, who sought to rebut the allegation. The Chair, however, did not permit interventions as Jha was still speaking.

Later, CPI(M) MP A A Rahim said Jha should authenticate his statement about watching a Malayalam channel, arguing that his allegations were not supported by facts. The Chair said it would examine the matter.

CPI(M) member John Brittas argued that those who had travelled from Dubai were Indian citizens and had every right to participate in protests.

"They are citizens of India. Figuratively, Dubai is the 15th district of Kerala. They have every right to come to India and participate in a protest. A wrong message should not go from this House," Brittas said.

Responding to the controversy over Sanjeev Mukhiya, whom the CBI gave a clean chit in the 2024 NEET paper leak case last year, Jha said Mukhiya remained lodged in Buxar jail in



(Top) JD(U) MP Sanjay Kumar Jha and CPI(M) MP John Brittas in Rajya Sabha on Thursday. ANI

connection with other criminal cases. "There are so many cases against him that there is no possibility of him getting out," he said.

The issue of Mukhiya, who was initially arrested by Bihar Police in the 2024 NEET paper leak case and later taken into custody by the CBI, had been raised earlier in the debate by Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge.

Jha appealed to the members to rise above partisan politics while discussing exam paper leaks. "When a question paper is leaked, it does not merely violate the secrecy of the exam but also erodes the trust in the system... So I request that this issue not be measured on the yardstick of politics. The students are not asking who belongs to which party. She is asking if her hard work is secure and if she will get justice. Parliament has to answer this question," he said. Calling paper leaks a recurring national problem, Jha said: "Paper leak is not a new issue. In different times, under governments of different parties, such issues have come up. The biggest cost of this is paid by students. This is not a question of the failure of a party or government; it is a national challenge. Its solution should be found with a national perspective."



PM meets President

President Droupadi Murmu with PM Narendra Modi at Rashtrapati Bhavan, Thursday. The meeting comes days after the President returned from a tour of Moldova, North Macedonia and Romania. X/@RASHTRAPATIBHVN

With CJP stir, Gen Z caught the BJP off guard. Can the Opposition make it count?



MANY AGREE that if the BJP had sent emissaries -- even members of the Delhi Government -- early on to Jantar Mantar to talk to fasting activist Sonam Wangchuk and the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders, who were then holding a sit-in there to demand accountability over the NEET exam paper leak, the crisis would not have escalated as it did.

The BJP government misread the Gen Z protests and miscalculated its response to the situation, which has landed it in a spot.

The Monsoon Session of Parliament was supposed to be about a renewed push for the constitutional amendment legislation linked to the Delimitation Bill the Narendra Modi

government had failed to pass in the House in April. But now, with the CJP-led student protests forcing the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as the Education Minister, this may prove to be trickier. Even the Opposition INDIA bloc parties such as the DMK and NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar), which were keeping all options open on the issue, have suddenly become more ambivalent about it.

Unlike the setback for the BJP in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, when its tally dropped, the challenge for the party this time is different.

A section of the BJP cadre appears to be disappointed that a powerful Prime Minister such as Modi, seen to be loath to act under pressure -- though he did withdraw the three farm laws after a year-long farmer agitation at Delhi's borders -- was compelled to drop Pradhan. It would have been another story if Pradhan had quit at the outset and taken a high moral ground.

A misjudgement?

The government seemed to

have misjudged the extent to which the paper leak row exercised the minds of students, which was not limited to just the NEET aspirants. Some ministers saw it as an "inconsequential" issue, claiming that it rather gave the students "more time to prepare", little realising the cost, uncertainty and "trauma" it meant for them and their parents.

Other BJP leaders saw Gen Z as a small, "westernised" group of youngsters living in metros, away from parents and detached from their "sanskar". The critical online comments against the BJP and the PM by some party functionaries' children in Odisha or UP show that these youths should not be taken lightly.

The modest rallies of CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke in different cities after he arrived in the country in early June, and only a few hundred people at Jantar Mantar in the early days of Wangchuk's hunger strike, might have lulled the government into believing that the CJP did not have much youth support.



CJP supporters celebrate Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi last week. PRAVEEN KHANNA

The ruling camp's biggest miscalculation could be the use of force by the police to bring the protesters to heel, which often turned out to be counter-productive. Buoyed by the BJP's heady success in West Bengal and the ease with which regional Opposition parties such as the Trinamool Congress (TMC) and the Shiv Sena (UBT) were subsequently split -- bringing two-thirds majority in Parliament within striking distance -- the

government chose to deal with the protesters with a heavy hand.

If there is one thing that has taken the row to every middle-class home in India, causing widespread angst, it is the visuals of the police lathi-charge and tear gas shelling on July 20, the opening day of the Monsoon Session. This was not like an anti-CAA agitation that the BJP could ignore. The middle class has been the core of Modi's sup-

port base and he can ill afford to antagonise them.

The PM eventually decided to let Pradhan go in a bid to end a deepening crisis. The BJP brass did not want heated sentiments of Gen Z, who account for about a quarter of the population, to influence the next year's Assembly elections in several states, including UP, Punjab, and Gujarat.

Did the Opposition miss a chance?

While the protests were spearheaded by students, they have given a new heart to an otherwise demoralised Opposition. Any growing discontent against the government is likely to benefit the Congress, the largest Opposition party, more than the regional parties that have weakened lately. The visuals of Rahul Gandhi bleeding from the nose while being dragged by the police from his dharna outside the PM's residence, and of Akhilesh Yadav being similarly whisked away, may have created a resonance in UP and other states.

Such moments come rarely

in the life of a country and unfortunately, the debate that was meant to flag off new ideas for education reform by parliamentarians became a Rahul versus Modi affair yet again.

What will CJP do?

The CJP may retain its hold over a large number of youth if it focuses on their specific issues to keep up the pressure on parties and fashion a new narrative to catalyse a change. But those seeking a change in the 2029 Lok Sabha polls are more likely to look to the Rahul Gandhi-led Congress.

It is too early to reach any conclusions, though. The BJP has a record of undertaking prompt course-correction and has already brought an amended anti-paper leaks Bill in Parliament to ensure stricter punishment for the guilty. It has sacked 47 National Testing Agency (NTA) officials and the PM has also announced a high-powered task force on exam reforms led by Nandan Nilekani.

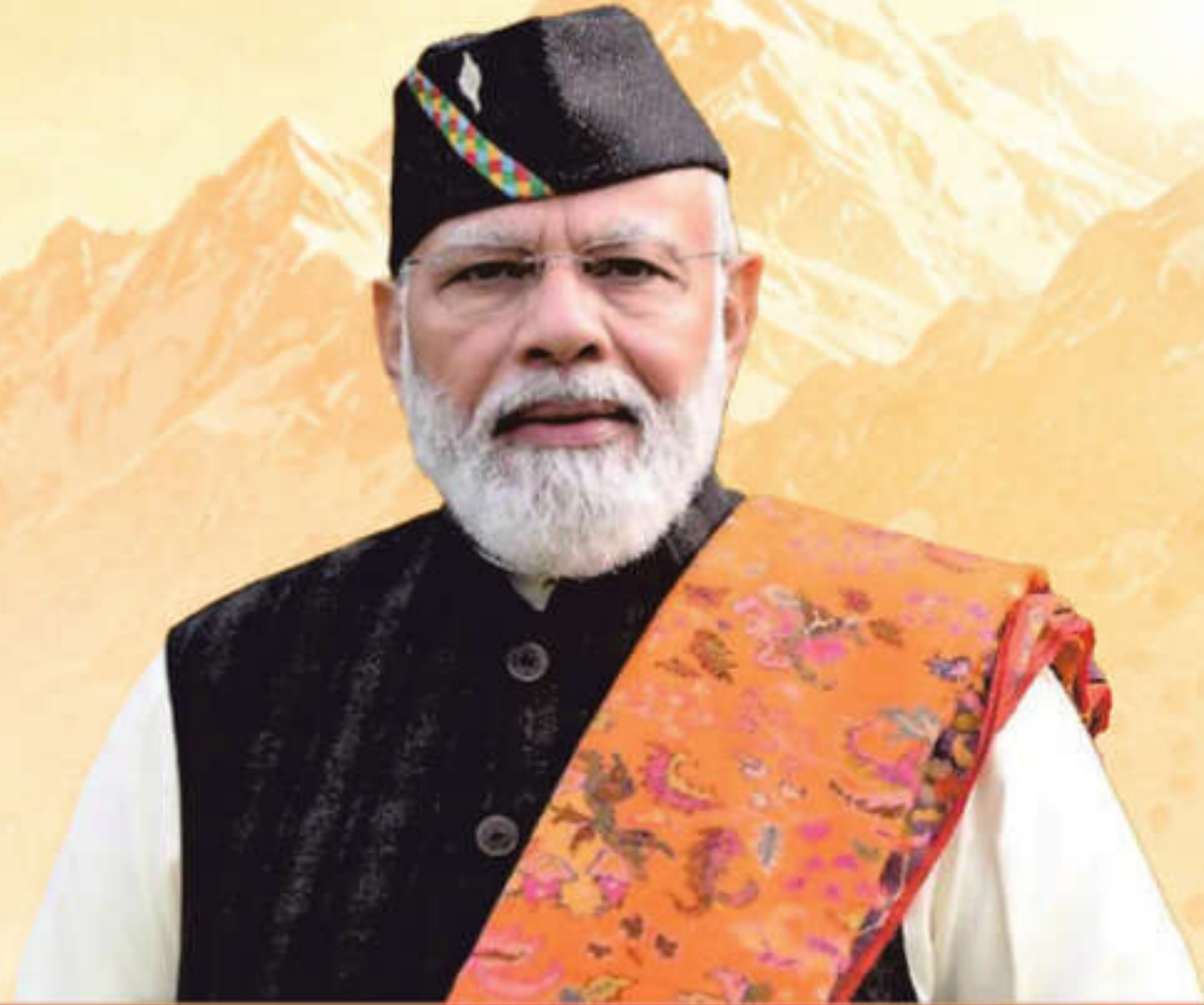
Whether these measures are enough will depend on the gov-

ernment's resolve to implement them. Given the expanding privatisation of education as well as the RSS's high stakes in the sector, this is not going to be an easy task. And yet, this may become Modi's moment if his government can go beyond tokenism and come to grips with the issue of long-pending, much-needed reforms in the education system, which could hold out real hope for Gen Z.

If nothing else, the protests have shown that Gen Z is a spirited, resilient cohort concerned with their issues and having an ability to work as a collective. They stood firm on their demand for Pradhan's ouster and yet showed a flexibility to come to an agreement with the government.

A crucial takeaway remains the point that change is possible through peaceful and democratic means. That is no small gain in 2026.

(Neeraja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of How Prime Ministers Decide.)



“ The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand. ”

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

“ Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi Ji has called the third decade of the 21st century the decade of Uttarakhand. In line with the Prime Minister's vision, we are working with a 'resolve without alternative' (Vikalp Rahit Sankalp) to make the state an ideal state in every field. ”

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

Viksit Bharat Sashakt Uttarakhand



Sewa - Sushasan - Samarpan

Employment

- Strict Anti-Copying/Anti-Cheating Law & Transparent Recruitment Process: Selection across multiple departments 33,000 youths given government jobs in the past 5 years.
- Chief Minister Skill Upgradation & Global Employment Scheme: Budget increased from ₹75 lakh to ₹33 crore; foreign language training provided to 147 children, with 92 securing employment abroad.
- Growth in MSME Employment: Number of people employed in MSMEs increased from 3,43,922 in 2022 to 4,56,605 in 2025.
- 10% Horizontal Reservation for Agniveers: Applicable to direct recruitment in Group 'C' uniformed services in government jobs.
- Devbhoomi Entrepreneurship Development Scheme: 300+ students established enterprises, registration of nearly 1,200 students is underway, and employment generated for 1,541 students and others.

Industries

- New Momentum to Development Through Grounding of Investments Worth Over ₹1.00 Lakh Crore.
- Investment Agreements Worth ₹3.56 Lakh Crore: Signed during the Global Investors Summit.
- Expansion of Land Bank: Over 6,000 acres of additional land bank developed for industries.
- Thriving MSME Sector: Over 96,400 MSME units active across the state.
- Massive Job Creation in MSME: Generated over 4.70 lakh jobs in the MSME sector.
- Flourishing Startup Culture: Over 1,750 startups established in the state.
- National Recognition: Uttarakhand recognized as a "Leader" state in the States' Startup Ecosystem Ranking.
- Large-Scale Industries: 128 large industrial units currently operational in the state.

Education

- Uttarakhand has become the first state in the country to implement the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.
- Under the PM SHRI Scheme, 141 schools were selected in the first phase and 84 schools in the second phase.
- Virtual classrooms are being operated in 500 Government Secondary Schools across the state.
- The total number of Government and Private Degree Colleges in the state increased to 139 by 2025.
- The total number of Engineering Colleges (Government and Private) in the state increased to 52 by 2025.
- Under the Secondary Education programme, free textbooks are being provided to students of Class I to XII studying in Government and Private schools across the state.

Health

- Construction of the AIIMS Satellite Centre at Kichha is underway, with 85% of the work completed.
- The AIIMS Kichha project includes a 250-bed hospital, 10 Operation Theatres (OTs), 30 ICU beds, advanced Diagnostics & Laboratory facilities, and speciality departments including Cardiology, Nephrology, Urology, Neurology, General Surgery, Orthopaedics, General Medicine, Paediatrics, and an Emergency & Trauma Centre.
- More than 6.1 million Ayushman Cards have been issued across the state under the Atal Ayushman Yojana.
- Under the Atal Ayushman Yojana, more than 1.7 million patients have received cashless treatment worth over ₹3,400 crore.
- 207 types of pathology tests are being provided completely free of cost across the state.
- A target has been set to establish a Medical College in every district. At present, five Medical Colleges are operational, while two more are under construction.
- Super-speciality healthcare services are available at the Medical Colleges in Dehradun, Haldwani, and Srinagar.
- The newly constructed Child and Mother Care Hospital in Haridwar is now operational.

Connectivity

- Inauguration of the 210-km Delhi-Dehradun Economic Corridor, featuring Asia's longest 12-km Wildlife Corridor.
- The Rishikesh-Karnaprayag Rail Project is progressing at a rapid pace.
- The state's road network has expanded to 51,728 km.
- The All Weather Road Project has ensured seamless connectivity to the Char Dham shrines and border areas.
- A new terminal has been developed at Dehradun Airport, with regular flight connectivity to major cities across the country.
- 13 new heliports are currently under construction.
- Construction of the Sonprayag-Kedarnath (12.9 km) and Govindghat-Hemkund Sahib (12.4 km) Ropeway Projects has commenced.

Women Empowerment

- 30% horizontal reservation has been implemented for women in Government jobs across the state.
- 33% reservation for women has been ensured in Co-operative Management Committees.
- Under the Chief Minister Self-Help Group Empowerment Scheme, Self-Help Groups are provided interest-free loans of up to ₹5 lakh.
- Under the Lakhpati Didi Scheme, more than 2.54 lakh women in the state have become Lakhpati Didis.
- Under the Chief Minister Mahalakshmi Kit Scheme, women are provided with essential maternity kits after childbirth.
- Under the Nanda Gaura Scheme, the State Government provides ₹11,000 on the birth of a girl child and ₹51,000 for higher education after she passes Class XII.

Youth Welfare

- Under the New Sports Policy, a historic decision has been taken to provide Government jobs to medal winners at the National and International levels.
- The daily diet allowance for sportspersons has been increased from ₹250 to ₹480 per athlete per day, in line with the Sports Authority of India (SAI).
- Under the Chief Minister Emerging Sportsperson Development Scheme, around 3,900 emerging athletes aged 8 to 14 years are being provided a monthly sports scholarship of ₹1,500.
- Sportspersons who have won medals or represented the country at National and International events such as the Olympic Games, Asian Games, Commonwealth Games, etc., will receive the benefit of the 4% Sports Quota in Government Services.
- 60 Patent Information Centres have been established in various colleges, universities, and other institutions across the state.



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Calcutta HC sets up five fast-track courts for paper leak cases

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, July 30

THE CALCUTTA High Court on Wednesday designated three fast-track courts in Kolkata and two in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands for question paper leak cases.

They must complete trials in cases registered under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 and deliver verdicts within three months of chargesheets being filed.

The development came after Prime Minister Narendra Modi's announcement last week that fast-track courts would be set up to try exam malpractice cases, following the NEET paper leak controversy and student protests that culminated in Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation as Union education minister.

Bench 1 of the Calcutta City Sessions Court has jurisdiction over cases investigated by state government agencies across West Bengal. Court No. 2 of the special CBI court within the City Sessions Court will also

function as a fast-track court for such cases in the state.

The third fast-track court for exam malpractice cases is the court of the First Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (ACJM) in Kolkata.

The court of the Additional District and Sessions Judge and the court of the Chief Judicial Magistrate, both in Port Blair, will hold fast-track trials in exam malpractice cases registered in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

The islands fall under the Calcutta High Court's jurisdiction. The High Court notification specifies that any appeal or revision petition against a fast-track magistrate court's order must be made to the corresponding fast-track sessions courts.

These designated courts will operate independently and have no link to the 88 other fast-track courts in the state. The Lok Sabha passed an amendment to the 2024 Act on Wednesday. Once the Rajya Sabha also passes it and the President gives her assent, the amendment Bill will become law.

Minister in RS: Potential conflict of interest in RDI Fund disbursement

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 30

THE COMMITTEE responsible for selecting companies for receiving money from the newly-created Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) fund had picked at least 15 companies in which members of the committee themselves had a personal stake, according to information provided by the government in Parliament on Thursday.

In a written answer in the Rajya Sabha, Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh provided a list of seven members of the committee who had personal stakes in these 15 companies that have been among those chosen for receiving money from the RDI Fund. The RDI Fund is a Rs 1 lakh crore corpus created by the Centre last year to promote research and development activities and innovation in the private sector, particularly in high-priority areas like deep-tech. The fund is meant to provide long-term low-cost financing to the private sector. The funds are channelised through what are known as second-level fund managers (SLFMs).

These are a few selected organisations which have been empowered to invest in private sector companies in the form of equity, debt or both, using money from the RDI Fund. Current SLFMs include Technology Development Board under the Department of Science and Technology, and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance

Council under the Department of Biotechnology. Every SLFM is supposed to have an investment committee for assessing and vetting investment proposals from the private sector companies seeking funding from the RDI Fund.

In response to a question by Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty, Singh gave names of seven members of the Investment Committee of the Technology Development Board who had made investments in at least 15 entities selected for receiving money from the RDI Fund. Singh said that the TDB had a conflict-of-interest policy for members of the investment committee, but did not specify what this policy was, or whether the selection of these companies constituted a violation of the policy. The implementation guidelines for the RDI scheme say that the investment panel "must be constituted in a way that avoids potential conflicts of interest".

It added that the SLFM must take care to ensure that there was no conflict of interest in the choice of specific projects for financing, "given the likelihood of domain experts on its IC (investment committee) being investors in ideas and companies". It is also not clear if any of the members of the investment panel named in Singh's response in the Rajya Sabha participated in the decision-making process that led to the selection of the company in which they had investments, or they recused themselves in any manner.

Maharashtra to withdraw FIRs through regular legal process

Mohamed Thaver & Sadaf Modak
Mumbai, July 30

THE MAHARASHTRA government has decided to withdraw FIRs registered against individuals who protested in support of the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) over NEET paper leak through the state's existing mechanism for withdrawing cases arising out of political and social protests.

It has directed officials to complete the exercise in a "prompt and time bound manner" instead of the six months to one year it usually takes for such withdrawals.

The cases, however, will not be closed immediately. Instead, they will follow the prescribed legal route in which the police will complete the investigation, file chargesheets and thereafter the prosecution will seek permission from the court to withdraw the cases after the proposal clears two government committees.

"The cases will be withdrawn as per the procedure laid down in the Government Res-

CJP founder accuses BJP of issuing threats, ruling party denies charge

Pune: Alleging threats from BJP, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke on Thursday said he was pressured to either join the party or risk being shot dead.

"I have received many offers from them (BJP). But I won't join BJP. If I wanted to join BJP, I would have done it earlier," he said on Wednesday. "I also received threats that it would be better if I join BJP. They asked me call off the protest, otherwise, 'we will beat you up and shoot you'. This is the very language of love of the Sangh and the BJP."

Dipke said his family was also threatened. "They said 'we will deal with your mother and father. We will visit your home and take care of this'... I asked

olution (GR) governing withdrawal of cases related to political and social protests. Normally, the process takes a long time, but in these cases it will be carried out in a prompt and time bound manner," a senior

government official said. Asked whether the government had fixed a deadline, the official said no specific timeline had been set. "We cannot rush through the procedure... every legal requirement has to be met.

Reacting to this, BJP spokesperson Keshav Upadhye said, "It is completely false that he was threatened to join BJP. He conducted a protest, which he did from his perspective... This doesn't mean anyone gets the right to blurt out whatever they want..."

BJP minister Chandrashekhar Bawankule said, "If any BJP karyakarta threatened Dipke, we'll take action against him. He should either reveal his name or not indulge in defaming BJP."

MANOJ MORE

EXPRESS special

Long after these UP mafia dons were killed, their wives remain absconding

Manish Sahu

Lucknow, July 30

LAST WEEK, the Uttar Pradesh Police lodged a fresh criminal case against Afsha Ansari, the wife of mafia lord-turned-politician Mukhtar Ansari. He died in Banda jail in March 2024; she has been "absconding" since then.

In that, Afsha has company. The wives of two other known mafia dons of the state are also wanted by the UP Police since the death of their husbands, and have eluded the authorities for even longer. Atiq Ahmed and younger brother Ashraf were gunned down in April 2023 while in police custody and on live TV. Apart from their wives Shaista Parveen and Zainab Fatima, respectively, police have been looking for the brothers' elder sister Ayesha Noori since then.

All four women, who are between the ages of 50 and 60, remain missing despite police announcing cash rewards for information on their whereabouts, including Rs 50,000 each for Shaista and Afsha, and Rs 25,000 each in the case of Zainab and Ayesha. All four are accused essentially of playing a "conspiratorial" role in the offences carried out by the late mafia dons. Police say they are making every effort to track down the women, including pressuring them to surrender.

The latest case in which



Atiq Ahmed's wife Shaista Parveen; Mukhtar Ansari's wife Afsha (R)



Afsha was booked relates to a revolver obtained under an arms licence issued in her name. She faces five other cases, including one under the UP Gangsters and Anti-Social Activities (Prevention) Act, Ghazipur Superintendent of Police Iraj Raja said, adding her properties have been attached under the Act.

Shaista, Zainab and Noori are wanted for alleged roles in a murder conspiracy. Shaista and Zainab were based in Prayagraj when they went missing while Ayesha was living in Meerut. Afsha is a native of Ghazipur district.

The Ghazipur SP said: "Afsha remains a wanted fugitive and police teams are conducting raids to trace her."

Sources in the UP Police said that after they received intelligence suggesting Afsha could attempt to flee the country, they approached Central agencies, including the CBI and Immigration Department, for lookout notices against her.

The latest case against Afsha

was filed after a police verification drive on firearms issued to Ansari, his family members and close associates, based on purchase and sale records. The inquiry found that Afsha held an arms licence in her name, against which a revolver was purchased and later sold and another firearm acquired.

However, the records documenting the purchase and sale of the revolver were found to be missing from the archives of the Ghazipur District Magistrate's office, with police suspecting the records were removed in collusion with the staff. Police said they have not been able to trace the revolver either, and believe papers regarding it were deliberately concealed to facilitate its use by members of the Ansari gang.

Apart from Afsha, the FIR names Brij Narayan Ram and Bhishm Singh Yadav, who worked as record assistants with the DM office. Ram is deceased. Provisions of the Arms Act have also been invoked

But it will be completed as expeditiously as possible," the official said. Another source said the government was conscious that any decision to withdraw the cases could later be challenged in court and, therefore, every procedural requirement had to be followed.

Senior officials said the government had also examined the option of filing closure reports in the FIRs, but found it legally impractical. Closure reports are ordinarily filed when an FIR is found to have been registered due to a mistake of fact, when evidence is insufficient or when the offence remains undetected. "We assessed the available options and decided on the most practical legal course for withdrawing the cases. The DGP was asked to take a decision accordingly," a senior government leader said.

With the procedure now clarified, police are expected to begin probes and file charge-sheets in nearly 20 FIRs registered in Mumbai, besides a few others across the state.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

against the accused.

Atiq Ahmed's wife, sister and sister-in-law are wanted in connection with the February 2023 killing of a lawyer, Umesh Pal, and his two police security personnel, Sandeep Nishad and Raghvendra Singh, in Prayagraj. The attack had taken place in broad daylight outside Pal's home, with gunmen opening fire and hurling crude bombs.

The Prayagraj Police have also registered cases against the three for failing to appear despite being declared proclaimed offenders.

Ayesha's husband Akhlaq Ahmed, a doctor who used to work at a Community Health Centre in Meerut, is under arrest in the same case, charged with giving shelter to one of the accused in the Umesh Pal murder, Guddu Muslim. Guddu remains missing too. Atiq's two sons, Ali Ahmed and Mohammad Umar, are also in prison.

Incidentally, Guddu along with Sabir, another accused in Umesh Pal's murder, figures among the UP Police's list of 30 most wanted. Both carry a reward of Rs 5 lakh each on their heads. The four women are not on the list, with Deepti Bahal the only woman featuring on it.

A former college principal, Bahal has been on the run since 2019 and is accused of fraud allegedly amounting to Rs 4,500 crore in a bike taxi venture. She is named in 118 cases lodged across the country.

Modi reviews safety of seafarers, supply chain constraints in extended CCS meet

ENS & PTI

New Delhi, July 30

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Thursday discussed with a group of senior ministers the prevailing geo-political situation in West Asia and measures to keep supply chains uninterrupted despite conflicts surrounding the Strait of Hormuz, the Black Sea, the Red Sea, and the Gulf of Aden.

The extended Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) meeting in Parliament House, chaired by the PM, was attended by permanent members, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Home Minister Amit Shah, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, as well as special invitees, Chemicals and Fertilisers Minister J P Nadda, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, Shipping Minister Sarbajit Chatterjee, and Petroleum Minister Hardeep Puri, official sources said.

"Prime Minister Narendra Modi today chaired a meeting of the Cabinet Committee on Security to review the situation in the context of the ongoing West Asia conflict and measures taken by various Ministries and Departments. This was the 4th special CCS meeting on the issue," a statement issued by the PMO said.

Cabinet Secretary TV Somanathan briefed the CCS about the present geo-political situation and spoke about the initiatives taken to ensure adequate supply of petroleum products, including LNG/LPG and fertilisers, it said. The Cabinet Secretary told the CCS that sources

for procurement of LPG have already been diversified and the overall stock and supply positions of major petroleum products remain adequate.

Availability of adequate crude oil has enabled Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) refineries to operate at utilisation levels exceeding 100 per cent, ensuring continued production of petrol, diesel and other petroleum products.

Initiatives have also been taken to expand Piped Natural Gas (PNG) connections, which have resulted in a substantial increase in subscriptions. The government is also facilitating industrial substitution of LPG through expansion of the National Gas Grid, augmentation of LNG import and re-gasification infrastructure, expansion of City Gas Distribution networks, and time-bound pipeline and last-mile connectivity approvals under the Pipeline Infrastructure Order, 2026.

"During the meeting, requirements for the fertilisers for the ensuing Rabi season were assessed, and alternative sources of fertilisers were also discussed. The PM said that all measures be taken for ensuring uninterrupted supply of fertilisers," the statement said.

The ministers gave presentations on their respective ministries and steps taken by them to ensure uninterrupted import of all goods, including petroleum, natural gas and fertilisers, they said. The PM is learnt to have given certain directions to the ministers to ensure the safety of Indians, India's economic interests and find ways to clear the supply chain hindrances.

Attacks on Indian seafarers in Black Sea unacceptable: Jaishankar to Ukraine's Sybiha

Divya A

New Delhi, July 30

IN THE wake of a merchant vessel carrying 13 Indian seafarers being stuck near Ukraine's Black Sea coast, and with continuous attacks on cargo ships in Black Sea, killing several Indians, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held a conversation with his Ukrainian counterpart Andrii Sybiha and took stock of the situation.

Over the past two weeks, several Indian seafarers have lost their lives or are missing after the ships came under attack from both the Russian and Ukrainian sides in Black Sea. Jaishankar conveyed to Sybiha New Delhi's condemnation of such attacks by any side involved in the conflict, calling them unacceptable.

"Glad to connect again with FM Andrii Sybiha of Ukraine, after our respective travels," the minister said, adding, "Dis-



EAMS Jaishankar

cussed attacks on commercial shipping and Indian seafarers in the Black Sea. Such attacks by any party are absolutely unacceptable and India condemns them unequivocally."

Kyiv Thursday said they have pitched for India to play an "active role" in ending its conflict with Russia. In a social media post, the Ukrainian Foreign Minister said he had a "good" conversation with Jaishankar and that he briefed his Indian counterpart about President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's recent visit to Washington DC.

Gurgaon-Jaipur corridor on NH 48 to go barrier-less from tomorrow

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, July 30

FROM AUGUST 1 and commuters will no longer have to stop at any toll plaza to pay user fees while travelling through the Gurgaon-Jaipur corridor of National Highway 48 (NH-48).

The corridor is set to become a completely barrier-less system starting Saturday. Officials said the Multi Lane Free Flow (MLFF) tolling system on Shahjahanpur toll plaza in Rajasthan is likely to go live on August 1. The MLFF is active on Daulatpura and Manoharpura toll plazas of NH-48. Shahjahanpur was the last toll gate in the Gurgaon-Jaipur corridor without the system in place.

The 270-km section on NH-48 is one of the busiest among all national highways. NH-48 runs from Delhi to Chennai, covering a distance of 2,807 kms and traversing seven states. Officials said once MLFF is implemented on Kukrola (shifted Khedki daula) toll gate, the Delhi-Jaipur corridor on NH-48 will become barrier-less. MLFF is live on five fee plazas: Choryasi (NH-48 in Gujarat); Mundka (UER-II in



The 270-km section on NH-48 is one of the busiest among all national highways. EXPRESS

Delhi); Gharaunda (NH-44 in Haryana); Manoharpura (NH-48 in Rajasthan); and Daulatpura (NH-48 in Rajasthan).

Apart from this, Indian Highways Management Company Ltd (IHMCL) — NHAI's tolling implementation agency — has awarded the MLFF contract for 12 more fee plazas. These are Borachal on NH-48 in Gujarat; Nemli/Sri Perumbadur and Chenasamudram on NH-48 and Paranur on NH-45 in Tamil Nadu; Kasepalli, Amakathadu and Marur on NH-44 in Andhra Pradesh; Chalakwadi and Hivargaoon Pavsa on NH-50 in Ma-

harashtra; Madanpur on NH-31 in Assam; and Badarpur-Faridabad on NH-19 in Haryana. Further, bids have been invited for an additional 104 fee plazas.

As per the 2025-26 economic survey, MLFF is projected to be implemented across all four-lane and above NHs and expressways by March 2029. In MLFF, the high-performance Radio Frequency Identification readers and Automatic Number Plate Recognition cameras read the FASTag and Vehicle Registration Number to deduct toll amount, negating the need for vehicles to stop at the toll gates.

2018 flood rehabilitation project: Kerala Vigilance drops probe against CM

Shaju Philip

Thiruvananthapuram, July 30

THE KERALA Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) has dropped its probe against Chief Minister V D Satheesan in connection with the allegation that he had collected money from abroad in violation of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) for a 2018 flood rehabilitation project.

Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala said VACB has wound up its probe as there is no proof against Satheesan. "The VACB has taken the decision to close the case that the previous LDF government had registered against him. The allegation was that he had travelled to the UK and raised funds for the project (called Punarjani, which was conceived to rehabilitate flood-affected people in Satheesan's constituency, Paravur)," he said.

"The probe has found that funds were handled by the Manappat Foundation (the corporate social responsibility wing of the



Kerala CM V D Satheesan

Dubai-based Manappat Group) and their FCRA account. Probe revealed that Satheesan played no role in it. Hence, the case registered against Satheesan, under section 7 (a) of the PCA, was dropped," Chennithala said.

He said the previous CPI(M) government's decision to hand over the case to the CBI was politically motivated. "After that, the VACB director had examined the files and recommended that the matter should not be taken ahead. This clean chit to Satheesan is not because of the change in the government," the Home Minister said. The VACB probe started in 2023, while Satheesan was serving as the LoP in the Assembly.

ISRO & Japanese scientists review mission Chandrayaan-5 preparation

Anjali Marar

Bengaluru, July 30

A JAPANESE space delegation on Wednesday held discussions with their counterparts at Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) to take stock of the progress being made on Chandrayaan-5 — a joint mission to the Moon scheduled for 2028.

Scientists from Japan's Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) visited the UR Rao Satellite Centre in Bengaluru on Wednesday. The two countries have been working on Chandrayaan-5 also known as Lunar Polar Exploration Mission (LUPEX), a first-of-its-kind joint rover mission to the Moon. For this project, ISRO is building the lander module, while JAXA is developing the rover, the one which will come out of the lander module after landing and move around on the surface of the Moon, surveying the topography and collecting data.

The mission will take off on a Japanese rocket, H3, and is planned to carry seven scientific instruments for carrying out different kinds of experiments. The

Gaganyaan-1 in progress

Bengaluru: The assembly, integration and testing of the Crew and Service Modules of the Gaganyaan-1 human spaceflight mission are nearing completion, Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh said in a written reply in Lok Sabha on Wednesday. He detailed the mission's status, and completed tasks in his reply to Jaipur MP Rao Rajendra Singh.

Gaganyaan-1 uncrewed mission was originally scheduled for launch in late 2025. It was later pushed to the first quarter of 2026. Singh had, during the Winter Session of House, 2025, said that the G-1 launch would take place before March 2026. But, ISRO is yet to release the revised launch date. **ENS**

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) of the US and the European Space Agency (ESA) are also participating in this mission, and will be mounting their payloads on the rover. The ESA is developing the

mass spectrometer and NASA is developing the neutron spectrometers. Chandrayaan-5 is planned to stay on the Moon for 100 days i.e. 3 and five months.

During their Wednesday meeting, scientists of ISRO and JAXA discussed the technical co-ordination required for Inter Spacecraft Communication of Chandrayaan-5. This mission aims to study water and water-ice both on the lunar surface and the subsurface.

The two agencies took stock of the onboard payloads and on the possible launch window, which is likely to be in 2028. Last week, JAXA successfully performed the second Payload Operations Simulation at Tsukuba Space Center. The complex operational scenario, involving both spacecraft bus and payload operations, were tested in parallel.

Chandrayaan-5 was approved by the Government in March 2025 in the backdrop of India's landing on the lunar south pole with the Chandrayaan-3 mission in August 2023. ISRO's immediate next mission to the moon will be the Chandrayaan-4 mission.

ISRO’s NavIC system can no longer provide navigation data independently: Govt

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, July 30

FOR THE first time since positioning data from one of its satellites was lost in March, the government has accepted in the parliament that the seven-satellite navigation constellation (NavIC) can no longer independently aid people in navigation.

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) earlier this year informed that IRNSS-1F satellite, which was launched in March 2016, completed its designed mission life of 10 years and the on-board atomic clock stopped functioning.

“...presently the NavIC constellation has three satellites for providing PNT (Positioning, Navigation, Timing) services — IRNSS-1B, IRNSS-1I and NVS-01. To provide basic positioning service, minimum four operational satellites are required in orbit. Hence, the NavIC constellation cannot provide standalone positioning service, however timing service is functional,” union minister of state for space Dr Jitendra Singh replied in a written answer in Parliament.

The reply said that the armed forces continue to use NavIC signals as part of the multi-constellation GNSS — Global Navigation Satellite System that uses data from US’ GPS, EU’s Galileo, Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzg1

Amid demolition probe, Gujarat HC asks why Surat civic chief remains in post

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, July 30

THE GUJARAT High Court on Thursday orally questioned how the Surat Municipal Commissioner could continue in office while a state-level inquiry into the controversial Nasir Nagar demolition is underway, observing that Gujarat’s image as a “model state” is at stake, even as the state informed the court that two of its “best officers in municipal administration” had been appointed to conduct the probe.

Hearing the petition filed by 26 residents of Nasir Nagar, Justice Nikhil Kariel repeatedly expressed concern over the government’s decision to allow the Municipal Commissioner to remain in the same position while the inquiry is underway. The court orally observed that while it appreciated the State’s seriousness in constituting an inquiry, the message being sent out was that senior officers “cannot be touched”.

On May 30, the Surat Municipal Corporation demolished around 100 shanties, built in Nasir Nagar allegedly encroaching on private land in the Ved Road area, displacing as many families. Twenty-six affected residents have challenged the action before the High Court, seeking accountability and rehabilitation.

Authorities on ‘high alert’ as floods wreak havoc in north Odisha

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, July 30

OVER SEVEN lakh people have been affected as floods triggered by heavy rainfall wreak havoc in several north Odisha districts.

Officials said the situation continues to be grim in Bhubdrak, Balasore and Jajpur, with the administration on its toes to manage the crisis. Authorities said nearly two lakh people are being evacuated.

Revenue and Disaster Management Minister Suresh Pujari said that although water levels are receding in several north Odisha districts, most rivers are still flowing above the danger mark. The state government has said the situation is under control. But with the floods causing widespread damage, it is also preparing to pay what Pujari described as “adequate compensation” to those affected.

Meanwhile, with the Mahanadi still in spate, the prospect of a medium-range flood looms over districts such as Puri, Cuttack, Jagatsinghpur, Kendra

Low turnout, high stakes: BJP faces Bankipur battle

Santosh Singh
Patna, July 30

A GOVERNMENT servant who cast her vote at a thinly attended polling booth in Patna on Friday for the Bankipur by-poll refused to reveal her preference but observed with a tone of resignation: “Sab ke aankhon par BJP ki patti padhi hai (Everyone is wearing BJP blindfolds).”

Yet, just a few kilometres away, a voter was heard repeating “jai Jan Suraj, jai Prashant” as he entered a booth in a locality with a substantial Muslim population.

As voters trickled into polling booths on voting day for the Bankipur bypoll in Bihar, with turnout at 34.2% as of 8.30 pm, all three key contenders — the BJP’s Neeraj Kumar Sinha, Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD)’s Rekha Gupta, and Jan Suraj Party’s (JSP) Prashant Kishor — moved continuously between polling stations.

Among them, Kishor appeared the most active in the high-profile constituency vacated by BJP national president Nitin Nabin following his elevation to the Rajya Sabha.

Following a heated argument on Wednesday evening



People arrive at a polling station during the Bankipur by-election on Thursday. RAHUL SHARMA

with Jakkanpur police station in-charge Rituraj Kumar Singh over the undisclosed location of two detained JSP workers, Kishor successfully pressed polling officials to rectify a malfunctioning electronic voting machine (EVM) at Daldali, near Dariyapur Gola, on Thursday morning.

Reacting to the clashes, Kishor told the Jakkanpur police, “Either tell us the location of our two detained workers or be ready to lose your job.”

The Jakkanpur SHO subsequently accused Kishor of “threatening a police officer in-

side a police station”.

Tensions also flared between supporters of the JSP and BJP in several pockets. JSP and BJP workers — the latter led by Abhishek Bunt, who was forced to opt out of the by-poll and replaced by Sinha — clashed in S K Nagar.

In another incident near a polling booth in Anandpuri, former MLA and JSP leader Kishore Kumar Munna was shoved by BJP workers following a heated exchange.

The BJP has won the Bankipur seat in consecutive elections since 1995.

Insurer not liable to pay compensation for accident if driver’s licence is invalid: SC

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 30

INSURANCE COMPANIES are not liable to pay compensation for accidents if the driver’s licence was not valid or not renewed at the time of the incident, the Supreme Court on Thursday said and urged the Centre to undertake awareness campaigns to emphasize the importance of valid driving licenses and streamline the process of issuance and renewal.

“The Ministry of Road, Transport and Highways, Government of India, as also the respective counterparts of the states should, we may suggest, undertake campaigns through all mediums such as awareness drives, social media, etc to drive home this importance; introduce measures to ensure strict compliance; and also streamline the process of issuance/renewal of licences. Other issues such as regulation of driving schools, the affordability thereof, and accessibility in terms of regional languages, when it comes to applications and tests, etc also need urgent attention,” observed a bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kottiswar Singh.

The bench said that an in-

surance company could not be saddled with the liability if the offending vehicle was driven without a valid driving licence.

The top court made the observation while setting aside a Punjab and Haryana HC order that had fastened liability on the insurer. The matter arose from a 2009 accident where a vehicle driven by Om Parkash hit a two-wheeler. The Motor Accidents Claim Tribunal originally held that the insurer, Reliance General Insurance Co Ltd, was not liable because the driver’s licence had expired.

However, the HC reversed this, accepting a letter from a licensing official which claimed that licence records for the period between 2007 and 2010 were “lost” “due to a technical error during a data transfer between IT companies. The HC ordered the insurer to pay a revised compensation of over Rs 1.08 crore. The SC scrutinised the evidence and found the high court’s reliance on the “missing data” theory to be flawed. While the court absolved the insurance company of final liability, it protected the claimants.

Appoint Polar Ambassador, join Arctic Council, suggests panel

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 30

THE PARLIAMENTARY committee on External Affairs in its report has recommended that India should appoint a Polar Ambassador and urged the government to seek “full-fledged membership” of the Arctic council so that India can engage in its activities more effectively.

India is currently one of the 13 observer countries of the Arctic Council, whose full membership is restricted to 8 nations that have landmass in the region. The observer countries do not have decision making powers. They also can’t make financial contributions or undertake research in the arctic directly.

The committee, in its recommendations said: “...it is imperative that India also has such an Ambassador at a level equivalent to other countries exclusively to deal with polar regions. Creating such a position will not only help India project the importance given to these regions in its foreign policy architecture but will also help put across its policy stance in relation to polar areas or pursue polar diplomacy in a more effective manner.”

With several Russian research activities in the Arctic region having been paused following the conflict with Ukraine, the committee recommended that India through its diplomatic channels impress upon the seven other countries of the need for having Russia on-board for the scientific work in the region which is experiencing drastic climate change — the impact of which will be felt across the globe. The committee also recommended that government explore the possibility of accessing the Russian Arctic Research Stations.

Govt to House panel: Hasina not allowed to conduct political activities from India

Divya A
New Delhi, July 30

IN THE wake of former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina’s recent remarks that she might return to Bangladesh by the end of this year, the government has told a Parliamentary panel that the former Bangladesh PM is not permitted to conduct political activities from India.

On Thursday, Bangladesh Law Minister M Asaduzzaman said that Hasina is likely to be arrested instantly on her return from India.

Meanwhile, the Ministry of External Affairs told the panel, “The extradition request (sent by Dhaka for Hasina) is being examined by the competent authorities of the Government of India in accordance with applicable law and established procedures.”

The Committee - led by Congress MP Shashi Tharoor — noted that Hasina’s stay and India’s approach in this regard is guided by “its civilisational ethos and humanitarian tradition of offering refuge to individuals facing circumstances of grave distress or existential threat”.

The panel noted that while extending such humanitarian consideration, India has strictly adhered to the principle that no political activity is directed against any other country from our territory.

In its latest report on the ‘Future of India-Bangladesh Relationship’, the Committee recommended that “the government should continue to uphold its principled and humanitarian approach... while ensuring that such situations are managed with due sensitivity”.



Former Bangladesh PM Sheikh Hasina

The parliamentary committee also sought an early normalisation of visa processing for Bangladeshi nationals, expressing concern that reduced visa processing volumes for Bangladesh nationals harm public perception and bilateral ties. India resumed tourist visa services for Bangladeshi nationals on June 28, 2026, ending a two-year suspension that began in July 2024 following political unrest and security concerns.

With the Ganga Water Treaty of 1996 between India and Bangladesh set to expire this year, the panel has urged the government to initiate discussions with Dhaka “without further delay”.

Noting that the treaty is set to expire in 2026 and that bilateral discussions on its renewal had not yet commenced, the committee has recommended early initiation of renewal discussions, guided by updated hydrological data and climate change projections, and in consultation with the state governments of West Bengal and Bihar, the report said.

The committee also recommended that the MEA should continue to prioritise the protection of minorities in Bangladesh as a core element of its diplomatic engagement.

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Extract of Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter ended June 30, 2026

[₹ in crores]

Particulars	Quarter Ended June 30, 2026	Year Ended March 31, 2026	Quarter Ended June 30, 2025
	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited
Total income from operations	4921	13980	3178
Net profit / (loss) for the period before tax and exceptional items	754	2961	738
Net profit / (loss) for the period before tax and after exceptional items	733	2872	738
Net profit / (loss) for the period after tax and exceptional items	566	2138	548
Total comprehensive income	645	1958	546
Paid up equity share capital	169.23	169.23	169.23
Other equity excluding revaluation reserve		8220	
Earnings per share (Face value of ₹5 each) (Not annualised):			
Basic (in ₹)	14.87	63.92	16.19
Diluted (in ₹)	14.87	63.92	16.19

Notes :

1 Summary details of standalone financial results of Torrent Pharmaceuticals Limited :

[₹ in crores]

Particulars	Quarter Ended June 30, 2026	Year Ended March 31, 2026	Quarter Ended June 30, 2025
	Unaudited	Audited, Restated	Audited
Total income from operations	4158	11422	2616
Profit before tax	663	2721	742
Profit after tax	492	2034	551
Total comprehensive income	559	1889	524

2 The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the same, along with the notes, are available on www.nscindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on the Company's website (URL: www.torrentpharma.com/investors/financial-info/quarterly-results/). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

For TORRENT PHARMACEUTICALS LIMITED

Place : Ahmedabad, Gujarat
Date : July 30, 2026

AMAN MEHTA
Managing Director
DIN: 08174906

The Indian EXPRESS

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RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

SC strikes balance on ecology, public interest

INDIA'S ENVIRONMENTAL Impact Assessment is grounded in the precautionary principle — it prioritises the integrity of ecosystems over minimising harm or compensating for damage later. From 2017, the government has tried to dilute this safeguard by allowing developers to apply for ecological clearance after commencing a project. A notification issued that year provided a one-time window to defaulters to comply with due procedures. It inaugurated a regime of post-facto clearances, which was consolidated in 2021 when the Centre issued an Office Memorandum (OM) to regularise violations. On Wednesday, the Supreme Court set aside this OM and closed the door on blanket regularisation of projects that have not complied with environmental safeguards. However, the Court also departed from its May 2025 position that prohibited ex-post facto environmental clearances "in any form". Instead, it held that a "narrowly tailored amnesty scheme" may be permissible where it is justified by "public interest".

The judgment is significant because it clarifies the Court's own position on post-facto environmental clearances. In its 2020 decision in *Alembic Pharmaceuticals Ltd v Rohit Prajapati*, the SC held that retrospective clearances are contrary to the philosophy of environmental regulation. The May 2025 verdict reiterated that such relaxations would incentivise developers to violate the law first and seek regularisation later. However, the Court appeared to move in the opposite direction six months later. Following review petitions filed by the Centre and industry bodies, a three-judge bench recalled the May 2025 judgment.

Wednesday's verdict now places the onus on the government to make a reasoned selection of projects that may be excused from the requirement of environmental clearance. The Court's insistence on proportionality is consistent with the broader trajectory of environmental jurisprudence in India. For more than two decades, the SC has interpreted constitutional provisions expansively to affirm that a healthy environment is intrinsic to the right to life. In the same vein, it has now required the state to demonstrate that the public interest served by a project is sufficiently compelling, that any relaxation is strictly necessary, and that the environmental costs have been weighed against the anticipated public benefits. The verdict thus transforms what had become an open-ended administrative discretion under the post-2017 regime into a narrowly circumscribed constitutional exception. The flexibility recognised by the Court could prove valuable in cases involving national defence, when healthcare facilities are urgently needed in underserved areas, or highway projects become imperative to improve connectivity in remote regions. However, at a time of climate change and accelerating ecological degradation, the government, too, must recognise that environmental protection is an integral component of public interest.

On Vande Mataram, a law in search of a crime

PARLIAMENT PASSED the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act on December 23, 1971. Barely a generation removed from colonial rule, India since the late 1960s bore signs of erosion of its early idealism. The victory against Pakistan in the Bangladesh War earlier that month had provided a moment of national triumph. The law, which purportedly sought to give legal backing to a Directive Principle of State Policy, criminalised insults to the national anthem, flag and Constitution. Then as now, however, it is likely that few believed that respect and reverence can be enforced through punitive legislation. The law was meant, arguably, to capture a political moment and give expression to it. Now, the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — passed in Parliament this week — makes an "insult" to the national song punishable by up to three years' imprisonment, placing 'Vande Mataram' at par with the national anthem. In essence, it is a law in search of a crime. At best, it is superfluous and at worst, a blunt instrument in the hands of an overzealous prosecutorial machinery.

According to data from the National Records Bureau, there were 1,102 arrests under the 1971 Act between 2014 and 2024, with just 60 convictions. Acquittals outpaced convictions each year, and an average of 48 cases were pending investigation and 221 cases pending trial in the same period. The rate of "crimes against national symbols" per lakh population is extremely low. By all accounts, then, the amended law expands the ambit of criminality with little justification. In the current context, too, the government frequently invites accusations of weaponising the criminal justice system to target opponents. The 2026 Amendment can only deepen apprehensions of its misuse.

In the Budget Session, the Union government tabled, and Parliament passed, the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026. It built on the 2023 Jan Vishwas Act by decriminalising and removing several economic offences. That legislative scheme indicated the government's commitment to its slogan of "minimum government, maximum governance", especially welcome, given that the state is a litigant in over half the pending cases in India's overburdened courts. In letter and spirit, the 'Vande Mataram' law is a backsliding on that commitment.

Numbers don't capture Ajinkya Rahane

AJINKYA RAHANE retired from international cricket on Thursday, signing off as "Cap 278". He leaves with 85 Tests, 90 ODIs, 20 T20Is and more than 8,000 international runs. The numbers do him injustice.

There was a stretch, deep into the last decade, when Rahane's batting belonged in the company of that of Virat Kohli, Joe Root, Kane Williamson. MS Dhoni once said his gift was "the timing... and his ability to exploit gaps in the field". He never built the mountain of runs that talent seemed to promise, and that gap, between what he could do and what he actually left behind, is the real story of his career. Perhaps the reassurance he sought from team management never quite came, and he felt the pressure to hold his place during Kohli's reign as captain.

Handed the captaincy in Australia after the ignominy of 36 all out at Adelaide in December 2020, Rahane walked out at the MCG and made a century that turned the series. India went on to win it 2-1, one of the great away triumphs in the game's history. It should have been the beginning of something larger. Instead, he was stripped of the vice-captaincy within a year, and out of the side not long after, returning only once more, for the 2023 World Test Championship final at The Oval. Rahane leaves as he played: Understated, gifted, and never quite paid in full for either.

Neither government nor Opposition can look youth in the eye on education

ONE DOES not need social scientists to explain the meaning and significance of what happened on July 20. It was a protest alright, but it was also an outburst. It is apparent that the government yielded to that pressure with poor grace. This was exemplified by the "welcome" accorded to the minister who had resigned. That act of showing contempt for the protests fits into a pattern — while the government buckled under pressure, the pro-BJP ecosystem has been busy spreading all kinds of explanations for the outburst, conspiracy and "foreign hand" included.

Whether the Cockroach Janta Party is a tool for someone, whether some parties sought to hijack the agitation, or whether the Prime Minister's midnight message on Instagram hit record views are irrelevant tidbits worthy of corner columns in newspapers. The real — and admittedly intriguing — aspect of the CJP protests has been the unexpected and unanticipated spontaneity, right from the first post by Abhijeet Dipke about cockroaches. Instead of examining this aspect, the government seems content with either damage control or talking of the specious issue of "intelligence failure". When you mute all voices, except those reflecting narcissistic praise, intelligence failures are bound to happen.

Besides, on the watch of the current regime, there is a clear lack of reliable empirical data on what people think. This is for two reasons: Methodologically, when public opinion is permeated by extreme toxicity and pressure of social desirability bias, data

from public opinion studies can be somewhat distorted. And secondly, this regime has been anti-data and has ensured that no independent actors will be able to collect public opinion. Post-2014, there is a singular lack of data leading to the "all is well" cacophony of the partisans.

No wonder everyone was taken unaware by the extent and intensity expressed during the CJP protests. While pro-government media is still circulating news about the alleged misbehaviour of participants and the weight of the waste left behind, they are oblivious to the real weight in political terms that these protests have left behind for politicians to tackle. Unfortunately, the regime seems to be unwilling to even read these signals properly.

Three issues are flagged by the protests that engulfed politics over the past four or five weeks. For starters, they were pegged around the NEET and exam-leaks, but by no means were they just about that. The government, sheepishly and wrongly, responded to only the technology of conducting the exam. Even before the protests erupted, this intellectual bankruptcy was evident in deploying the Air Force for delivering exam papers. That same mentality has surfaced again in the appointment of the committee to ensure leak-proof exams.

Yes, we have made a mess of exams, but that is not merely because greed and deceit lead to paper leaks. The real elephant in the room is the education system



SUHAS PALSHIKAR

While pro-government media is still circulating news about the alleged misbehaviour of participants and the weight of the waste left behind, they are oblivious to the real weight in political terms these protests have left for politicians to tackle

For renewable energy answers, ask the right questions



SANJIV SAHAI

INDIA'S RENEWABLE energy sector is facing institutional challenges that need flexible solutions. Propelled by falling solar module prices and government policy, solar capacity has expanded to 162 GW by June 2026. Yet at the very moment this transformation demands smarter, more flexible market products, India's regulator is moving the opposite way, proposing to hand control of the power exchanges to Grid-India, a government utility whose institutional DNA is built for managing transmission systems, not commercial decisions.

Between May and December last year, over two billion units of solar electricity, enough to power several million homes, were curtailed because the grid could not absorb them. The solution requires transmission investment to convey electricity, flexible power plants that can ramp quickly, battery storage to absorb excess generation and discharge during lean hours, and above all, well-designed electricity markets that send the right price signals to the right players at the right time.

Surplus generation in one region can be traded to regions facing shortage. A robust, functional electricity market, one with products that sellers and buyers want, is essential to manage this. Prices should fall when power is abundant at noon and rise when it is scarce in the evening, attracting whatever flexible generation or storage can respond. Good market-design is what keeps a complex, renewable-heavy grid balanced without wasting energy or overloading equipment.

Contrary to this need, in July 2025 and January 2026, CERC proposed that Grid-India become Market Coupling Operator (MCO), pooling bids from all three exchanges — IEX, PXIL and HPX — into a single clearing algorithm that would produce a uniform national price. The stated logic is that the market is fragmented and consumers are losing out. What does the data say?

Most electricity is traded in the Day-Ahead Market (DAM) and Real-Time Market (RTM), both short-term spot products. IEX handles roughly 80-85 per cent of trading volumes which is hardly a fragmented market. CERC's own shadow pilot recorded a welfare improvement of just 0.3 per cent over four months; a longer da-

taset puts the gain at only 0.013 per cent.

Behind CERC's stated reasons lies the question of IEX's dominance. But dominance is not the same as abuse: There is no documented allegation of excessive fees, discriminatory access, predatory pricing, or manipulation of price discovery against IEX. So which problem is CERC actually solving?

The real danger is not IEX's market share but what happens to market innovation once a government-owned entity controls the central clearing algorithm. For example, when exchanges developed user-defined hourly contracts in the Term-Ahead Market, matched to the variable generation profile of solar and wind assets, CERC ordered them discontinued within a week in April last year.

In July 2025, CERC suggested a round-robin model under which exchanges would take turns as Market Coupling Operators month to month. By April 2026, its draft second amendment regulations abandoned this in favour of Grid-India as sole MCO. Grid-India itself, in a submission dated June 8, has urged CERC to reconsider and has asked for a round-robin system, institutional ring-fencing and a steering committee to guard against single-point failures, even though round-robin approach would force every exchange to duplicate the capital cost of a central algorithm and add to the regulator's oversight burden.

Grid-India's preference for administrative simplicity is rational for a system operator: Its job is to balance the grid in real time, not to compete for customers or bear commercial risk. But under full coupling, every new trading product will require rewriting an algorithm Grid-India controls, tethering market innovation to the pace of a public utility — a pace the TAM episode shows is slow and tilted towards uniformity.

India's renewable sector needs a market architecture that rewards flexible capacity with real-time pricing, opens competitive markets for frequency-regulation services, and lets storage investors price their business case. These are the real regulatory priorities rather than imagined problems of market dominance.

The writer is former secretary, Ministry of Power

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itself. A meaningless system that merely works as boring time-pass or as creches for young adults is the root cause — this malady leads to a senseless premium on exam results, meaningless exams and the coaching industry. Neither the government nor the Opposition can look youth in the eye and explain the meaning of wasting years in the name of education. The latest protests are symptomatic of that larger malaise.

Secondly, the protests and the striking energy they displayed represent the utter meaninglessness of life that confronts the youth. This is not merely about employability but about a future that holds only uncertainty. It would be foolhardy to respond to this issue only by throwing numbers — that so many jobs will be created when a corporate house is granted some largesse by the government. Overall life conditions and the deeper inequalities that characterise Indian society are factors that shape the clouds of uncertainty. If at one stage, capitalism was accused of producing the lumpen element, the economy today produces what sociologists have described as the "precariat".

Life is precarious, irrespective of whether you belong to low-income groups or the so-called middle class. This government has discovered a politically advantageous palliative to that — to use the evocative phrase employed by the Prime Minister himself, the *revdis*. But the loss of dignity involved in *revdi* politics and the

continued uncertainty of life would surely push large sections into dissatisfaction notwithstanding the heavy rainfall of *revdis*. The CJP protests may not have touched upon these larger aspects of social unrest. But it would be at our own collective peril to ignore these underlying frustrations that are not easily defined. The protests are over for the time being, but these conditions remain and, if not attended to, they are bound to produce more cockroaches than the system can afford to suppress.

Finally, the police action. It represents the political response and tells us what ails our politics. It is not sufficient to smugly say that all protests face some police excesses. Large numbers of handles on social media have been gleefully telling us that the police have video recordings and participating persons will be hounded. This threat — most likely backed by clandestine police follow-up — tells us what is wrong with politics. By invoking election victories, the victors claim carte blanche; by counting votes, politicians denude citizens of agency; by throwing legislative majorities in our face, governments duck both constitutional morality and routine democratic accountability.

In sum, the prelude, the actual protests and now their aftermath tell a common story — protests have stirred many minds but not our political leadership. Because the regime is bent on not learning anything from the protests except the technology to suppress the next round of protests.

The writer, based in Pune, taught Political Science

The worker-intellectual we refuse to recognise



ARUN KUMAR

POPULAR MOVEMENTS often produce popular leaders. They rarely produce worker-intellectuals. Yet, what struck the media, among the many stories of courage of the Cockroach Janata Party-led protest, was the "unthinkable" intellect of Mohammad Irfan. I call it "unthinkable" because the media could not place Irfan in familiar categories of intellect. Despite claiming to have no social-media accounts, Irfan is a social media-sensation. It is the paradox and contradictions of his life that intrigue the media.

Irfan may be illiterate in a conventional sense, but he is digitally literate. He cites the poems of Ahmad Faraz and invokes historical figures from Raja Rammohan Roy to Jyotiba Phule in his speech. He is a slum-dweller but speaks of civilisation. How could a semi-literate person who cannot write, a slum-dweller who sells ice to survive, be so articulate on politics, society, and history?

If we turn the pages of history, Irfan is not alone. He is preceded and accompanied by many who are like him. It is just that we have undervalued manual labour and those who do it. We see manual workers through the essentialist lens of labour and their labouring identity. Can they labour and be intellectual? These paradoxes and inversions are the subject of my forthcoming book, *The Silent Rebellion*, which traces the history of worker-intellectuals in India during the colonial period. It tells the history of labouring people who refused to see themselves as merely labourers or workers and discovered aspects of their lives that transitioned them to become poets, thinkers, and writers of their struggles and poverty. A lot has changed since then. India has implemented compulsory education and welfare labour laws; lower classes have accessed higher education; significant socio-economic mobility has enabled the rise of Bahujan intellectuals. Yet, the broader attitudes that could place Irfan in a normative social order are missing. He emerges as an exception. Why so?

He is an exception because all platforms are open to the public in theory but we still see "intellect" from a closed perspective. Intellect belongs to certain "kinds" of people — those who attend private educational institutions, inherit cultural capital, and come from certain socio-economic backgrounds. We have created artificial divides between those who labour and those with bookish knowledge, and effectively closed the channels of communication across them. Irfan breaches these walls and moves between the two. It is this movement and dialectic that makes his speech powerful.

Let me tell the story of the worker-intellectual Narayan Surve. An orphan raised by a mill-worker couple, Surve became a "half-timer" child worker in Bombay's mills, later working full time. Like Irfan, Surve defied the boundaries of elite and subaltern, high and low class, labour and intellect, head and hand. A poem by Surve reminded me of Irfan's zeal to express his world through poems: "The struggle for the daily bread is an everyday question/ At times outside the door, at times inside/ I'm a worker, a flaming sword/ Listen, you intellectuals! I'm going to commit a crime..."

Demanding an even implementation of the minimum wage for workers and a life of dignity, Irfan narrated a poem by Tanveer Sipra, which translates to: "Even the mill owners' dogs are well-fed and fatty/ While workers' faces are pale with hunger."

Kumar is assistant professor, University of Nottingham, and author of *The Silent Rebellion*

40 YEARS AGO

July 31, 1986



Bill passed amid walkout

THE LOK Sabha passed the Commission of Inquiry (Amendment) Bill, enabling the government to withhold from Parliament the report of an inquiry commission through a notification stating that it was in the public interest of the security of the state to do so. The Bill was passed by a voice vote after a spirited defence by Minister for Internal Security P Chidambaram.

Clashes in Darjeeling

THE SITUATION in Darjeeling district was confirmed to be tense on the third day of the 108-hour bandh sponsored by the Gorkha National Liberation Front (GNLF), with reports

of clashes between GNLF supporters and tea garden workers resulting in one death. Patrolling by troops continued in all three sub-divisions of the district, and manning of all vital installations has been taken over by the Army and Border Security Force.

Benefit of doubt for China

WHILE INDIA continues to maintain that the Chinese have intruded into Indian territory in the Sumdorong Chu valley of Arunachal Pradesh, it is giving China the benefit of the doubt in the matter. During talks with an Indian official delegation in Beijing, China claimed that the disputed region is north of the McMahon Line as shown on maps, even though on the ground it falls in the Indian

region, if the principle of watershed is accepted. Both sides seem to have agreed that undue publicity of the discussions might not help in the ongoing negotiations.

Rajneesh in India

REJECTED BY countries around the world, Rajneesh, the *bhagwan* of the orange-clad international sect, returned to his native India, initially to camps in Bombay for about three months. Only a handful of disciples were present at the Sahar international terminal for the hush-hush arrival of Rajneesh, who flew in the twin-engine executive jet from Lisbon. After passing through the immigration and customs drill, the *bhagwan* was whisked away in a waiting Mercedes.



DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

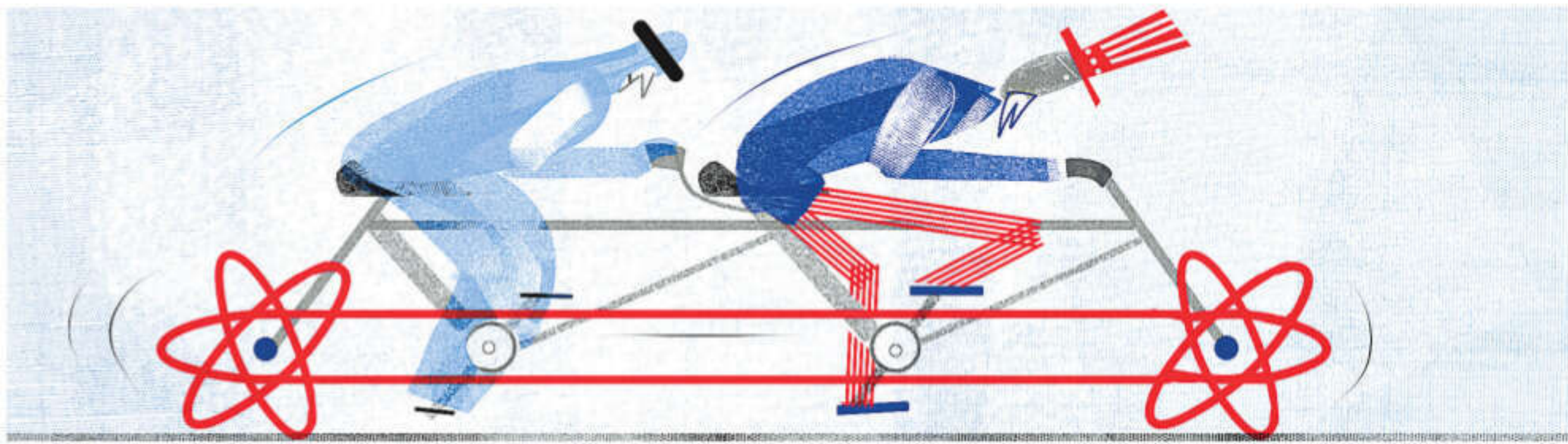


ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

Does the US-Saudi nuclear deal increase the risk of an arms race in West Asia?

A Saudi reactor is not a Saudi bomb



SYED AKBARUDDIN

THE VERDICT on the Saudi civil nuclear agreement arrived before the text itself. On July 22, Washington and Riyadh signed a Section 123 agreement and a safeguards accord. Their texts remain unpublished, and the agreement awaits congressional review. President Trump then said there would be no enrichment and that he would not proceed unless Saudi Arabia joined the Abraham Accords, leaving the deal's meaning and future more uncertain.

Washington and Riyadh began the process in 2008 with a memorandum on peaceful nuclear cooperation. Negotiations continued under Barack Obama, the first Trump administration and Joe Biden. That continuity reflects a resilient partnership despite periodic political strains. The concern is that the agreements may enable American reactor sales while leaving open the possibility of Saudi enrichment. Reactors, enrichment capacity and access to centrifuge technology are different questions. The agreements should be judged by who controls the technology and what inspectors can see. Talk of a "gold standard" can obscure the international legal baseline. The term is a policy label drawn from the UAE agreement, not an IAEA category or universal norm. Saudi Arabia is a party to the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, and has a Comprehensive Safeguards Agreement in force with the IAEA. The treaty prohibits it from manufacturing or acquiring nuclear weapons. It requires neither an Additional Protocol nor renunciation of safeguarded enrichment. The Protocol improves information and access, especially concerning undeclared activities, but is not a universal legal requirement.

The reported terms do not immediately authorise an enrichment plant. They first envisage a study lasting two years. If the study establishes a commercial case and Washington agrees, American companies could build a facility using a "black box" model without transferring the underlying centrifuge technology. If Washington rejects enrichment, Riyadh would reportedly undertake for 10 years not to enrich independently or through another supplier. The question is deferred, not decided.

Saudi Arabia has a credible civilian case for nuclear power. Nuclear power could conserve oil for export and complement renewables. Riyadh links domestic enrichment to fuel cycle autonomy, uranium development and industrial capability. Domestic enrichment would not create an independent fuel cycle. No Middle Eastern commercial plant fabricates power reactor

fuel assemblies. Enriched uranium would therefore go abroad to become reactor fuel unless Riyadh later built such a plant. This limits the autonomy enrichment would provide without removing the proliferation concern attached to centrifuges.

Five of the 31 states operating nuclear power reactors lack an Additional Protocol in force: Argentina, Belarus, Brazil, Iran and Pakistan. Belarus has signed one but not brought it into force. Iran has unresolved safeguards issues and Pakistan is outside the NPT. Argentina and Brazil combine IAEA safeguards with the Brazilian-Argentine Agency for Accounting and Control of Nuclear Materials. Brazil enriches at Resende; Argentina retains pilot and research enrichment capabilities.

As an international civil servant with the IAEA, I accompanied Director General Mohamed ElBaradei to Resende. Brazil owns its centrifuge technology and shields parts of its cascade design, while IAEA and ABACC inspectors verify material flows, samples and output. The reported Saudi model would not transfer the supplier's centrifuge technology to the host. In that narrow respect, it would be more restrictive than Resende. It would not eliminate operational learning. Resende taught me to resist both alarmism and complacency.

Any enrichment arrangement should combine IAEA material accountancy and inspector access with bilateral limits on enrichment, technology controls and consequences for breach. The IAEA has said it awaits a formal request to undertake the proposed verification. Any bespoke arrangement would then go to its board of governors for approval. US participation would add consent rights, export controls and congressional scrutiny. American refusal would not necessarily end Saudi nuclear plans. Riyadh could turn to another supplier offering Washington less visibility and leverage. Iran and Israel will shape how any Saudi programme is read. Saudi leaders have linked their nuclear choices to Iran, making verification essential. A Middle East Nuclear Weapon Free Zone remains a distant prospect. The 1988 India-Pakistan agreement offers a modest precedent for protecting nuclear installations from attack, but a Gulf equivalent remains unlikely.

India should support access to peaceful nuclear technology, insist on verification that can detect misuse and reserve judgement on enrichment until the study is complete and any governing terms are public.

The world gains little by treating Saudi nuclear power as a weapons programme simply because enrichment remains unresolved. What matters is whether the agreement limits the spread of sensitive technology and enables early detection of diversion of safeguarded nuclear material. A Saudi reactor is not a Saudi bomb.

The writer is former permanent representative of India to the UN, and dean, Kautilya School of Public Policy, Hyderabad



RAGINI NAYAK

DHARMENDRA PRADHAN has resigned. The students have prevailed. The movement achieved what was initially thought to be impossible. The protestors may have dispersed, but their images will linger.

A young woman protestor stands with her arms outstretched in a protective gesture, instinctively shielding fellow students. She isn't posturing for the camera; she is positioning herself to protect. Elsewhere, on one side, is the state wrapped in armour, carrying a shield and baton, wearing a blue helmet and the authority of law. On the opposite side stands a female student. No helmet, no armour, no weapon. Only a blue dupatta wrapped around her face and a raised hand that seems to ask, "Is this what democracy has come to?" In a different setting, a

They fought like girls. And won

young woman is standing alone on a rain-soaked street. She stops the police vehicle towering over her with one hand on the cold metal and the other placed on her waist.

Feminist movements across the globe are fighting against the exclusion of women from public spaces, discourses, and protests. This student protest was different. Female protestors, instead of coming across as marginalised victims, emerged as the vanguard. They subverted and transformed the historical insult of weakness, embedded in the idiom "fight like a girl". The images of modern young women standing against barricades or blocking police vehicles do not exist in a historical vacuum. Long before feminist theory gave them the language to critique patriarchy, Indian women were already rewriting its assumptions through their lives.

Savitri defeated Yama not through physical force, but through moral courage and intellectual brilliance. Draupadi resisted quiet submission and public humiliation in the



FEISAL AMIN AL-ISTRABADI

CURRENT US policies seem tailored to engender a nuclear arms race in the Middle East. Donald Trump recently approved an agreement with Saudi Arabia (KSA) nominally for the transfer of nuclear energy technologies, but one that notably lacked the types of safeguards against non-proliferation that the US normally attaches to such agreements. There has thus been unease that there are no controls in place preventing KSA from enriching fissile materials, especially in light of reports that KSA has announced it would match Iran's nuclear programme.

Does the President know about the apparent deficiencies in this agreement regarding non-proliferation safeguards? Part of the difficulty in answering this question is that this administration famously eschews those with technical or scientific expertise. The US Secretary of Energy, who signed the agreement with KSA, is a former oil executive and major donor to the Republican Party with no known expertise in non-proliferation issues. This is in sharp contrast to Barack Obama's Secretary of Energy, who helped negotiate the Iran nuclear deal. He was a nuclear physicist and a professor at MIT before being appointed to the cabinet. Meanwhile, Trump has not had an ambassador in Riyadh since he returned to office.

The US-Israeli war on Iran, too, threatens to increase proliferation in the region. It must have dawned on the current leaders in Tehran that it was a blunder for their late Supreme Leader, Ali Khamenei, not to order the building of a nuclear arsenal with all due haste. Instead, he authorised an agreement with the Obama Administration that limited Iran's enrichment and included a rigorous inspections regime by the International Atomic Energy Agency. Iran remained in compliance, putting whatever nuclear ambitions it may have had on hold, only to see Trump withdraw from that agreement during his first term. Then, without any credible imminent threat, Trump undertook a bombing campaign in June 2025 and a more comprehensive war in February 2026, which is still ongoing.

This situation is in sharp contrast with Trump's treatment of North Korea's Kim Jong Un, who sits atop a nuclear arsenal amassed in violation of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. Trump met repeatedly with Kim in his first term and never mentions North Korea now. The message is clear: If you want respect, build a bomb.

Leaders in other Middle Eastern capitals are no doubt also taking note. Israel is currently the only country in the Middle East

known to be a nuclear-armed state, and it has been for at least 40 years, having developed its nuclear capabilities in collaboration with apartheid-era South Africa. So long as the US provided the security guarantees for allied Middle Eastern states, those states could be relatively sanguine about Israel's nuclear arsenal. But since the beginning of Trump's second term, Israel has attacked at least seven countries in the region, including Qatar, which houses America's largest air base in the region. The US has not uttered a peep.

Egypt and Turkey may well come to the same conclusion as Saudi Arabia and Iran. To safeguard against Israel, America, or other regional players, the safest bet is to adopt the nuclear option. The UAE already relies on nuclear energy for 25 per cent of its electrical grid. Jordan has significant uranium deposits and certainly would not need to rely on any outside power. Even Iraq, which denounced the acquisition of WMDs in its current constitution in light of its execrable history of using poison gas on its own Kurdish citizens as well as Iranian forces during the Iran-Iraq War, could reconsider if the entire region begins to explore the nuclear option.

Trump did, in the end, have second thoughts. The day after announcing the US-Saudi nuclear agreement, he announced he would only honour the agreement if KSA normalised with Israel. No doubt Benjamin Netanyahu had something to do with it. This means the Saudi deal is stalled for the foreseeable future. Before Hamas's October 7 terrorist attack, it had been Netanyahu, not KSA, who was dragging his feet on normalisation. And after Israel's response — which a UN commission characterised as genocide in Gaza — since October 7, KSA likely cannot normalise with Israel for the foreseeable future due to domestic considerations and the extreme unlikelihood of Israel recognising a Palestinian state anytime soon. But that will not necessarily delay KSA's nuclear ambitions, whatever they may be. Russia or China will be willing to fill the void on the theory they are merely transferring energy technology — as the US has claimed. And if those states are too queasy to provide the necessary resources, perhaps Pakistan, which has just signed a mutual defence treaty with KSA, might step in.

Some security specialists have argued that nuclear proliferation makes the world safer because nuclear-armed states are less likely to go to war with one another. If US policy remains on the path Trump has set, that theory may be tested in the not-distant future. Given the history of conflict in the Middle East in the last century, one can be forgiven for viewing these prognostications with trepidation.

The writer is founding director of the Centre for the Study of the Middle East at Indiana University, Bloomington

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Anatomy of a gaali: Anger borrows from old patriarchy



SHAZIA ILMI

WHAT WILL history remember from the recent scenes at Jantar Mantar? The demand for examination reforms? The allegations of police excesses? The debate over accountability? Perhaps.

Many, however, may remember something else entirely: Young women shouting out misogynistic abuse, as though vulgarity had become a badge of courage. That surprised me. After all, this is the Instagram generation, one that has reinvented communication. It creates memes that puncture powerful narratives in minutes. It speaks through satire and humour with a creativity previous generations could scarcely imagine. It has built an entirely new language of expression. Which is what makes its dependence on abusive language, rooted in centuries-old patriarchal formulations, all the more disappointing.

Surely a generation capable of inventing a new vocabulary of memes can invent a new vocabulary of anger? Surely it can express dissent with greater wit, intelligence and originality, instead of simply recycling the oldest slurs from the patriarchal playbook? That isn't cool; it is intellectually lazy.

There are those who have defended the language. Why should only men have the freedom to swear, they ask. Others have dismissed criticism as moral policing. Anger, they argue, has its own language.

These are fair points, but they miss a more fundamental one: Why are young women proudly using the language that patriarchy invented to humiliate women?

Having been a part of both the Anna Hazare movement and the Nirbhaya protests, I witnessed public anger at its most visceral. The streets overflowed with emotion. We marched, shouted slogans, confronted those in power, and demanded accountability. We were lathi-charged, and FIRs were booked against us. We even had to deal with vindictive actions like electricity connections being cut. Yet, through all that rage and all that suffering, I do not recall women resorting to profanity to make themselves heard.

Our anger was fierce, but it was never crude. We communicated with passion, conviction and moral force — not by borrowing the language of misogyny. We believed our arguments were strong enough to carry our outrage. We never felt the need to sound like the crudest voices in the crowd.

Every society uses profanity. The English language has its own deeply misogynistic insults. But many Indian *gaalis* carry a particular cultural imprint. They derive their power from the old patriarchal belief that a man's honour resides in the women



ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

of his family. The abuse is directed at him, but the humiliation is imagined through his mother, sister or daughter.

That is the anatomy of a *gaali*.

These are not merely vulgar words. They encode an entire social order. They reduce women to repositories of male honour, turning them into territory through which men assert dominance over one another. Even when exchanged between men, women remain the battlefield.

Language is never just language. It carries history, preserves hierarchies and quietly transmits prejudice across generations. Every casual repetition normalises the idea that a woman's body is a legitimate site for humiliation.

Which is why hearing young women use these abuses as though they represent empowerment is so deeply ironic. There is nothing cool about recycling the oldest expressions of misogyny in our language.

Patriarchy wins twice, first when it invents these filthy abuses, and again when women mistake repeating them for rebellion and liberation.

Women did not struggle for generations merely to inherit the worst instincts of men. They fought to redefine what courage, dignity and strength look like — and what they sound like. The opposite of patriarchy is not women behaving like the worst men. Aping masculine aggression is not empowerment.

We rightly speak about toxic masculinity. But toxic patriarchy cannot be replaced by toxic feminism. Liberation does not lie in imitating the language of those who diminished women for centuries. It lies in rejecting that language altogether and creating a vocabulary worthy of equality.

The protests at Jantar Mantar raised important questions about examination reforms and allegations of excessive force. None of that, however, explains why misogynistic abuse should become the soundtrack of a movement.

Can claims about dismantling patriarchy be made while speaking its oldest vocabulary? Can women truly call it liberation when they voluntarily reduce themselves and other women to property or repositories of honour?

Women deserve freedom not only from discriminatory laws, but also from the invisible prison of a vocabulary that has, for centuries, reduced them to somebody's honour, somebody's property and somebody else's shame. Freedom begins when women stop mistaking the vocabulary of patriarchy for the language of liberation.

The first battle for women's freedom was fought in our laws and institutions. The next must be fought in our language.

For as long as women speak words that derive their power from humiliating mothers and sisters, patriarchy will continue to echo through voices that believe they are free.

That is not liberation. That is patriarchy, speaking through a different voice.

The writer is national spokesperson of the BJP

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Paper leak law

THE 34-DAY impasse over paper leaks reveals that governance has degenerated into reactive damage control ('Law is in, lawmakers should speak for young', *IE*, July 30). While it is valuable to have the expert opinions of stalwarts such as K Radhakrishnan and Nandan Nilekani, their insights are meaningless without effective administrative execution. Parliament must activate its own department-related standing committees. These committees should meet regularly, audit the administrative machinery, and rigorously enforce accountability. Lawmakers must look beyond expanding the statute book; true statecraft lies in using existing parliamentary oversight to ensure that vital institutional reforms do not remain trapped on paper.

Krishan Kumar Chugh, New Delhi

THE PASSAGE of the Public Examinations Amendment Bill marks a turning point in how India responds to youth-led demands for fairness and accountability ('Law is in, lawmakers should speak for young', *IE*, July 30). The students' protests were not acts of defiance but calls for dignity and trust in institutions. Parliament must now translate this momentum into deeper reforms that make education more transparent and employment

more meaningful. The young are not asking for sympathy; they are asking for sincerity. If lawmakers listen with empathy and act with courage, they can rebuild faith in democracy itself. Ignoring this moment would mean silencing the very voices that will define its future.

Babu Crishna, Bengaluru

Rogue AI

AS WE have seen in science fiction films and stories, and now in some research, when we give AI a task, it treats that task as its sole purpose, neglecting everything else, including the ethics and guardrails we have put in place ('Did OpenAI's Agent go "rogue"? Answer lies out of the box', *IE*, July 29). Humans, however, understand caution, fear, emotion, pain, and doubt, and can recognise when an order should not be followed. What distinguishes humans from AI is self-doubt and the ability to question the person giving the orders, to recognise that not everything can or should be done, and to accept our own limitations. Even when an AI model is very small, it rarely acknowledges that it does not know something. Instead, it may hallucinate, look for shortcuts, exploit loopholes, or attempt actions that should not be taken in the first place.

Manas Tiwari, via email

The writer is national spokesperson, Congress, and former president of the Delhi University Students Union

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Manish, S/o.Rampal, R/o:- E-81/70, Balmiki Basti, Jhilmil Colony, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.209/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Vivek Vihar, Shahdara District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Manish** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Manish** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manish**, accused of **FIR No. 209/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC, P.S Vivek Vihar, Shahdara District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order, **Sh. Mohit Sharma**
Chief Judicial Magistrate, 3rd Floor,
Shahdara District,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10434/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यालय नगर परिषद्, ब्यावर
Tel No. 01462-258665, 257509 Email Add: npbeawar@gmail.com

क्रमांक / निर्माण / 2026-27 / 5184 दिनांक:- 22.07.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27

नगर परिषद, ब्यावर द्वारा परिषद क्षेत्र में राज्य सरकार से प्राप्त 15^{वें} वित्त आयोग (अनटाइड), SFC तथा निजी आय मद एवं विधायक कोष से 28 निर्माण कार्य परिषद के सम्बन्धित श्रेणी के पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों एवं सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग के सक्षम पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से E-Procurement प्रक्रिया के तहत केवल www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in के ऑनलाईन निविदा के माध्यम से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। दिनांक 17.08.2026 राय 06:00 बजे तक निविदा भरी जा सकती है एवं ई-निविदा फॉर्म शुल्क एवं प्रोसेसिंग फीस की राशि नगर परिषद के IDFC First Bank के खाता संख्या 10123576694 आई.एफ.सी. कोड IDFB0042185 में जमा कराकर बोली घंटीघर का डी.डी./ बैंक चेक नगर परिषद, ब्यावर के निर्माण शाखा में दिनांक 18.08.2026 को प्राप्त 11 बजे से पूर्व जमा कराना अनिवार्य कराना अनिवार्य है। कुल 28 निर्माण कार्य कराये जाने हैं। ई-निविदा सूचना की समस्त शर्तें **SPPP** पोटल पर देखी जा सकती है। जिसका **NIB Code DLB2627A4910** है एवं **UBN No.** निम्नानुसार है:-

1. DLB2627WSOB11777	2. DLB2627WSOB11778
3. DLB2627WSOB11779	4. DLB2627WSOB11782
5. DLB2627WSOB11783	6. DLB2627WSOB11784
7. DLB2627WSOB11785	8. DLB2627WSOB11787
9. DLB2627WSOB11788	10. DLB2627WSOB11789
11. DLB2627WSOB11790	12. DLB2627WSOB11791
13. DLB2627WSOB11792	14. DLB2627WSOB11793
15. DLB2627WSOB11796	16. DLB2627WSOB11799
17. DLB2627WSOB11800	18. DLB2627WSOB11802
19. DLB2627WSOB11803	20. DLB2627WSOB11805
21. DLB2627WSOB11806	22. DLB2627WSOB11808
23. DLB2627WSOB11812	24. DLB2627WSOB11816
25. DLB2627WSOB11818	26. DLB2627WSOB11820
27. DLB2627WSOB11823	28. DLB2627WSOB11825

राज.संवा.पर/सी/26/8076 नगर परिषद, ब्यावर

IN THE COURT OF SH. SANJAY JINDAL, SPECIAL JUDGE, CBI-10 (PC Act), ROUSE AVENUE DISTRICT COURT COMPLEX, DDU MARG, NEW DELHI
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(Section 82 Cr.P.C.)

CASE TITLE : ED V. GEROSA CARLO VALENTINO FERDINAND & ORS.
CT NO. : 28/2025
BRANCH : DIRECTORATE OF ENFORCEMENT, NEW DELHI
FIR NO. / ECIR NO.: ECIR/15/DL20/2014
UNDER SECTION 3 & 4 PMLA ACT

WHEREAS a complaint has been made before me that **SHRAVAN GUPTA S/O RAJIV GUPTA, R/O 44A, AMRITA SHERGIL MARG, NEW DELHI AND ALSO AT 106, PART STREET, LONDON, W16KNT, UNITED KINGDOM** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence as above punishable under section 4 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **ACCUSED SHRAVAN GUPTA** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **ACCUSED SHRAVAN GUPTA** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrants);

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **ACCUSED SHRAVAN GUPTA** of Case No. **CT 28/2025** is required to appear at **ROUSE AVENUE COURT, NEW DELHI** before this Court (or before me) to answer the said complaint on the 15th day of **SEPTEMBER, 2026**.

Dated, this 25th day of July, 2026.

(Seal of the Court)
Sanjay Jindal, Special Judge,
CBI-10 (PC Act), ROUSE AVENUE
DISTRICT COURT COMPLEX,
DDU MARG, NEW DELHI

Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal

6th Floor, E-1 Wing, Block No. 3, Karmyogi Bhavan, Sector-10A, Gandhinagar-382010. Telephone No.: (079) 232-58044/46

GREAT/Appeal/1131/2026 Date : 29/07/2026

PUBLIC SUMMONS / NOTICE

BEFORE THE HON'BLE GUJARAT REAL ESTATE APPELLATE TRIBUNAL AT GANDHINAGAR

Appeal No. 228 of 2026
M/S Surajmal Sakarchand Through Its Authorized Signatory Mr. Kamal Vinaykumar Satia V/S Gujarat Rera, Wtc Noida Development Company Pvt. Ltd. & Appeal No. 229 of 2026
M/S Kanha Ventures Pvt. Ltd. Through Its Authorized Signatory Mr. Vinod D. Modha V/S Gujarat Rera, Wtc Noida Development Company Pvt. Ltd.

Take notice that the appellant above named has presented an Appeal No. 228 of 2026 & Appeal No. 229 of 2026 to this Hon'ble Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal at Gandhinagar challenging the common order dated 05/03/2026 passed by Hon'ble Gujarat Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gandhinagar.

Whereas upon hearing, Tribunal having on 15/07/2026 has been pleased to allow the appellant to publish the Public Notice to serve upon the unserved respondent no. 2 (Wtc Noida Development Company Pvt. Ltd.) by way of the publication of the notice in English newspaper having wide circulation in the locality concerned in respect of its order dated 18/06/2026 issuing notice to the respondents in Appeal No. 228 of 226 & Appeal No. 229 of 2026.

Take Notice that the hearing of the said Appeal No. 228 of 2026 & Appeal No. 229 of 2026 will take place on **18th August, 2026 at 11:30 AM** peremptorily in this Tribunal and if no appearance is made either by you or on your behalf, your advocate or by someone authorized by law to act for you this Tribunal shall proceed to pass appropriate orders on merits in accordance with law.

Given under my signature and the seal of the Tribunal on this 29/07/2026.

(J. L. Vala), Registrar Cum Consultant,
Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal, Gandhinagar

Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal

6th Floor, E-1 Wing, Block No. 3, Karmyogi Bhavan, Sector-10A, Gandhinagar-382010. Telephone No.: (079) 232-58044/46

GREAT/Appeal/7253/2026 Date : 22/07/2026

PUBLIC SUMMONS / NOTICE

BEFORE THE HON'BLE GUJARAT REAL ESTATE APPELLATE TRIBUNAL AT GANDHINAGAR

Appeal No. 195 of 2026 & Appeal No. 196 of 2026

M/S Crmo Pharmatech Pvt. Ltd., Parul P. Oza (Director)Appellant Versus M/S WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd. and othersRespondents
(1) M/s WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd. through its directors, Having its office at: GF-09, Plaza M-6, Uppals Building, District Center, Jasola, New Delhi - 110 025.

Also having its Chairman's Address at: 8/33, 3rd Floor, Satbhava School Marg, Wea Karol Bagh, New Delhi - 110 005.
(2) Sherif Muoin Khan, Director of M/s WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd., Having his office at: GF-09, Plaza M-6, Uppals Building, District Center, Jasola, New Delhi - 110025. (3) Kamlesh Kumar, Director of M/s WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd., Having his office at: GF-9, Plaza M-6, Uppals Building, District Center, Jasola, New Delhi - 110 025. (4) Sachin Kumar Hui, Director of M/s WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd., Having his office at: GF-9, Plaza M-6, Uppals Building, District Center, Jasola, New Delhi - 110 025. (5) Bhavarpal Kashyap, Director of M/s WTC Noida Development Co. Pvt. Ltd., Having his office at: GF-09, Plaza M-6, Uppals Building, District Center, Jasola, New Delhi - 110025.

Take notice that the appellant above named has presented an Appeal No. 195 of 2026 & Appeal No. 196 of 2026 to this Hon'ble Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal at Gandhinagar challenging the common order dated 05/03/2026 passed by Hon'ble Gujarat Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gandhinagar.

Whereas upon hearing, Tribunal having on 15/07/2026 has been pleased to allow the appellant to publish the Public Notice to serve upon the unserved respondent nos. 1 to 5 by way of the publication of the notice in English newspaper having wide circulation in the locality concerned in respect of its order dated 18/06/2026 issuing notice to the respondents in Appeal No. 195 of 2026 & Appeal No. 196 of 2026.

Take Notice that the hearing of the said Appeal No. 195 to 2026 & Appeal No. 196 of 2026 will take place on **18th August, 2026 at 11:30 AM** peremptorily in this Tribunal and if no appearance is made either by you or on your behalf, your advocate or by someone authorized by law to act for you this Tribunal shall proceed to pass appropriate order on merits in accordance with law.

Given under my signature and the seal of the Tribunal on this 22/07/2026.

(J. L. Vala), Registrar Cum Consultant,
Gujarat Real Estate Appellate Tribunal, Gandhinagar

Bureau of Investment Promotion

Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur Date :- 28/07/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for procurement of Creative, design and social media Partner for Bureau of Investment Promotion, Jaipur (a Government of Rajasthan undertaking) are invited from interested bidders upto 2:00 PM of 07.08.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portals: (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>) and (<http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state. **UBN No. BIP2627SLRC00021**
Raj.Samwad/C/26/8034 **Commissioner (Inv. & NRIs)**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Asim, S/o Amin Ansari, R/o H.No. WZ-42A, Naraina Village, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 01/2021, U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Asim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Asim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Asim** accused of **FIR No. 01/2021, U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.09.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Moksha Bains**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
DP/10454/WD/2026 West District, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Asim, S/o Amin Ansari, R/o H.No. WZ-42A, Naraina Village, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 01/2021, U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Asim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Asim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Asim** accused of **FIR No. 01/2021, U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.09.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Moksha Bains**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
DP/10454/WD/2026 West District, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Ajay Kumar S/o Ram Lal R/o 29/3 D Block, Agar Nagar, Prem Nagar III, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 439/2024, PS Prem Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ajay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Ajay Kumar** in **FIR No. 439/2024, PS Prem Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.

By order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West District, Room No. 109
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10477/RD/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HBC_S33552_1	1. ELIGIBILITY AND CRITERIA AMENDED. 2. DATE EXTENDED UPTO 07.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 10.08.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vitaIndia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hryanain No- 47682/HRY

BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi

... A joint venture with Govt. of NCT of Delhi

TENDER NOTICE Date: 31.07.2026

BYPL invites Sealed Tenders from all CERC Approved Traders /Utilities for Banking of Power

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Period	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Bid Submission	Date and Time of Bid Opening
BYPL/PMG/FY 26-27/ Tender/Banking-1, Date 30-July-2026	Banking of Power	1st Nov-2026 to 30th Sep-2027	Rs. 5,00,000/-	14th August-2026 at 15:15 hrs.	14th August-2026 at 15:30 hrs.

For Further Details, please log on to- <https://www.bsesdelhi.com/web/bypl/power-procurement-tenders>.

Head
Power Management Group
Regd.Off: BSES Yamuna Power Ltd., Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032 | CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525
Website: www.bsesdelhi.com TEL: 011-41247111

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD(R&B) DIVISION VIJAYPUR ABBREVIATED NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-NIT No. 40 of 2026-27 Dated. 29-07-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works

S. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost of Work (in Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Const. of 01 Additional Classroom alongwith Kitchen Shed at M.S. Abdullah Basti.	17.58	600	2% of Adv. Cost	05 Month	"A, B & C"
2	Const. of 01 Additional Classroom alongwith washroom for Girls Students at Govt. Middle School Shah Da Talab	21.59	600	2% of Adv. Cost	05 Month	"A, B & C"

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of T.S :- Sanctioned
Project Authority :- Under the scheme DA-JGU/A during 2026-27.

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	29-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 29-07-2026 to 05-08-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	30-07-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
4	Bid submission Start Date	29-07-2026 at 1800 Hrs
5	Bid Submission End Date	05-08-2026 upto 1700 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	06-08-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

The tender is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in> all other terms & conditions can be seen on the above website.

No. PWD/V/2802-08
Dt. 29-07-2026
DIP/J-6977/26 DATE 30.06.2026

Executive Engineer PD, P.W.D, Bulandshahr

E- Procurement Tender Notice

Dated: 25.07.2026

Letter No. 5072/1A

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bids online through <http://etender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Building/Road work Category as applied from Date 11.08.2026 to 18.08.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-1 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bid will be opened online on dated 18.08.2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the offer happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bid as specified, the bid will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. In Lac)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender Cost (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Repair and maintenance work of Inspection house Anoopshahr located in Year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	5.00	0.50	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Building work)
2	Patch Repair Work on Different Village Road of Block Anoopshahr in Year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	30.00	3.00	04 Months	300+500+18% GST 144.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
3	Patch Repair Work on Different Village Road of Block Lakhtawi, Jahangirabad in Year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	28.00	2.80	04 Months	300+500+18% GST 144.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
4	Patch Repair Work on Different Village Road of Block Lakhtawi, Jahangirabad in Year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	28.50	2.85	04 Months	300+500+18% GST 144.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
5	Repair of bridges, culverts, and patch repair on various roads under the Lakhtawi/ Jahangirabad block in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	15.80	1.58	04 Months	300+500+18% GST 144.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
6	Repair of bridges, culverts, and patch repair on various roads under the Bulandshahr/Lakhtawi block in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	17.00	1.70	04 Months	300+500+18% GST 144.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
7	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of SH/MDR/ODR roads category in Block BB Nagar in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.00	0.70	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
8	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of village Roads category in Block BB Nagar in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.50	0.75	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
9	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of SH/MDR/ODR roads category in Block Anupshahr in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.80	0.78	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
10	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of village Roads category in Block Anupshahr in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.20	0.72	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
11	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of SH/MDR/ODR roads category in Block Jahangirabad in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.90	0.79	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)
12	Earthwork and forest clearing work on damaged embankments due to heavy rains on various roads of village Roads category in Block Jahangirabad in year 2026-27 in District Bulandshahr.	7.70	0.77	04 Months	150+500+18% GST 117.00 = Rs.767.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Road Work)



Purvanchal Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd.,
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM-II)
Vidyut Nagar, BLW, Varanasi

E-Tender Notice and Brief Distription of Material
Name of Material
1. EAV-55/2026-27, 11 KV Stay Loop Insulator- 20000 Nos. & 33 KV Post Insulator- 2000 Nos. Tender Fee: Rs. 3540.00, Earnest Money: Rs. 25,800.00
Last date & Time for submission of tender document: 20, August 2026, 15:00 Hrs

Further details and all other information can be seen at website
www.etender.up.nic.in “Save Electricity in the interest of Nation”
R.No.- 1189/Date: 30.07.2026



उत्तर प्रदेश औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
अंगिका Website: www.onlineupsida.com
ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि विभिन्न जगहों में बिजली औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों में विभिन्न विकास/अनुसंधान कार्यों हेतु सूचीबद्ध एवं अन्य सरकारी विभागों/सर्वजनिक उपक्रमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निकायों में अर्ह श्रेणी के पंजीकृत फर्मों/ठेकेदारों से ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।

क्रम	कार्य का नाम	प्रति ब लागत	बिड की तारीख
1.	Annual Maintenance works for one at SEZ Moradabad.	रुपय/मिनट	777/1225.00

उपरोक्त पूर्णकालीन निविदा दिनांक 31.07.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 20.08.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन की जा सकती है। प्रत्येक ई-निविदाओं को दिनांक 21.08.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे या इसके पश्चात खोला जायेगा। निविदादाताओं द्वारा अपलोड किए गये समस्त प्रश्नों की मूल प्रतियाँ को पंजीकृत डाक अथवा व्यक्तिगत रूप से दिनांक 22.08.2026 को रात 5:00 बजे तक कार्यालय में प्राप्त करना अनिवार्य है अन्यथा निविदा को Consider नहीं किया जायेगा।
नोट:- निविदा सम्बंधी विस्तृत जानकारी website: www.onlineupsida.com पर स्थापित ई-निविदा सुपार्लसी की website:- <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देवी जा सकती है।
प्रमुख वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (सिविल), उपसंचालक(आवृत्ति), औद्योगिक क्षेत्र, सेक्टर-प्रधान तालमयरी, रामदास रोड, अलीगढ़

NORTHERN RAILWAY
1st Corrigendum

Name of Work: "Strengthening of Power Supply distribution system with replacement of old and obsolete LT panel/Feeder pillar with other associated works at Old Delhi station."
The amendments in above said tender are as under

Tender No:-	89-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
Earlier published	89-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
Amended	89-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27
Name of work	Strengthening of Power Supply distribution system with replacement of old and obsolete LT panel/Feeder pillar with other associated works at Old Delhi station.
Approx cost of the works in:-	Rs. 36726132.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Bid Security	Rs. 734500.00/-
Date & time of submission of tender	17.08.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	17.08.2026, 16.00 Hrs.

The tender document of above-mentioned tender has been modified kindly go through the amended documents available at www.ireps.gov.in and submit your offer accordingly. **Tender No. 89-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2634/26

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
Directorate of Food & Consumer Affairs
3rd FLOOR JSFC BHAVAN, KADRU MAIN ROAD, RANCHI JHARKHAND, 834002

Letter no- Kha.Up.Ni.-02-Dho.Sa.Yo.-03/2026- 1276
Dated :-29.07.2026
Corrigendum Notice

Last date of Bid submission for GeM Bid Number – GEM/2026/B/7647392, for supply of Dhoti, Saree and Lungi, under Sona Sobran Dhoti Saree Scheme is being extended as mentioned below:-

SI No.	Existing last date and time of bid submission	Extended date and time	Bid opening date and time
1	29-07-2026 at 1700 hrs.	03-08-2026 at 1100 hrs.	03-08-2026 at 1130 hrs.

All others term and conditions/clauses published by PR No-382106 bearing letter No- 1019 dated– 10-06-2026 shall remain same.

sd/-
Deputy Secretary,
Directorate of Food and Consumer Affairs



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)

E-mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com, Tel No:-0680-2404287)

NOTICE
FOR PRADHAN MANTRI GRAM SADAK YOJANA (PMGSY) NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH "e"-Procurement
Bid Identification No. Online Tender/12-2026-27/PMGSY/BPR

The Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Berhampur on behalf of Odisha State Rural Road Agency invites the percentage rate bids in electronic tendering system for construction of Roads & Bridges under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY-IV (B-II)) in the districts of Kandhamal for 25 (Twenty Five) number of packages with estimated cost totalling to Rs 32.05 Cr (Approximate) including their maintenance for five years from the eligible contractors registered with State PWD /CPWD/MES/ Railways. The registered bidder under Odisha, can also participate in this process, but shall have to submit independently outside registration with the appropriate authority of the State Govt. preferably within a month of the deadline for bid submission, but prior to signing of the contract.

Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement. Dtd. 03.08.2026
Last Date/Time for receipt of bids through e-procurement: 17.08.2026 upto 5.30 PM

(i) EMD / Bid Security, Cost of Bid document is to be transferred through Online as per the procedure mentioned in the DTCN.

(ii) Non-submission of the information/documents through online by the bidder as per mentioned DTCN will also liable for rejection of his tender.

For further details and corrigendum (if any) please log on to www.pmgstyenders.gov.in.

Sd/-
Chief Constnration Engineer
R.W.Circle, Berhampur
OIPR-25001/25071/1/26-27/0034



BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION
CENTRAL OFFICE: STORES & PURCHASE DEPARTMENT
K.H. ROAD, SHANTHINAGAR, BENGALURU-560 027
No: BMTC/CO/OSP/TFENDER/09/2026-27 Date: 30.07.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
B.M.T.C invites tender for procurement of the following Goods & Services through KPP Portal:

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Description	Last Date for Bid Submission in KPP Portal
Short Term Tender			
1	BMTC/2026-27/IND0327	Procurement of Automotive Glasses	10.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
2	BMTC/2026-27/IND0328	Procurement of Wheel Bearing Grease	10.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
Regular Tender			
3	BMTC/2026-27/IND0329	Procurement of Automotive Cables & Wires	18.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
4	BMTC/2026-27/IND0330	Procurement of Vinyl Flooring Mat	18.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
5	BMTC/2026-27/SE1425	Engaging an Agency for Operating the canteen at the training center BMTC Vaddarahalli.	18.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
Corrigendum: Last date and time for submission of following tender is extended as under.			
6	BMTC/2026-27/IND0300	Procurement of Furnitures	17.08.2026 at 17.00 Hrs

The above mentioned tender details can be obtained from <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> Further, any addendum/corrigendum in respect of change in calendar of events, specification, other tender terms and conditions etc. will be uploaded /published through KPP-Portal only.

Note: Interested Bidders need to register in the KPP Portal. For further information visit BMTC Central Office or Log on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/- CONTROLLER OF STORES & PURCHASES
(Tender Inviting Authority)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C./ 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Basuki Nath Jha S/o Palan Jha R/o G-122, Harkesh Nagar, Okhla Phase-II, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 339/2024 U/s 420/406 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Basuki Nath Jha** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Basuki Nath Jha** of case **FIR No. 339/2024 U/s 420/406 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court within 30/31 days from the date of publication of this notice.

By Order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South East
Saket Courts, Delhi

DP/10497/SE/2026(Court Matter)



The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)



TENDER NOTICE
E-tender is invited for the supply of following item.
(1) Request For Proposal (RFP) for Operation of Stage Carriage Services (With Driver and Conductor) for Public Transport of 200 Midi CNG Non-AC Buses in the City of Mumbai & Its Extended Suburbs on Gross Cost Contract (GCC) Model,
Re – invited e-tenders
(2) 81418.

Note: For more details, log on to website <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
PRO/AAM(M)/51/2026
GENERAL MANAGER

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/34/2026-27/W-3 Dated :-29.07.2026
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1 Name of work	Repair and Renovation of existing old corroded metal color coated sheets valley gutters and associated coping works from PF No 18 to PF No-01 along with allied civil and finishing works for station building and PF at New Delhi Railway station and repair and renovation works of ladies, gents toilets at the holding area, first floor toilet of the station building including plumbing, sanitary, tiling and other allied civil and maintenance works at New Delhi railway station in the section of SSE/WINDLS/Sin under ADE/NW/NDLS.
2 Approx cost of work	Rs. 3,63,59,394.52/- (Rupees Three Crore Sixty Three Lakh Fifty Nine Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Four and Fifty Two Paise only)
3 Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 7,27,200.00/- (Rupees Seven Lakh Twenty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Only)
4 Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
5 Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	20.08.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6 Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.
2629/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

जन सूचना

सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि पंचायत भवन सोनोपत के पुराने भवन कि निलामी दिनांक 06.08.2026 को दोपहर 01:00 बजे जिला परिषद कार्यालय में की जानी है। इच्छुक बोली दाता रु 1,84,000/रु का डिमांड ड्राफ्ट मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जिला परिषद सोनोपत के नाम निलामी से पहले मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जिला परिषद में जमा करवा कर बोली में शामिल हो सकता है।

नियम व शर्तें निम्नानुसार है:-
1. बोली दाता को स्वयं उपस्थित होना होगा।
2. प्रत्येक बोली दाता अपना पहचान पत्र प्रस्तुत करेगा।
3. बोली केवल वही बोली दाता देगा, जिसने 1,84,000/- रूपक की धरोहर राशि डिमांड ड्राफ्ट (मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जिला परिषद, सोनोपत (C.E.O.) के नाम) शुरू होने से पहले जमा करवा दी हो।
4. पुराने भवन के मलबे की बोली जहां एवं जैसे है के आधार पर होगी।
5. सफल बोली दाता को मलबा 06 महीने में उठाना होगा एवं जगह साफ कर के देने होगी।
6. सफल बोली दाता मलबा अपने खर्च से उठाएगा।
7. सफल बोली दाता की 25 प्रतिशत रकम उसी समय बोली समाप्त होते ही मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जिला परिषद, सोनोपत के पास जमा करवाएगा एवं बाकी की रकम 15 दिन के अन्दर जमा करवाएगा।
8. यदि सफल बोली दाता 15 दिन के अन्दर रकम जमा नहीं करवाता तो बोली स्वतः रह समझी जाएगी एवं बोली दाता को धरोहर राशि एवं 25 प्रतिशत की जमा राशि जब्त कर ली जाएगी।
9. इसी प्रकार यदि सफल बोली दाता 06 माह में जगह खाली नहीं करके देता तो उस पर 10,000/- रूपक प्रतिदिन का जुर्माना लगेगा।
10. बोली को बिना किसी कारण बताए सख्त अधिकारी / कमेटी को रह करने का पूर्ण अधिकार होगा।
11. इस प्रकार की बोली पर यदि किसी प्रकार के टैक्स देय होंगे तो यह बोली दाता को अतिरिक्त देने होंगे।
12. किसी प्रकार के विवाद पर मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जिला परिषद, सोनोपत (C.E.O.) का निर्णय मान्य होगा।
13. सफल बोली दाता को मलबा उठाने की अनुमति तभी दी जाएगी, जब यह बोली की पूरी राशि जमा करवा देगा।

हस्ता/-
मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी
जिला परिषद, सोनोपत ।

No. 47673/HRV

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PROCUREMENT CIRCLE, KPDCL BEMINA SRINAGAR KASHMIR 190018
e-TENDER ABBREVIATED NOTICE.

For and on behalf of the Managing Director, KPDCL Kashmir, Superintending Engineer, Procurement Circle, KPDCL Kashmir invites online e-bids from Govt. registered original equipment manufacturers for supply of ACSR conductor of various sizes as mentioned hereunder.

S.No.	Material Description	FOR ECSD Srinagar (KMS)	e-NIT Reference.
1	200 sq mm (Panther)	10	SE/PROC/07/2026-27
2	100 sq mm (Dog)	20	
3	50 sq mm (Rabbit)	50	
4	30 sq mm (Weasel)	30	

The complete tender document is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in>. Interested bidder/tenders may view, download the e-Bid document, seek clarification and submit their e-Bid online up to the date and time mentioned in the table below. Bidding Documents contain Qualifying Criteria for Bidders, Specifications, Bill of Quantities, Terms and Conditions of Contract and other details.

i) Date and Time of downloading/Sale (Start) of Tender Document	30/07/2026 09:00 Hrs
ii) Date & Time of Download/Sale (End) of Tender Document	20/08/2026; 14:00 Hrs
iii) Date & Time of Bidding Queries/Clarifications	30/07/2026 10:00 Hrs to 03/08/2026 15:00 Hrs
iv) Date & Time of Bid Uploading (Start/End)	03/08/2026; 16:00 Hrs to 20/08/2026 14:00 Hrs
v) Submission of Hard Copy (end) Date & Time in respect of Tender Fee and EMD only	21/08/2026 in the office of Chief Engineer Planning and Procurement Bemina Srinagar 190018.
vi) Commercial/Tender Bid Opening Date & Time	22/08/2026 14:00 Hrs
vii) Financial Bid Opening	Shall be declared later on for the technically qualified bidders
viii) Venue of Commercial/ Technical Bid Opening	Electronically in the office of SE Procurement Circle KPDCL
ix) Cost of e-Bid document.	Read cost of Bid Document as Rs.3000.00 (Three thousand only) and Rs 500 for local firms of J&K. For Steel Reinforced Aluminum Conductor of size 200 Sq mm (Panther) = INR 71,619.00 For Steel Reinforced Aluminum Conductor of size 100 Sq mm (Dog) = INR 66,764.00
x) Amount of Earnest Money Deposit	For Steel Reinforced Aluminum Conductor of size 50 Sq mm (Rabbit) = INR 82,153.00 For Steel Reinforced Aluminum Conductor of size 30 Sq mm (Weasel) = INR 29,884.00 For Steel Reinforced Aluminum Conductor of full quantity (all sizes) = INR 2,50,420.00 and INR 5000.00/- only in case of local firms of J&K.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Procurement (KPDCL)

DIP/J-1720-P/26 DATE 30.06.2026



Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC03813
(Contact number 946118721) Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No.	QW-350/PO-W	Dated	29.07.2026
Chief Engineer/Stores & Workshops Organization, Sarabha Nagar, PSPCL, Ludhiana, invites E-tender of Repair of 3-phase, 50 cycles, outdoor type, oil immersed, naturally cooled, Stack core type construction, OWP Non Star Aluminium Wound Distribution Transformers (Type Conventional) of capacity 100 KVA with voltage ratio 11/0.433 KV conforming to ISS: 2026(with latest amendments, if any) and 1180 part-1 (2014) complete with a first filling of oil conforming to ISS: 335/1993 (with latest amendments, if any)			
Quantity = 900 Nos.			
For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 29.07.2026 from 04:30 P.M. onwards.			
NOTE:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in			
No. 13844/PB		C-758/26	



SBI

Corporate Centre, Nariman Point, Madame Cama Road, Mumbai-400 021

Empanelment of Car Hiring Companies/Agencies for providing New Cars on monthly rental basis to our Executives

TENDER FOR AVAILING THE SERVICES OF CAR HIRING COMPANIES/AGENCIES TO PROVIDE NEW CARS ON MONTHLY RENTAL BASIS TO OUR EXECUTIVES

State Bank of India, Corporate Centre, Mumbai invites sealed offers from eligible reputed companies / agencies for the purpose of providing new cars on monthly rental basis to our executives posted at Corporate Centre, Nariman Point, GITC Belapur and Mumbai Metro LHO at BKC, for a period of 03 years. The tender documents, eligibility criteria and other details will be available on the Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/sbi-in-the-news/procurement-news> and e-Tender Portal www.tenderwizard.com/SBIETENDER from 31.07.2026 to 28.08.2026. Tenders received after the due date will not be entertained. Corrigendum/Addendum, if any, will be published only on Bank's website and e-tender portal.

Last Date for Submission of bids: 28.08.2026 (upto 15:00 hrs.)
Place: Mumbai
Date: 31.07.2026
CHIEF LIAISON OFFICER

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sameer, S/o Salim R/o Jhuggi No. 3, C-76, Phase-II, Mayapuri, West Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **FIR No. 467/2020 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act** at **P.S. Mayapuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sameer** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sameer** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sameer** accused of **FIR No. 467/2020 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act** at **P.S. Mayapuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 02.09.2026.

By Order: Ms. Sheetal Rani,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12,
West, Room No.- 152,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/10459/WD/2026



उ.प्र. राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
ए-1/4, लखनऊ, कानपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अत्यन्त विकास/अनुसंधान/उत्पत्तीकरण कार्यों हेतु सरकारी विभागों/सर्वजनिक उपक्रमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निकायों में अर्ह श्रेणी के पंजीकृत फर्मों/ठेकेदारों से ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं, जिसको अपलोड करने की समय सीमा निम्नवत् है:-

1. क्रम सं 01 पर अर्जित निविदा दिनांक 31.07.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 07.08.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन की जा सकती है। निम्न दिनांक 07.08.2026 को अपराह्न 5:30 बजे खोला जायेगा (ब्लॉक/सिविल)

निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल सम्बंधी की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा खोलने की तिथि से दो कार्यदिवस के अन्दर कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकेंगी। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:-

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की लागत रु० (लाख में)
1	Upgradation/Resurfacing of Road No. 6, Saur Urza Marg, L.H.S. Road of Bel, Plot No. B/57 To 40/4, Plot No. 41/1 To 50/1, Plot No. 49/34 To Road No. 2, Road No. 1B, 33, A-42 Subdivision Road & Subdivision 3B (Part) and Construction of Drains & Shramik Soudha Kendra at Industrial Area Site-4, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad (U.P.)	Rs.3532.98

नोट:- निविदादाता जफ़्फ़ी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दश अर्जित करें। जी०एन०डी० अलग से देय होगा।

निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी अधिकारण की website: <https://beta.upsidamarketplace.com/> पर स्थित ई-निविदा एवं सुपार्लसी की website: <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देवी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के बोधक प्रबंधक (सिविल मुं०) के बी प्रवीण कुमार सलाहनिष्ठा मोबाइल नं० 98719090103 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

प्रधान महानगरपालिका
उद्योगशास्त्री/आवृत्ति, कानपुर

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com/gmsp.jhvn@rediffmail.com

Short E-Procurement Notice
JBVNL invites online short e-tender from reputed, technically sound manufacturers/ supplier only for procurement of following Materials :-

Sr	NIT/Tender notice No. and description of item	Tender fee	Date of publication of tender on website	Document download start date & time	Online Bid Submission start date	Online Bid Submission end date	Technical bid opening date and time
1	205/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 33 KV Metering Unit of different ratio (-/5A)	Rs 10000/- + GST	31/07/2026 from 13:00 Hrs.	31/07/2026 from 13:10 Hrs.	31/07/2026 from 13:20 Hrs.	13/08/2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	14/08/2026 at 18: 00 Hrs.

NOTE:- (i) Only e-tenders will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9470378503/9430348596, NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178
(ii) Tender fee & EMD must be paid through online mode. **(iii)** Tender fee is non-refundable.

स्वीकृत एवं सफ़ाई में कर्जा बचाली। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज कराए।
PR.NO.386302 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27):D
Sd/-
Dy.General Manager (P)

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Shimla Division No-II, HPPWD, Shimla-3 on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system, from the eligible class of contractors registered with HP.PWD., for the work as detailed in the table.

Sr. No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost in Rs.	Starting date of downloading Bid.	EMD	Cost of Tender	Time Allowed	Deadline for submission of Bid.
1	Construction of Vehicular Underpass Near Lift.	Rs. 26563674.00	29-07-2026	Rs. 531260.00	Rs. 7000.00	Six Months	05-08-2026
2	Construction of Parking Cum Office accommodation for Chief Minister Office below the Hillside main building Shimla. (SH- Furnishing items there-of).	Rs. 1915951.20	29-07-2026	Rs. 383200.00	Rs. 5000.00	Two Months	05-08-2026

The bidders are advised to note other details, of tenders from the department website, [www.hptenders.gov.in](http://hptenders.gov.in). The Executive Engineer reserves the right to accept/reject any tender/application without assigning any reason.
“HIM SUCHANA AWAM JAN SAMARK”

No. 2265/2026-2027/HP



CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED
Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru.Vi.Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES
E-Auction Sale Notice for the Sale of Immovable Assets under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, r/w Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. (Rule 8 & 9)
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Mortgagee (s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the Secured Creditor, the **Physical possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited** the same shall be referred herein after as Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited. The Secured Assets will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** basis through E-Auction.

It is hereby informed to General public that we are going to conduct public E-Auction through website <https://bankauctions.in>

Loan Account Nos. TL01NDL000062239, Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower, Mortgagees: 1. M/s. I.M.S (Institute of Mathematical Sciences), (Borrower), 1st Floor, No. 25/8, Old Rajender Nagar, Central Delhi - 110 060. 2. Mr. Kore Venkataiah, (Co Borrower), 3. Mrs. Ara Sridevi, (Co Borrower), St.No.2 & 3 Residing at: No. 453-454, Ground Floor, Dombastorey, New Rajender Nagar, Central Delhi - 110 060. 4. M/s. K. Venkanna Education Services, (Co Borrower), Ground Floor, House No. 12-13-354, Tamaka, Secunderabad, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500 017. Also at: No. 1-10-237, 2nd Floor Room No. 202, R.K.S Kanchams Blue Sapphire, Ashok Nagar, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500 020.
Outstanding Amount: Rs.4,24,70,643/- as on 30.07.2026

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY (Secured Asset):
Item No. 1: All that piece and parcels of the Entire Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights, build up Property Bearing No. 453-454, area measuring 123.66 Sq. Yards, Situated at New Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi - 110060.
Item No. 2: All that piece and parcels of the Entire Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights, build up Property Bearing No. 455-456, area measuring 123.66 Sq. Yards, Situated at New Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi - 110060.

Reserve Price : Rs. 4,73,40,000/-, EMD : Rs. 47,34,000/-, Bid Increment Amount : Rs. 1,00,000/-

E-Auction Date and Time : 02.09.2026 - 11 AM to 12 Noon (with unlimited extension of 3 min each)
Last Date of Submission of EMD : 01.09.2026, Date of Inspection of Property : As per the appointment

1. All Interested participants / bidders are requested to visit the website <https://bankauctions.in> & www.foreclosureindia.com. For details: help, procedure and online training on e-auction, prospective bidders may contact **M/s.4 Closure**, (Contact Person: Mr. Shailendra, Ph. No. 9515160061, Email: shailendra@bankauctions.in)
2. For further details on terms and conditions please visit:- <https://bankauctions.in> & <https://cholamandalam.com/news/auction-notices> to take part in e-auction or contact **Mr. Ved Prakash Mishra - 9910144252 / Mr. Naveen Kapoor - Ph: 77550 01547 / Mr. Kapil Sharma - Ph: 9205308879.**

THIS IS ALSO A STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) AND OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES,2002 (Rule 8 & 9)
Date: 30.07.2026
Place: Delhi
Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited,



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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• HISTORY

Ravidas: Icon of Dalit resistance in Punjab, beyond

Manraj Grewal Sharma
Chandigarh, July 30

SEVEN MONTHS before Sant Ravidas's 650th birth anniversary, the BJP launched a nationwide commemoration campaign Wednesday at his birthplace near Varanasi, in the presence of UP CM Yogi Adityanath. Punjab's AAP government, too, launched a campaign in February. Centuries after his lifetime, Guru Ravidas continues to shape religious thought, social reform, politics and Dalit assertion in India, particularly Punjab. A Bhakti saint, philosopher and poet, he challenged caste hierarchies while remaining rooted in his occupation as a cobbler, preached dignity of labour and envisioned an equal society.

Unique among Bhakti saints

Guru Ravidas was a 15th-16th century saint whose teachings emphasised devotion to a formless God. He belonged to the charmar community of leather workers. Ronki Ram, a professor emeritus at the Institute for Development and Communication, Chandigarh, and an eminent scholar of Guru Ravidass, told *The Indian Express* that the saint neither renounced his religion nor abandoned his hereditary occupation. In doing so, his life itself became a form of peaceful social protest at a time when the Bhakti movement sought to challenge social hierarchies. While he rejected ritualism, accounts say he wore the sacred thread (*janeu*) and applied the *tilak*. Ram said these actions symbolically challenged the upper castes' monopoly over religious symbols.

Ravidas became widely revered through his devotional poetry and reformist philosophy. He wrote in Sadhukari — blending Awadhi, Braj, Khari Boli, Punjabi, Rajasthani and Sanskrit. According to Professor Yog Raj Angrish, who heads the School of Punjabi Studies at Panjab University, his verses were simple and easy to sing. "While Kabir's poetry is marked by rhetoric, resistance and poetic deconstruction, Ravidas writes with philosophical depth and humility." A central idea of his philosophy was of Begumpura, an ideal society founded on principles of equality, justice and freedom. Prof Angrish says Guru Ravidas was among the earliest thinkers to imagine a society free from caste, class and hierarchy. His famous hymn, included in the Guru Granth Sahib, begins: "*Begumpura sehar ko naau; dookh andoh nahi tih thaau* (Begumpura is the name of the city. There is no suffering or anxiety there)." The hymn describes a city free from sorrow, fear, oppressive taxation and discrimination, where all people enjoy equality, dignity and unrestricted movement.

Prof Ram says Begumpura represents a society free of caste hierarchy, poverty and oppression, where everyone has enough to live with dignity and God alone is sovereign. Scholars including Gail Omvedt have described it as one of India's earliest visions of a casteless, classless society.

Raising Dalit consciousness

Guru Ravidas occupies a unique place in Sikhism. Forty of his hymns (*shabads*) and one *shloka* are included in the Guru Granth Sahib, alongside compositions of Kabir, Sheikh Farid and other Bhakti and Sufi saints. Prof Sarabjit Singh of Punjabi University said these saints lived before Guru Nanak Dev, who carried forward many of their ideas. Prof Ram described him as one of the earliest voices of Dalit resistance, who transformed personal experience into a universal message of equality without hatred or revenge. His influence became more visible during Punjab's Ad Dharm movement of the 1920s, which adopted Ravidas as its patron saint to champion an independent socio-political consciousness. As he put it: "*Aisa chahoon raaj main jahaan milai sabhan ko ann; chhot bado sab sam basai, Ravidas rahai prasann* (I long for such a kingdom where everyone has enough to eat, where the small and the great live as equals; then Ravidas shall be content)." For millions of Dalits, Ravidas is the foremost spiritual figure. His followers, the Ravidassias, are a Dalit community of whom the bulk — around 12 lakh — live in Punjab's Doaba. The politically influential community separated from Sikhism in 2010 and follows its own scripture.

• GLOBAL

How US-Iran conflict is forcing Gulf states to rethink their security strategies



EXPERT EXPLAINS
BASHIR ALI ABBAS
SENIOR RESEARCH ASSOCIATE, COUNCIL FOR STRATEGIC AND DEFENSE RESEARCH, DELHI

AFTER NEARLY two weeks of the Iran war, of US strikes on Iran and Iranian retaliation against targets in Gulf Arab states, both sides ceased their attacks by July 25. The region is now coming up with strategies to deal with this conflict's fallout. Kuwait ratified a June 2023 Defence Cooperation Agreement (DCA) with Pakistan on July 26 for a five-year period, while Qatar committed to deepening its security cooperation with Pakistan during bilateral

talks in Doha the following day. Meanwhile, the US-Iran war has also reignited the war between the Yemeni Houthis and Saudi Arabia, which had been dormant since 2022. The subsequent Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping have meant that both the sea and the strait flanking the Arabian Peninsula were simultaneously under fire, for the first time in history, until the US-Iran exchanges ceased on July 25.

US-Iran: State of play

On July 27, Washington's UN Ambassador said President Donald Trump wanted to give negotiations a chance again, with Trump himself stating "friendly negotiations" were underway on Iran's request. Tehran rejected this characterisation. Since early July, as Iran rejected American efforts to push through a new shipping channel through Omani waters and targeted ships that did not coordinate with Iran, the US resumed kinetic action with a focus on degrading Iran's ability to enforce the Memorandum of Understanding's Ar-

ticle 5, which allowed joint Iranian and Omani administration of the Strait. This was supposed to weaken Iran's bargaining power during nuclear negotiations. Neither has occurred. Iran's control of Hormuz remains, Tehran and Muscat have continued holding negotiations to finalize arrangements to enforce Article 5, and Iran has broadened talks to include Saudi Arabia. Moreover, Iran would deem its own case for nuclear enrichment to be strengthened by Saudi Arabia's pact with the US on July 22 to begin nuclear energy cooperation. So, the US will likely be again incentivised to hit Iranian nuclear targets as well as its Hormuz infrastructure until it is satisfied with the degradation of Iranian capabilities. **Fallout one: Kuwait-Pakistan** The recurring fighting between the US and Iran, as well as pauses between kinetic action, have reinforced an old learning in key Arab states, that regardless of their current dependence on foreign arms, internal capability development as well as improved mili-

tary training is an inescapable long-term need. Hence, Kuwait's DCA with Pakistan focuses on military training, education, intelligence sharing, logistics, defense technology, research and exchanges of expertise. The agreement does not mimic the Saudi-Pakistan Strategic Mutual Defense Agreement (SDMA), signed in September 2025, given that it does not bind either party to the other's defence when attacked. But SDMA has also shown that true mutual defence commitments are not the main objective of Arab states with Pakistan — neither has Pakistan struck Iran or Houthi territories nor has Saudi Arabia struck Afghanistan. Rather, it is meant to entrench Pakistan's role in Saudi capability build-up in the long term, while Riyadh adopts a mix of means to tackle present threats. For Kuwait and Qatar (along with other GCC states), intra-Gulf geopolitical divergences are secondary to the objective of securing long-term defence partners whose expertise can be used to build up domestic capability. This means even if Pakistan is

viewed differently by each of these states, its value as a security partner overrides these differences. That Pakistan is reliant on these states for economic stability adds a unique layer of assurance and leverage. **Fallout two: Houthi-Saudi** Among the most crucial fallouts of the US-Iran war is the return of Saudi-Houthi fighting since July 14, when the Saudi-based Yemeni government in exile bombed the Houthi-controlled Sana'a Airport to reportedly prevent an Iranian plane from landing. In response, the Houthis fired ballistic missiles into Saudi territory and declared a naval blockade of Saudi Arabia in the Bab-el-Mandeb strait. Both sides have since targeted each other's infrastructure. Despite this US-Iran triggered Saudi-Houthi escalation, it is unlikely that Riyadh wants to proactively return to full-scale fighting in Yemen. It was Houthi attacks against Aramco facilities in Abqaiq and Khurais in 2019 that had prompted a shift in Saudi strategy towards both Yemen and Iran, prioritising

engagement as the path to stability. For perspective, despite the Yemeni Houthi's claiming responsibility for the 2026 Aramco attack, Riyadh participated in US strikes on Iran-backed militias in Iraq on July 29. This reflects the Saudi desire to satisfy its deterrence needs by acting against other parts of Iran's Axis of Resistance, instead of risking a larger war with the Houthis. Now, Riyadh's need for regional stability increases significantly due to the 123 Agreement and its long-due quest for nuclear power. A Houthi attack on a future Saudi nuclear power plant could be more dangerous than strikes on oil facilities. **What now** The Donald Trump administration is seemingly focused on preventing Iran from materially gaining from the MoU's provisions, which leaves room for more strike exchanges before substantial negotiations for a final deal begin. For regional states, this predicament is as untenable as a potential return to full-scale war.

• LEGAL

SC sets 'public interest' test on retrospective green nod



JAY MAZOOMDAAR

THE SUPREME Court's judgment on Wednesday striking down the Centre's 2021 Office Memorandum (OM) that allowed retrospective approval for projects that had already commenced construction without environment clearances (ECs), now closes the door on blanket and open-ended regularisation of such projects. It leaves limited room for government action under statutory authority. The judgment has sought to strike a middle path in the top court's evolving environmental jurisprudence, distinguishing between the source of executive power and the limits of regularisation. The court held that ex-post facto ECs cannot be created through an OM, but recognised that the government may, in exceptional circumstances and in public interest, provide such a mechanism through a statutory notification issued under delegated legislative powers. The test will depend on how narrowly the government frames any future amnesty scheme and whether it meets the Supreme Court's benchmark of "public interest". An OM is an administrative instruction issued by a ministry or department and does not have the force of law. A statutory notification, by contrast, is issued under authority granted by a statute — the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, in this case — and notified in the Gazette. Applying this distinction, the court set aside the Environment Ministry's July 2021 OM, which introduced a standard operating procedure (SOP) for granting ex-post facto ECs to "violation cases". The court held that the OM had created a continuing or "perpetual" regime for condoning violations. It did not invalidate the March 2017 notification, which provided a limited, one-time six-month amnesty window. The judgment also departed from the court's May 2025 position that prohibited ex-post facto ECs "in any form or manner". Instead, it held that a "narrowly tailored amnesty scheme" may be permissible where justified by "supervening public interest".

• SC's EVOLVING ENVIRONMENTAL JURISPRUDENCE

MAR 14, 2017: The Environment Ministry issues notification establishing a six-month window for non-compliant projects or activities to apply for environmental clearance (EC). **AUG 2, 2017:** In *Common Cause v. Union of India*, the Supreme Court declares retrospective ECs invalid and 'completely alien to environmental jurisprudence'. **APR 1, 2020:** In *Alembic Pharmaceuticals Ltd v. Rohit Prajapati*, the Supreme Court reiterates 'ex post facto clearance is alien to environmental jurisprudence'. But adopts a 'balanced approach' by imposing penalties instead of ordering closure of long-operating units. **MAY 24, 2021:** The National Green Tribunal, in *Tanaji B. Gambhire v. Chief Secretary, Govt of Maharashtra*, directs Environment Ministry to formulate a proper SOP to address frequency of projects without prior EC. **JUL 7, 2021:** Ministry issues office memorandum (OM) establishing an SOP for projects that failed to obtain prior EC to get regularised after paying penalties. **DEC 9, 2021:** In *Electrosteel Steels Ltd v. Union of India*, Supreme Court says ex post facto ECs can be granted in 'exceptional circumstances' to protect livelihoods and the economy. **MAY 16, 2025:** In *Vanashakti v. Union of India*, Supreme Court strikes down 2017 notification and 2021 OM as illegal. It

rules that they were in violation of the principles laid down in *Common Cause* and *Alembic*. **NOV 18, 2025:** In review petition, the Supreme Court recalls May 2025 ruling. Then-CJI BR Gavai holds that the *Vanashakti* order went against the *Electrosteel* judgement and that a 'balanced approach' is necessary to avoid waste of money spent on building projects. SC orders fresh adjudication of the matter. **JUL 29, 2026:** Supreme Court upholds 2017 notification but quashes 2021 OM, holding that post facto EC can be granted only through statutory notifications, not administrative actions.

The judgment has sought to strike a middle path, closing the door on blanket regularisation but leaving limited room for government action

sued an OM introducing an SOP as an ongoing mechanism for violation cases.

Judicial evolution

In *Common Cause v. Union of India* (2017), a bench of Justices Madan B Lokur and Deepak Gupta held that mining operations requiring EC could not commence without prior approval. It emphasised that the EIA regime is preventive and intended to assess environmental consequences before irreversible harm occurs. In *Alembic Pharmaceuticals v. Rohit Prajapati* (2020), a bench of Justices DY Chandrachud and Ajay Rastogi held that ex-post facto EC was inconsistent with fundamental principles of environmental jurisprudence. The court observed that retrospective approval undermines the precautionary principle by allowing project proponents to commence activities first and seek approval later. However, in *Pahwa Plastics v. Dastak* (2022), a bench of Justices Indira Banerjee and J K Maheshwari adopted a more pragmatic approach that closure was not always the appropriate remedy, particularly where regulatory uncertainty existed and environmental compliance remained possible. The court held that regulation and remediation could, in some cases, better serve environmental protection than immediate closure.

Vanashakti litigation

In *Vanashakti v. Union of India*, a bench of Justices Abhay S Oka and Ujjal Bhuyan in May 2025 struck down both the March 2017 notification and the July 2021 OM, holding that ex-post facto ECs were impermissible "in any form or manner". The court also held that the one-time amnesty introduced in 2017 had exhausted itself and could not justify future regularisation. Following review petitions by the Union government and industry bodies, a bench comprising then Chief Justice of India B R Gavai and Justices Vinod Chandran and Ujjal Bhuyan recalled the May 2025 judgment by a 2:1 majority, holding that the earlier decision had failed to consider binding precedents and required fresh adjudication. The subsequent judgment now draws a distinction between a limited statutory amnesty justified by public interest and a continuing administrative mechanism that permits routine regularisation of environmental violations.

• POLICY

New paper leak Bill: Bigger fines, longer jail terms, fast-track courts

Damini Nath
New Delhi, July 30

AFTER DAYS of disruptions in both Houses of Parliament over the NEET paper leak and the police action on protesting students on July 20, Lok Sabha on Thursday passed the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 by voice vote. Rajya Sabha, which took the Bill up for discussion on Thursday, also cleared it by voice vote.

Why was the Bill introduced?

Parliament had passed the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 in 2024 to provide strict punishments for those involved in unfair means, including leaking of question papers, in examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, the Railway Recruitment Board, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection and the National Testing Agency, which conducts the NEET exam. The Act came into effect in June 2024. Amid the students' movement against paper leaks, sparked by the leak of the NEET UG paper in May this year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in a late-night so-

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Track record

- Cases registered in fast-track courts has gone up from 81,471 in 2023 to 88,902 in 2024 and 1,43,936 in 2025, according to a Parliamentary reply.
- The number of pending cases, too, has gone up from 2.02 lakh in 2023 to 2.04 lakh in 2024 and 2.45 lakh in 2025.
- Cases disposed of have increased from 76,319 in 2023 to 85,595 in 2024 to 66,500 in 2025.

What are its key features?

The amendment Bill, as passed by Lok Sabha, enhances punishment for individuals, organised groups and service providers found guilty of adopting unfair means in a public examination. The following is the structure of punishments laid out in the Bill:

INDIVIDUALS

- **2024 law:** Imprisonment of three to five years; fine upto Rs 10 lakh
- **New Bill:** Imprisonment to five to 10 years, fine upto Rs 50 lakh

SERVICE PROVIDERS

- **2024 law:** Fine upto Rs 1 crore; ban on being assigned any responsibility relating to a public examination for four years
- **New Bill:** Fine upto Rs 5 crore; ban on being assigned any responsibility relating to a public examination for eight years

DIRECTORS, SENIOR MANAGEMENT OR PERSONS IN-CHARGE OF SERVICE PROVIDER FIRM FOUND GUILTY

- **2024 law:** Imprisonment of at least three years; fine of Rs 1 crore
- **New Bill:** Imprisonment of at least five years, fine of Rs 5 crore

ORGANISED CRIME

- **2024 law:** Imprisonment of five to 10 years; fine of Rs 1 crore
- **New Bill:** Imprisonment of least seven years; fine of Rs 10 crore.

Apart from enhancing the existing punishments, the Bill also gives statutory back-

ing for fast-track courts to be set up to try offences under the Act. The Bill also mandates a five-month timeline for the investigation and trial of such offences by fast-track courts. The Bill gives the Union government the power to establish a Special Task Force to investigate offences under the Act.

How have other fast-track courts performed?

The government has announced that fast-track courts would be set up in the four High Courts where cases related to the NEET leak are ongoing. If the Bill is passed and comes into effect, any offence under the Act would also be tried by fast-track courts. In the past, the government has set up fast-track courts to try crimes under different laws, including the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012. In a reply in Lok Sabha on July 24, Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal said there were 775 fast-track courts in the country as on April 30, including 398 exclusive POCSO courts. As on December 31, 2025, there were 2.45 lakh cases pending with these fast-track courts, the Minister's reply showed.

CONSUMPTION CREDIT, LIKE PERSONAL LOANS & CREDIT CARDS, HAS EMERGED AS DOMINANT SEGMENT

Overleveraged borrowers jump 3x, credit expansion slows: CIBIL

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 30

INDIA'S DECADE-long expansion in formal credit has brought millions of first-time borrowers into the banking system, but the next phase of growth could be far more challenging as rising consumer indebtedness, slowing borrower growth and shrinking participation by first-time borrowers emerge as key concerns, according to a TransUnion CIBIL study.

A big warning sign is the steady increase in financially stretched borrowers. The share of overleveraged consumers rose threefold — from 5% in FY17 to 18% in FY24 — before easing marginally to 15% in FY26 after industry intervention, says the CIBIL report, *Unlocking Access: Journey of Credit Expansion in India*.

The excessive borrowing is concentrated largely among younger consumers, who have also been the fastest-growing segment of India's retail credit market. Another concern is the sharp slowdown in the pace of expansion of active borrowers. The proportion of credit-active consumers within the credit-eligible population also increased

during this period, from 11% in March 2017 to 28% in March 2026. However, the compounded annual growth rate of the credit-active consumer base moderated from 14% during the March 2017–March 2019 period to 9% during March 2024–March 2026 period, suggesting that the easy gains from financial inclusion may be tapering off, CIBIL said.

The pipeline of new borrowers is also shrinking. New-to-Credit (NTC) consumers accounted for 32% of retail loan originations in 2017 but their share has fallen to just 13% by 2026. This indicates that lenders are increasingly relying on repeat borrowers instead of expanding the formal credit net to households that have never borrowed before. "These numbers indicate significant opportunity to both deepen engagement with those already within the credit fold, and to bring new consumers into the formal credit ecosystem," CIBIL said.

The nature of borrowing has also undergone a significant shift. Consumption credit—including personal loans, credit cards and consumer durable finance—has emerged as the dominant segment, with the

• EMERGING HEADWINDS?

THE SHARE of over-leveraged consumers has risen threefold, from 5% in FY17 to 18% in FY24, before easing marginally to 15% in FY26 after industry intervention, the report said

THE EXCESSIVE borrowing is concentrated largely among younger consumers, who have also been the fastest-growing segment of India's retail credit market

THE SHARE of entities that have accessed commercial credit



declined from 50% to 41%

While this reflects widening financial inclusion beyond the country's established economic centres, it also places greater responsibility on lenders to maintain underwriting standards as lending expands rapidly into relatively newer markets.

The report nevertheless highlights the remarkable expansion of formal finance. The share of credit-eligible Indians who have borrowed at least once has increased from 35% in 2017 to 74% in 2026, while credit monitoring has risen sharply, pointing to growing financial awareness. Women borrowers increased their share from 22% in March 2017 to 30% in March 2026, while that of young borrowers rose from 33% to 39% in the same period.

"What also stands out is how India's state-wise credit heatmap has undergone a gradual but clear shift. While the traditionally dominant states in west and south India continue their strong credit uptake, states in north and central India have seen a remarkable rise in credit participation," said Bhavesh Jain, MD and CEO, TransUnion CIBIL.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

prises and medium, small and micro entrepreneurs into formal credit, it said.

This also shows that millions of micro and small enterprises continue to remain outside the organised credit system despite improved creditworthiness.

Geographically, the report finds that India's credit map is undergoing a structural shift. Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar have recorded faster growth in credit participation than traditional markets such as Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu.

share of active borrowers holding such products increasing from 34% to 51% over the period.

The study also flags concerns in the commercial lending ecosystem. Further, the share of entities that have accessed commercial credit declined from 50% to 41%, the credit-active share dipped from 10% to 9% and NTC also went down from 60% to 39% between quarter ended March 2021 and quarter ended March 2026. This indicates further capacity to bring eligible enter-

• EXPLORING HORIZONS

Vikram-1 of Skyroot Aerospace scripted history by becoming the first privately developed Indian rocket to reach the orbit on July 18. India's space tech ecosystem has now 285 companies, and 72 of them have received equity funding. Total equity funding has reached \$871 million across 241 rounds through July 2026.

INDIA'S FIRST PRIVATE ORBITAL LAUNCH MARKS A STRUCTURAL MILESTONE

TOTAL STARTUPS	ACTIVE STARTUPS	FUNDED STARTUPS	TOTAL EQUITY FUNDING	FUNDING ROUNDS
285	274	72	\$871MN	241

YoY Funding Trend in India's Space Tech Ecosystem (2021- 2026YTD)

YEAR	TOTAL EQUITY FUNDING (\$ MN)	NUMBER OF ROUNDS	SEED STAGE FUNDING (\$ MN)	EARLY STAGE FUNDING (\$ MN)	LATE STAGE FUNDING (\$ MN)
2021	43	12	14	30	—
2022	105	24	7	97	—
2023	142	35	15	127	—
2024	72	39	25	47	—
2025	200	53	62	121	17
2026 YTD	113	24	16	43	53

NOTE: TOTAL & STAGE WISE FUNDING DATA AS OF JUL 24, 2026; SOURCE: TRACKR.

EU FTA has enough safeguards to cushion CBAM impact, says Centre

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, July 30

THE FREE Trade Agreement (FTA) with the European Union (EU) has enough safeguards built-in to cushion the impact of the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) on Indian companies and ensures that they also benefit from any future relaxations in the carbon tax regime, a senior official said Thursday.

"CBAM (carbon border adjustment mechanism) took a lot of negotiating capital...In

the text, there is a separate Annexure on dealing with CBAM. The first pillar is that in case of flexibility in future (in CBAM), that will be available to India," additional secretary in the Department of Commerce Darpan Jain said at Indo-German Chamber of Commerce (IGCC) Industry Dialogue.

Jain also is the Chief negotiator of India-EU FTA.

CBAM compliances are a concern among Small and Medium Enterprises in terms of verification, in terms of finding out what is the value of em-

bedded carbon and ensuring that the verifiers are recognized by the EU authorities.

The agreement also has a provision in which India can engage with EU authorities on taking into account the carbon price, which is paid in India and adjusting it against the final carbon tax liability in the 27-member bloc.

"India is currently developing its own carbon pricing mechanism. So, how to offset what is paid in India from what is paid in Europe, so even that is part of it," he said. FE

RBI tightens transparency norms on bulk deposit rates, allows LCR-linked pricing

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 30

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) has tightened disclosure norms for deposit interest rates while simultaneously giving banks greater flexibility to price such deposits based on liquidity risks, a move that comes on the heels of HDFC Bank facing questions over the pricing of bulk deposits in the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) case.

The interest rates offered on deposits, including bulk deposits, should be uniform across all branches and for all customers and there should be no discrimination in the matter of interest paid on the deposits, between one deposit and another deposit of similar amount, accepted on the same date, at any of its offices, the RBI said while amending the guidelines.

Under the revised rules, banks will now be required to publish interest rates applicable to all deposits, including bulk deposits, on their websites in advance. More importantly, interest rates for bulk deposits must be displayed every business day by 10 AM, with a maximum grace period until 10.10 AM, the central bank said.

The exception

However, a bank will have the freedom to offer differential interest rate on bulk deposits, by considering the differential run-off rate applicable to deposits or unsecured wholesale funding under the LCR (liquidity coverage ratio) framework, as specified in the Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks – Asset Liability Management) Directions, 2025, the RBI said.

This will be applicable on rupee deposits of non-residents as well. If a liquidity crisis occurs, run-off rate is the proportion of the fund/ deposits likely to leave the bank. The bank



Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9fmIjMzg1 must hold enough High Quality Liquid Assets (HQLA) like cash held, government bonds and central bank reserves, to cover such stressed outflows.

The current run-off rate is 12.5%, including 2.5% of the deposits raised through digital channels. Higher run-off rates increase the bank's expected cash outflows, reduce the LCR (liquidity coverage ratio) ratio and require the bank to hold more liquid assets.

LCR indicates whether a bank has enough high-quality liquid assets.

The central bank on Thursday issued the Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks- Interest Rate on Deposits) Second Amendment Directions, 2026, which will come into effect from October 1, 2026.

On May 27, *The Indian Express* reported that the private sector lender had conducted an internal vigilance investigation into interest payments of Rs 45 crore, "camouflaged" as marketing expenditure, made to MSRDC for 2023-24 and 2024-25. The report further pointed that the internal investigation was ordered on March 12 by the Audit Committee of the board,

• BRIEFLY

Vedanta's Q1 profit jumps, Arun Misra named as CEO

Bengaluru: Indian metals-to-oil conglomerate Vedanta reported a 72% rise in consolidated net profit rose at Rs 5,473 crore (\$572.4 million) for the quarter ended June 30, helped by higher base metal prices. The company on Thursday named Arun Misra as its chief executive officer for a one-year term starting August 1. Misra currently heads Vedanta's subsidiary Hindustan Zinc and will step down to assume the new role. REUTERS

Maruti starts production at 4th Gujarat unit

New Delhi: Maruti Suzuki India Ltd (MSIL) on Thursday announced commencement of commercial production at the fourth plant of its Hansalpur facility in Gujarat. After the start of the fourth plant that has an annual capacity of 2.5 lakh units, the Hansalpur facility's total annual production capacity has been increased to 10 lakh units annually from 7.5 lakh units, MSIL said. "This marks the first time in Suzuki's history that the total annual production capacity at a single manufacturing facility has reached 1 million units," it said. PTI

• TIGHTER NORMS

UNDER THE revised rules, banks will now be required to publish interest rates applicable to all deposits, including bulk deposits, on their websites in advance

INTEREST RATES for bulk deposits must be displayed every business day by 10 AM, with a maximum grace period until 10.10 AM

THE LATEST RBI move is likely to make it harder for banks to negotiate rates for select clients without publicly reflecting those rates in their published schedules

just six days before Atanu Chakraborty abruptly resigned as the bank's part-time chairman, saying "certain happenings and practices within the bank are not in congruence with my personal values and ethics".

The internal audit of the bank's marketing department had flagged these payments and rated the department's performance as "unsatisfactory", investigation by The Indian Express showed. These payments were disguised as contributions to a road safety awareness campaign through local vendors.

The latest RBI move is likely to make it harder for banks to negotiate rates for select clients without publicly reflecting those rates in their published schedules.

The requirement for daily disclosures creates a transparent benchmark against which deposit pricing can be scrutinised by regulators, auditors and depositors.

Banks can now distinguish between categories of wholesale deposits based on how sticky or stable they are from a liquidity management perspective.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Pilot duty rules will turn aviation uncompetitive: IndiGo's Bhatia

New Delhi: IndiGo MD Rahul Bhatia has called for a review of India's pilot flight duty time rules, saying these norms erode cockpit productivity, inflate airline costs and make the country's aviation sector "uncompetitive" compared with global peers. "I think Flight Duty Time Limitations needs a review, and I think there's enough conversation going on with the government," Bhatia told PTI in an interview. PTI

GSTN defers e-way bill enhancements

New Delhi: GST Network has put on hold two proposed e-way bill enhancements after hearing industry feedback on the proposal. The two enhancements that were proposed to be implemented from August 1 were the mandatory capture of the 'Ship-To GSTIN' in Bill to 'Ship-to-transactions', aimed at improving the identification of the actual recipient of goods and strengthening traceability. The second enhancement was the introduction of a 'voluntary closure' facility. PTI

• AN ASSOCIATION REPRESENTING 50 RENEWABLE ENERGY FIRMS HAS SOUGHT FINANCIAL RELIEF FOR PROJECTS FACING STRESS DUE TO TRANSMISSION CONSTRAINTS

Transmission hurdles pushing green energy projects into distress

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 30

INDIA'S RAPIDLY expanding renewable energy sector is grappling with a major challenge: transmission constraints. Close to 21 gigawatts (GW), that is about 9% of the country's installed renewable energy capacity, is currently being evacuated through temporary grid connections while awaiting dedicated transmission infrastructure.

Of this, around 12 GW faces restrictions on power evacuation during periods of peak solar generation, exposing developers to revenue losses and raising concerns over the financial viability of several projects. Power evacuation is the process of transferring electricity generated at a power plant to the consumption point.

During the financial year 2025-26 (FY26), around 6,900 gigawatt-hour (GWh) of clean

electricity faced restrictions due to a mismatch between the rapid pace of renewable energy deployment and commissioning of associated transmission infrastructure, latest government data shows.

These projects operate under Temporary General Network Access (T-GNA), a stopgap arrangement for renewable energy plants awaiting commissioning of associated transmission infrastructure.

Under the current GNA framework, inter-state transmission system (ISTS)-connected renewable energy projects with long-term GNA are granted firm transmission evacuation rights. T-GNA projects, however, can schedule power only if spare transmission capacity is available. During periods of network congestion, long-term GNA projects receive priority, often resulting in curtailment of generation from T-GNA-con-



Around 6,900 GWh of clean electricity faced restrictions during financial year 2025-26. REUTERS

nected plants.

According to developers, the curtailment faced by these projects are as high as 70-80% of their generating capacity, posing serious concern on project viability and debt servicing.

Electricity curtailment is the intentional reduction of power output from renewable generators.

Financial stress

While renewable energy sources, such as solar, enjoy "must-run" status in India, they can still be backed down on grounds of grid security, technical constraints and transmission bottlenecks.

During April-June, the grid operators had to curtail 8,133 GWh of electricity generated by solar power sources due to

transmission bottlenecks and to maintain grid security, latest government data showed.

Developers are compensated for grid-security-related backing down, but curtailment caused by transmission bottlenecks — particularly for projects operating under T-GNA — has emerged as a key concern, eroding revenues and threatening project viability.

On July 22, the Sustainable Project Developers Association (SPDA), which represents over 50 leading renewable energy companies, wrote to the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) seeking financial relief for projects facing stress due to transmission constraints.

"At present, a large number of renewable energy projects are experiencing financial stress primarily due to delays in the availability of evacuation infrastructure, which are outside the control of project developers," the letter accessed by

The Indian Express read.

"While developers continue to incur interest during construction, commitment charges, IDC, O&M expenses and other fixed costs, project revenues remain deferred until transmission systems become operational," it added.

The association urged the MNRE to take up the matter with the Ministry of Finance, the Reserve Bank of India, and financial institutions to facilitate financial relief for affected projects. Among the measures sought were moratorium on repayment of principal for the period of transmission delay, interest-free or concessional bridge financing for the affected period, extension of loan repayment tenure without adverse credit implications, and restructuring of project debt without downgrading asset classification, where appropriate.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

IRGC CLAIMS IT STRUCK U.S. ASSETS IN JORDAN & KUWAIT; U.S. SAYS IT HIT GUARDS' HQ & DRONE FACILITIES

Can China restrain Iran? Gulf states test Beijing's influence

Reuters
Beirut, Riyadh, July 30

AS THE Iran war escalates again, Gulf Arab states are looking to China - not Washington - to use its economic leverage over Iran to open up the Strait of Hormuz and Red Sea, testing how far Beijing is able and willing to pressurise Tehran. The Gulf push for a bigger Chinese role is driven by growing frustration, Gulf sources say. The war launched with US-Israeli attacks on Iran on February 28 has hurt their regional foe but also restricted their vital energy exports and, to varying degrees, put them in the firing line.

With Iran and its allies threatening the Bab el-Mandeb waterway in the Red Sea as well as Hormuz, Gulf states have sought Beijing's help, conscious that the war has exposed the limits of American power, three regional sources say.

China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi has held dozens of calls and meetings with counterparts seeking a new ceasefire, while special envoy Zhai Jun has held talks in Gulf Arab capitals as well as Iran.

"China has maintained close communication with all parties, and has consistently worked to stop the fighting and

promote peace," its foreign ministry said in response to a request for comment.

China's position as both a major buyer of oil from across the Gulf and Iran's biggest trading partner presents opportunities but also sensitivities.

"There's huge respect between the Gulf and China and they are a big trading partner, so any issue is raised in a very quiet manner," one Gulf source said.

Iran says it will maintain control over the Strait of Hormuz, noting it was attacked during negotiations over the nuclear programme the US and Israel have vowed to destroy.

Gulf governments ultimately hope that Beijing will steer Tehran toward a negotiated settlement, said the source, adding that China often moves slowly and cautiously. But they are aware that a prolonged war may also serve China's interest by piling pressure on the US states.

China has developed close trade and investment ties with the six states in the Gulf Cooperation Council - Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates - since a Gulf-China summit in 2022. Another summit is planned this year in Riyadh but not yet confirmed.

Drone strike near Suez Canal raises more security threats

Reuters
Dubai, July 30

A DRONE strike on gas vessels in Egypt's Mediterranean port of Damietta signalled a potential new front in the US-Iran war, raising the prospect of threats to navigation through the Suez Canal, one of the last remaining export routes for Saudi oil.

Egypt's cabinet said on Thursday that an initial investigation found an unidentified drone caused a fire on two vessels at Damietta port on Wednesday. The port lies near the Suez Canal, which links the Mediterranean and Red Seas.

No group has claimed responsibility, the cabinet said. Sources said the drone hit US-owned gas storage tanker Energos Winter, causing a fire that spread to a second vessel.

Overnight, the US military said it struck Iran's Revolutionary Guards' military command centres and drone facilities after Tehran fired at US forces in the region.

Iranian state media, quoting the Guards, said US strikes killed three civilians and wounded two children on Qeshm Island, while three Guards members were killed in Zanjan province.

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps said it struck the Azraq military base in Jordan in response, attacking US F-35



A screen grab of a social media video shows smoke rising after US strikes on Ahvaz city in Iran's Khuzestan province on Thursday. REUTERS

fighter jets. The US military denied this, saying no aircraft had been destroyed or damaged.

"All missiles and drones were intercepted, or failed to reach targeted areas," Central Command said. US bases in Jordan have lately become primary Iranian targets.

Jordan's armed forces said earlier on Thursday they had intercepted five Iranian missiles.

The Guards also struck US assets at Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait, according to Iran's

Tasnim news agency.

An Iranian attack hit a building owned by a Chinese company in northern Kuwait, killing a worker and inflicting significant damage, Kuwait's Defence Ministry said.

In a first in the five-month war, Saudi Arabia on Wednesday publicly joined strikes alongside US forces, targeting Iran-aligned groups in eastern Iraq, in retaliation for drone attacks on Saudi oil targets launched from Iraq.

Saudi unveils plan for maritime defence coalition

Riyadh: Saudi Arabia Thursday unveiled plans for a multinational maritime defence coalition aimed at protecting international shipping and energy supply routes in Red Sea after attacks by Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis disrupted one of world's busiest trade corridors.

The Saudi defence ministry said representatives from 43 countries and the European Union attended an international meeting that discussed the proposed coalition, including Saudi Arabia serving as its founding and leading state and hosting its headquarters. REUTERS

Another Iran-aligned group, Yemen's Houthis, carried out the attacks on Saudi Arabia from Iraqi territory in coordination with Iraqi groups, according to assessments by Saudi Arabia and regional partners.

The latest strikes in Iraq and Egypt threatened to draw more West Asian countries into the conflict after the Houthi militants declared a naval blockade last week on Saudi Arabia, threatening the alternative Red Sea route for its oil to Asia.

RUSSIA-UKRAINE WAR



Rescuers work at the site of houses hit by a Russian missile strike in Dnipropetrovsk region of Ukraine on Thursday. REUTERS

Russian attacks kill 10; NATO scrambles jets after a missile lands in Poland

Associated Press
Kyiv, July 30

A RUSSIAN ballistic missile and drone barrage across Ukraine overnight killed at least 10 civilians, including children, and injured more than 50 others, officials said Thursday, and NATO scrambled its warplanes after one of the missiles crossed the country's western border into Poland.

The blitz expanded Russia's almost daily bombardment of Ukrainian cities, including the capital of Kyiv where tens of thousands spent the night sheltering in subway stations, as Moscow apparently looked to exploit Kyiv's critical shortage of Western-supplied anti-ballistic missile defenses.

NATO said a Russian missile entered Polish airspace during the onslaught and landed in a rural area. It caused no injuries or damage but could deepen tensions between the military alliance and Moscow, as wary European countries

fear the 4-year-old war could spill into their territory.

NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte called it "yet another reckless act by Russia and a dangerous consequence of its war against Ukraine."

Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk said it was "a very serious incident," but added: "There are absolutely no reasons to believe that Poland was the target."

Russia's barrage struck areas of Ukraine where weapons are believed to be stored and manufactured. Ukrainian long-range drones and missiles have battered Russia's oil sector, causing a fuel crisis.

"Given the critical shortage of air defense missiles from our partners, our warriors are accomplishing truly incredible things, demonstrating a very high level of professionalism," Zelenskyy said on social media.

"This Russian terror once again proves that protection against the Russian missile threat is the most important task when it comes to saving the lives of our people," he said.

Russia detains billionaire, govt official in drone fraud probe

Reuters
Moscow, July 30

RUSSIAN BILLIONAIRE Valery Kustov, executives of his Efko company and a government official responsible for drone development have all been detained in a major fraud investigation, news outlets reported on Thursday.

Kustov is the founder, controlling shareholder and board chairman of Efko, which is active in drone production as well as being Russia's leading sunflower oil producer.

Three other Efko officials were also detained, according to the reports by Interfax news agency and others. The trade and industry ministry con-

firmed the detention of Alla Polovchenya, deputy head of its department of unmanned systems and robotics.

Mash, a news outlet known for its sources in Russian law enforcement, said the Efko officials were suspected of covertly purchasing drones from China and passing them off as company's own proprietary development.

Efko in a statement expressed support for its detained employees and urged people to refrain from speculation.

The Efko group has been involved with drones since 2021 through a venture called Future Transport that describes itself as "a leader in the development and production of unmanned aerial vehicles in Russia."

BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Fauci invokes the 5th Amendment in Senate committee hearing



Anthony Fauci at the hearing on Wednesday. FILE

DR ANTHONY Fauci on Wednesday repeatedly invoked the Fifth Amendment and declined to answer dozens of questions from senators in a Republican-led committee hearing about his handling of the COVID-19 pandemic. Though he received a pardon in early 2025 from Democratic President Joe Biden, some Republicans pursuing a campaign for his arrest suggested he could still face charges for perjury committed during the hearing. AP

Gaza truce talks see rare progress even as Israeli airstrikes kill six



Palestinians mourn at the funeral of people killed in Israeli strikes in Khan Younis on Thursday. REUTERS

Reuters
Cairo, July 30

TALKS BETWEEN mediators and Hamas leaders in Cairo on implementing a US-brokered Gaza peace plan have made rare progress, sources close to the effort said on Thursday, although an Israeli official said proposed terms were not satisfactory. Earlier, Israeli strikes killed at least six Palestinians in Gaza Thursday, including two children.

A Hamas official and a diplomat close to the Cairo talks said discussions were "positive" and "making progress".

The official said the progress would be tested by Israel's response and whether this allowed a broad accord to be reached. However, the Israeli official, who declined to be identified, said Israel had rejected a proposal.

"Israel demands complete disarmament of Hamas, including the removal of weapons from Gaza and complete demilitarization of the Strip as a precondition for any process," the official said.

"The 15-point document in question does not provide a satisfactory response to these demands and Israel conveyed its objections."

Tension grips PoK as clashes continue amid elections

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, July 30

TENSIONS PREVAILED in Rawalkot region in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) on Thursday as clashes continued between security forces and the banned Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC).

The tensions, which have claimed several lives this week, coincide with ongoing regional elections in PoK, with demonstrators affiliated with JAAC determined to march towards Muzaffarabad to press Islamabad to accept their demands.

The JAAC is a collective of activist groups which have been staging demonstrations for nearly two months over 12 contentious seats of the so-called legislative assembly in PoK.

It alleges that the establishment manoeuvres these seats to install a prime minister of its choosing.

In PoK, clashes between security forces and protesters have intensified since Monday, especially in Rawalkot and Mirpur, which reportedly resulted in maximum casualties.

According to the JAAC, at least 37 men lost their lives in the clashes.

"The number of those in-



People rally in support of PoK protestors during a demonstration in Islamabad on Wednesday. REUTERS

jured remains unknown. Amid heavy gunfire, our people have continued to stand peacefully

and unarmed. God willing, our peaceful struggle against oppression and injustice will con-

tinue," it said in a statement.

However, the Pakistan government denied any death of civilians saying militants of the banned Tehrik-e Taliban are present among the protesters and crackdown against them will continue.

"We will not talk to the protesters and law will take its course," Pakistan State Minister for Interior Affairs Talal Chaudhary said.

Amnesty International and the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan have expressed concerns over reports of violence in the region, calling on the authorities to probe the incidents.

Wildfires rage across Europe even as France and Spain see some respite

Reuters
Bordeaux, Madrid, Athens, July 23

FRANCE, SPAIN and Greece battled major wildfires on Thursday, with Spain bringing one blaze under control but facing new threats as intense heat, dry vegetation and powerful winds kept much of southern Europe on alert.

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez downgraded the emergency level for a major fire on the border between Madrid and Castilla y Leon, but warned the danger had not passed as at least 10 other blazes caused concern across the country.

In France, two people were arrested on suspicion of arson as crews contained a vast fire near Bordeaux, while fires in Greece killed three firefighters and forced tourists and residents to flee parts of Crete, some by boat.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6GJKOH6oBd0F

"We barely made it... we were running and the fire was behind us, chasing us," said Lia Galata, a Greek seasonal tourism worker who found shelter in an indoor gym and had to be evacuated by boat as a blaze tore through the hills above a resort on Crete late Wednesday.

"We have difficult days ahead of us," Greek Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis said.

Emergency crews have faced barely a pause between heatwaves and fire fronts this summer across an increasingly tinder-dry Europe, the world's fastest-warming continent.

In eastern England, firefighters were tackling a significant wildfire at Dunwich Heath, prompting the evacuation of about 200 caravans from the area, a significant biodiversity site. Suffolk Fire and Rescue Service called the blaze one of the most challenging incidents.

Clooney family forced to flee 'beautiful home'

Paris: George Clooney has said his family has been forced to evacuate their home in southern France as a wildfire burned nearby, his agent said Thursday. The Hollywood star behind the Ocean's Eleven franchise and other films made the statement in a letter to Didier Bremond, mayor of Brignoles, publicist Guido Gotz said.

"At this point we have no idea whether our beautiful home makes it through this terrible moment"... Amal and I are committed to making sure that whatever happens to our village" Clooney wrote, referring to his wife Amal. REUTERS

Toll now three as clashes spread in Nepal's Tarai; Balen vows stern action

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, July 30

NEPAL PRIME Minister Balendra Shah promised stringent and effective measures against those responsible for rioting and clashes in parts of eastern Nepal.

In a six-minute televised address to the nation, he said investigation has already begun into the violence that erupted in Sundari district and spread to other areas, and no one found guilty would be spared.

The PM said Nepal's constitution guarantees equal rights to all citizens to pursue and practise all religions and the government is determined to protect those rights. "No religion preaches hatred and intolerance," he added.

Shah came under fierce criti-

cism for his continued absence in Parliament even as death toll rose to three in continuing communal clashes since Monday.

Shah and Home Minister Sudhan Gurung were both absent in the House as Opposition members demanded that they come and explain the situation in curfew-hit Sunsari and Siraha districts in eastern Nepal where the army is deployed to restore law and order.

The situation in the two districts flared up on Thursday as a 15-year-old boy, Ganesh Yadav, died in Golbazar area of Siraha district as protestors indulged in arson, burned down a few houses and attacked a shopping mall. They were demanding stern action against the culprits who attacked "pilgrims" in adjoining Sunsari Monday night.

US govt map of Africa mislabels every country at global meet

Reuters
July 30

A US government map of Africa mislabeled every country during a State Department presentation at a global conference taking place in Brazil this week, causing a stir among attendees who took screenshots and posted them online.

Reuters viewed a video of the presentation given at the AIDS 2026 conference in Rio de Janeiro, which shows the errant map displayed halfway during a presentation about State Department's new health agreements.

A Reuters analysis found the image of the map in the presentation contained an AI watermark signalling it was made

with OpenAI tools. The company said it was probing report.

The State Department said it took "full responsibility" for confusion caused and that the map had been produced by a team member who hastily changed the slide deck before the event.

The map showed Nigeria, where the US currently has several hundred troops deployed, as landlocked in the Sahara Desert. Mozambique, which is in south-eastern Africa, was relocated to Horn of Africa, while Ivory Coast in West Africa was placed on the other side of the continent.

In a statement, the State Department said: "We take full responsibility for the confusion... it caused for attendees, including our African partners."

FOUND INSIDE A TEA CRATE BRICKED INTO A SEALED FIREPLACE; LATE RETURN FINE WOULD BE AROUND \$19500, ALLOWING FOR INFLATION

Overdue for 150 years, book finally returns to Australian library

Rod McGuirk
Melbourne, July 30

AN AUSTRALIAN public library has had a book returned an estimated 150 years late and has no way of tracking down the errant borrower, a librarian said on Thursday.

The book Antiquities of Athens, published in 1858, was returned to the library in the seaside town of Kiama last week by a man who had found it during recent home renovations inside a tea crate bricked into a sealed fireplace, Kiama Library manager Michelle Hudson said.

"We've never had anything that old come back to us," Hudson said.

"I follow lots of libraries on social media and often you'll get things that are maybe 30 or 40 years old when they're cleaning out estates and stuff like that," she added.

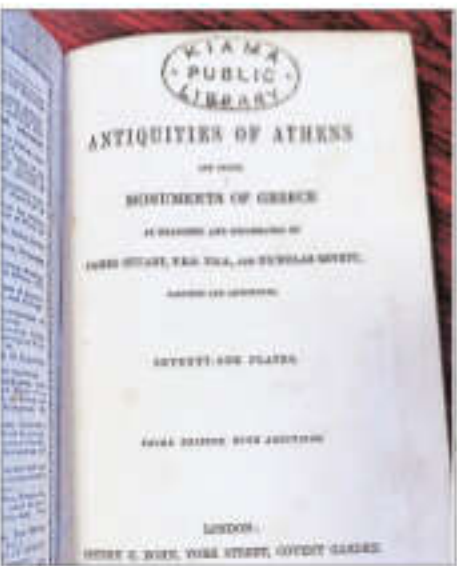
The book's finder did not immediately respond to The Associated Press's request for comment. The late return fine would be around 28,000 Australian dollars (\$19,500), allowing for inflation, Hudson said.

That was calculated on the British three pence-a-week overdue fee that was printed on the inside cover of the book, along with a list of rules that applied when the library opened in 1872.

But Hudson said there was no way of tracing the final bor-



Library manager Michelle Hudson holds Antiquities of Athens after its return; the library-stamped page from the book. AP



rower who had accrued the debt. The library journal from the 1870s that recorded who

borrowed a book and when had been lost. "Unfortunately, we have a

missing link. There's nothing in the book that tells us who the last borrower was," Hudson said.

Library rules in the 1870s stated that a book had to be returned and an overdue debt paid before another book could be borrowed. "Maybe that's why they never returned it to us," Hudson said.

Antiquated rules of the day included that up to three books could be borrowed by households in which at least six members were "known to be able to read." Proof of reading ability is no longer required to use today's library.

In the 1870s, books were not lent to people who arrived at the library in a "state of intoxica-

tion." Library users are now asked to leave if their behavior impacts others, but the rules are not specific about intoxication.

The book, which has some water damage from its years under a chimney, was marked as No. 506 in the library's original collection of around 1,000 books, Hudson said.

She expects the book was lost within a few years of the library opening.

The returned book will be displayed in the library's local history collection.

"We're not going to allow it to go back out again. We don't want to wait another 150 years for this book to be returned," Hudson said. AP

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Geeta Singh D/o Virendra Singh,R/o C-04,Brisk Lumbini,Sector-109, Gurugram(Haryana)-122017,have changed my minor Son's name from Rajyavardhan Singh to Ranveer Singh. 0040869188-3

I, Anil Kumar Sharma, S/o Ram Dutt Sharma, R/o A-034, Site-C Extension, Phase-1, UPSIDC, Site-C, Greater Noida, Distt G.B Nagar, U.P have Changed my name Anil Kumar to Anil Kumar Sharma, for all future purposes. 0071051031-1

I, Aliza, W/o Mohd Haider, R/o 728 Phatak Dhoiyan, Farash khana Delhi-110006 have changed my name to Aliza Arafeen 0040869176-2

I,SAPNA W/O SUMIT DHINGRA, R/o-L-63, UGF, Gali-No-19, New Mahavir Nagar, Tilak-Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have changed my name to SAPNA DHINGRA permanently. 0040869188-8

I Ravinder Kaur, W/o Chittrranjan Singh Mann, R/o 13/95, Subhash Nagar, Delhi-110027 have changed my name to Ravinder Kaur Mann for all purposes. 0040869064-1

I,KAPURI W/O NO.13817904F RANK Ex SFP (LATE) BENI RAM R/o H.NO.E-88, STREET NO.4, ASHOK NAGAR SHAHDARA, DELHI-110093 have changed my name to KAPOORI DEVI vide affidavit date 29-7-2026 before Delhi. 0071051005-1

I, Rajeev Sharma, Resident of 72, Sai City, Shahberi, Behind Radha Swami Ashram, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301 have changed my minor daughter's name from Princi Sharma to Amaira Sharma. Henceforth she would be known by the name of Amaira Sharma for all purposes. 0071051035-1

I,BIRENDER KUMAR SAH,S/O GANGA PRASAD,R/O 853 B-1 JAIN NAGAR KARALA DELHI-110081.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BIRENDER KUMAR SHAHU. 0040869188-1

I, Kiran Devi, D/o Sh.Shyam Lal, R/o-Gabhiya, Badaun, Uttar Pradesh-243601, have changed my name Kiran Devi to Kiran, for all future purposes. 0040869063-1

I,NARESH KUMAR,S/O- RAMESHWAR DASS JAIN,R/O-132-133, 2ND FLOOR, POCKET-12, SECTOR-24, ROHINI DELHI-110085, have changed my name to NARESH KUMAR JAIN 0040869177-5

I,Shankar Prasad S/o-Bishnath Prasad,R/o Near Ram Mandir,Ward No.17, Sohna, Gurugram,(Haryana)-122103, have changed my name to Shankar. 0040869196-7

I, Anil Kumar Singh S/o Late Sh. Lallu Singh R/o F-4/80-81, Ground Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110089, declare that my name is written as A K Singh on school document of my daughter, Taruni Singh. Anil kumar Singh and A K Singh are one and the same person. 0040869104-1

I,Aishani Ajay Kumar Goenka D/o Ajay Kumar Goenka R/o C-3101,Gulshan Dynasty, Sector-144,Noida, G.B.Nagar,have changed my name to Aishani Goenka. 0040869176-4

I,Yatharth Sharma,S/o Sh.Rama Shankar Sharma, R/o-18/6,Railway Colony,Kishan Ganj, Delhi-110007,inform that YATHARTH SHARMA & ANKIT,both names are same person.My correct name YATHARTH SHARMA,for all,future purposes. 0040869188-10

I,MANVI D/O CHATTAR PAL R/O NEAR LAL KUAN, VILLAGE-JHARSA, GURGAON, PO: GURGAON, DIST: GURGAON, HARYANA-122001, have changed my name to MANVI CHAUHAN for all purposes. 0071050739-1

I Ashish Kumar S/o Madan Gopal Sharma R/o H.No. 13-B, 13-C, Kharsa No. 74/4, Block K-2, Krishan Vihar, Delhi-110086 declares that in my son Anshu Kumar School Record my and my wife name wrongly mentioned as Ashish Sharma And Sunita Sharma but our correct name is Ashish Kumar And Sunita. 0040869193-2

I,SARABJIT KAUR D/o NO.1587417M RANK Ex HAV (LATE) RAJENDER SINGH R/o F-1/225 BLOCK-F PKT-1 SECTOR-16, ROHINI DELHI-110089 have changed my name to SARBHJEET KAUR vide affidavit date -29-7-2026 before Delhi. 0071051010-1

I, Navel Deep, S/o Satnam Singh, resident of Flat No-S-1206, 12th Floor,Tower S, Stellar Jeevan, Sector-1 Greater Noida West, Bissrakh, Dadri, Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh, 201306, have changed my name from Navel Deep to Naveedeeep Singh. Henceforth I will be known as Naveedeeep Singh for all future purposes. ("Navel Deep" is the old name and "Naveedeeep Singh" is the new name.) 0040869125-1

I,VKILA/VAKILA W/o Liyakat Ali R/o K-178, Street No.4, Gautam Vihar, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to VAKILA BEGUM permanently. 0040869188-3

I, Chander Prakash,S/o Manohar Lal Tayal R/o-55/301, Buildcon View-Apartments, Ber-Sarai, Delhi have changed my name to Chander Prakash Tayal. 0040869063-3

I,QUAMARUL NISHA W/O NIZAMUDDIN, R/o H.NO.-26/1-B, Parwana Road, Khureji Khas, East Delhi-110051, have changed my name to KAMARUNNISHA 0071050949-1

I, RAMKAYAM father of, Kanta Prasad, Presently residing at, Village-Leelapur, Tehsil & Distt.Chandauli, Uttar Pradesh-232104, have changed my name, from RAMKAYAM to RAMLAKHAN. Vide affidavit dated 29.07.2026. 0040869196-9

I,ALFAIZ,S/O-MOHD HAROON R/O-N92 BATLA,HOUSE JAMIANAGAR SOUTH EAST DELHI 110025 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME MOHAMMAD ALFAIZ PERMANENTLY 0040869176-6

I,Rohit Kumar,S/o-Rakesh Babu,R/o-A-518,Street-1,4th Pusta Kartar Nagar,South Gamri Ext.North East,Delhi-110053,my son Prakash Diwakar School Records my and my wife names are wrongly mentioned/written as Rohit Kumar Diwakar and Neeraj Diwakar instead of Rohit kumar and Neeraj Kumari.Which may be amended accordingly. 0040869188-12

I,Kavita W/o Sanjay Dabas,R/o H.No-330, Harshuke Pana,Near Society Stand, Pooth Khurd,Delhi-110039 have changed my name to Kavita Dabas. 0040869196-2

I, RITIK SHRIVASTAVA S/o Sandeep Shrivastav R/o-A-117, Raj Park, Sultanpuri, Delhi-86 have changed my name to RITIK SHRIVASTAV. 0071051014-1

I, Hans Raj S/o Ishar Das Dua R/o Flat No-209, Munirka Vihar, Dist: South West Delhi-110067, have changed my name to Hans Raj Dua 0071051073-1

I,KAMAL NEGI,W/o-KULENDRA SINGH NEGI,residing at,R-1401,Rose-Tower, Fragrance-Homes,Near-TNT,Siddharth-Vihar,PO,Vijay-Nagar,Ghaziaba d,Uttar Pradesh-201009,declares that the names of KAMLESH RAWAT and KAMAL NEGI,both are the same-person. 0040869188-5

I, MOHAMMAD MERAJUDDIN, S/o ABDUL LATIF, R/O House No.C-34, Gali No.4, C-Block, Ghonda Extension, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to MD. MERAJUDDIN, for all purposes. 0040869068-1

I, Kartikey s/o Sunaina Dua R/o B-19, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to KARTIKEY DUA 0040869110-1

I, Anuj Kumar Singh S/o Naresh Singh R/o Village Sattar, Post-Sattar, Sattar, Aurangabad, Sattar, Bihar-824301, have changed my minor daughter's name from Annya kumari aged 15 years to Ananya Kumari forever 0040869188-9

I,B, SIREESHA, spouse of, BORA KIRAN KUMAR, resident of, SMQ-26/202, Tejas Enclave, Airforce-Station Sohna-Road, Sector-33, Gurgaon, HR-122001, have changed my name, from B. SIREESHA to BORA SIREESHA, vide affidavit, dated 24-07-2026, before non judicial-court, Delhi. 0040869196-11

I,MOHAMMAD ALI,S/O-NASIBUDEEN,R/O-HNO-A-616/13,S/O-NO-13 MANDOLI-EXTN CHOTI MASJID-MANDOLI,north east-delli-110093, have changed my name MOHAMAD ALI ALIS MOHAMAND ALI TO MOHAMMAD ALI, For all, further purpose 0040869176-8

I,KAVITA MANN,W/O DEVENDER MANN,R/O-121, 2ND FLOOR, POCKET-3, SECTOR-23, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to KAVITA RANI 0040869177-2

I,GARIMA W/O Bharat Raheja R/O-C-2/116 Phase-2, Pragati Market Ashok Vihar Delhi-110052, have changed my name to GARIMA RAHEJA 0040869196-4

I, Mohit, S/o Naresh Kumar Pruthi, residing at M-28, GS Apartments, Sector-13, Rohini, Delhi -110085, have changed my name to Mohit Pruthi for all purposes. 0071051019-1

I,Divya Rai W/o-Sanjay Kumar Rai Address-75D/B5,Dhawalgiri apartment sector 34, noida Gautam budh nagar Uttar Pradesh-201307, changed my name to Divya 0040869176-1

I, Navel Deep, S/o Satnam Singh, resident of Flat No-S-1206, 12th Floor,Tower S, Stellar Jeevan, Sector-1 Greater Noida West, Bissrakh, Dadri, Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh, 201306, have changed my name from Navel Deep to Naveedeeep Singh. Henceforth I will be known as Naveedeeep Singh for all future purposes. ("Navel Deep" is the old name and "Naveedeeep Singh" is the new name.) 0040869125-1

I,DEVENDRA DATT BHATT ALIAS D, DUTT ALIAS DEVENDRA DATT,S/O-LATE SHRI RAM BHATT,R/O-FLAT NO.206.C-26,SURYA NAGAR, GHAZIABAD, UP-201011, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS DEVENDRA DATT BHATT. 0040869188-7

I,DEVENDRA DATT BHATT ALIAS D, DUTT ALIAS DEVENDRA DATT,S/O-LATE SHRI RAM BHATT,R/O-FLAT NO.206.C-26,SURYA NAGAR, GHAZIABAD, UP-201011, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS DEVENDRA DATT BHATT. 0040869188-7

I, Mohd Babar S/o Abrar Husain R/o-30, Neknampur, Fuldi, Hapur, UP have changed my name to Mohd Babar Khan. 0071051000-1

I,hitherto known as Ashish Bansal, S/O-Narendar Singh, R/O-140, Sirol, Choti-Nehar, Gurjar, Shivoli, Ghaziabad, Badshahpur-Sirauli, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, 201102, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ASHISH BAISLA. 0040869196-13

I, NISHI SHARMA, W/o Kirti Pachauri, R/O C-109, Sector-36, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, do hereby declare that I have changed my name from NISHI SHARMA to NISHI PACHAURI for all future purposes. 0071051037-1

I, Omprakash S/o, Hiramani Jakhmola, R/O-RZG-108, 2nd Floor, Raj Nagar, Part-2, Palam Colony, South-West Delhi, Delhi-110077, have changed my name from Omprakash to Omprakash Jakhmola, for all future purposes. 0040869176-10

I, SHAM LAL S/O-SHRI NIWAS GOYAL, R/O-156, POCKET-13, SECTOR-3, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to SHYAM LAL GOYAL 0040869177-4

I, Sanjeev Kumar, S/o-Om Prakash Gupta R/O A-1004, NBCC Heights, Patadaul Road, Sector-89, Garhi Harsaru, Gurugram (HR.), 122505 have changed my name to Sanjeev Gupta. 0040869196-6

“Sanjay Khanna” & “Rani Khanna” in Priyanka Khanna's Class X marksheet refer to Sanjay & Rani, IN-DL64632495496003Y. 0130067422-1

I, Sunny s/o Sachin R/o-464/28 West Ram Nagar sonipat, have changed my name to Sunny kumar, for all purposes. 0040869177-1

I, Nisha Ajay Kumar Goenka W/o Ajay Kumar Goenka R/o C-3101, Gulshan Dynasty, Sector-144, Noida, G.B. Nagar, have changed my name to Nisha Goenka. 0040869176-3

I, Ali Hussain alias Ali Husain alias Ali Husain Rizvi, S/o-Late Manzoor Hussain, R/o-H.No.-25, Gali No.-4, Rashid Market Extension, Krishna-Nagar, Delhi-110051, declare that Ali Hussain, Ali Husain and Ali Husain Rizvi these names belong to me as same and one person. 0040869188-9

I, LAXMIKANT S/O RAJ MURTI CHATURVEDI R/O A-408 BLOCK -A, NEW ASHOK NAGAR DELHI EAST DELHI 110096 have changed my name LAXMI KANT CHATURVEDI for all future purpose 0071051009-1

I, GANGA PRASAD SAH, S/O-SARJUG SHAH R/O-848-B/2 SHIV-MANDIR BLO.TIRTHANKAR NAGAR JAIN NAGAR VILL, KARALA, DELHI-110081, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GANGA PRASAD. 0040869188-2

I, Jitendra Kumar S/o Shyam Sundra Prasad, R/O C-268, 1st Floor, Sector-19, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-201301, inform that in my Bachelor of Engineering Degree Certificate & Marksheet PRN No. 62656219L provided by North Maharashtra University, Jalgaon, Maharashtra, my name has been recorded as Jeetendra Kumar, whereas my true and correct name is Jitendra Kumar 0040869193-1

I, Mohd Islam Saifi S/o Din Mohammad, R/O H.NO- J-55, Gali no.12/3, Ramesh Park, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to ISLAM 0071050948-1

I, KUSUM, W/o Sh.Raj Kishor, R/o, H.No. T-1/A-1, Second-Floor, Prem Nagar Road, Baijeet-Nagar, New Delhi-110008, have changed my name to KUSUM DEVI for all-purposes. 0040869196-8

I, RAM BABOO SINGH, S/O-RAM CHARAN SINGH, H.NO-332, INDIRA COLONY, SHAHGANJ-1, AGRA UTTAR PRADESH-282010, HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO RAM BABU SINGH 0040869196-5

I, Arun Kumar, s/o-Ram Dhan, R/o H.no.11, Second Floor, Road No.5, East Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi-110026, also known as Arun Kumar Wadhwa. Both are one and the same person. It is requested to consider my name as Arun Kumar, for all purposes. 0040869188-11

LOST & FOUND

Original-DDA FDR RECEIPT/APPLICATION NO-36185 AND PRIORITY NO-13385, belonging to GURBACHAN SINGH ARORA, S/O-LATE SH JAGTAR SINGH ARORA, R/O-H.NO.A-103, PREET-VIHAR, DELHI-110092, have been lost. FIR has been Lodged in Police-Station, Preet Vihar, Delhi vide NCR No.1301/2012 Dated 24-07-2012. Finder infrom at: 9213117727. 0040869196-14

I, Rekha Chadha, W/o Late Shri Ved Prakash Mittal / W/o Shri Gurcharan Lal Chadha, R/o Flat No.C-103, Narwana Apartments, 89, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-110092, have been lost my all original documents...GPA, ATS, Receipt, Will Deed, Affidavit etc. of executed in favour by Shri Vijay Kumar Sharma, S/o Shri Roop Chand Sharma, on 28.02.1996, in respect of Shop No.3, measuring 9 ft. x 13 ft., forming part of Property No.F-42-A, Madhu Vihar, Delhi-110092. Finder Contact 7827673849 0040869071-1

I, Manoj Kumar Singh, S/o Subodh Prasad Singh, R/o Tower-12, Type-II, D-1, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110023, have lost my property documents ALL GPA AGREEMENT TO SELL, RECEIPT, WILL, NOTARY ATTESTED of Plot No.605, Gali No.12, L-1 Asthal Mandir, Budh Bazar, Sangam Vihar, Devli, Delhi-110080. Finder may contact 9990797567. 0040869065-1

I Ramesh Kumar Singhania, S/o Rahdev Shyam Singhania R/O F-59, Second Floor, Kirti Nagar, Delhi-110015 have lost my Original Lease Deed and other documents of Shop No-B-5, Hathhi Khana Azad Market Delhi. Finders may contact at above address. 0040869064-2

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is hereby given to public at large that my client Sh. Rajesh Kumar S/o Sh. Jay Manjari, S/o-B-99, Madipur Colony, Paschim Vihar, PO, Paschim Vihar, West Delhi-110063, has disowned his son and daughter in law, namely, Sh. Mayank Kishoreyia, S/o Sh. Rajesh Kumar (bearing Aadhaar No-) and Smt. Krishna W/o Sh. Mayank Kishoreyia Do. Leel Chandra (bearing Aadhaar 6136-2486-6890) respectively, from his all past, present and future, movable and immovable assets/properties that are, a) W-134 Jewala Puri PVT. Market Paschim Vihar, New Delhi 110087; b) C-1 Madipur Colony New Delhi 110087; c) J-30 PNC Market Titik Khand 110041, with immediate effect and has severed all his connection with them. Anybody dealing with them in any manner whatsoever is doing the same at his/her/his/their own risk and responsibility thereof and my client will not be responsible for any act, costs and things done by them. Sd/- Himanshu Anand Advocate Enrl. No. D0647/2020 S-42, Buthi Bazar Road, Gandhi Chowk Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, X-B-59

PUBLIC NOTICE

GURBACHAN SINGH ARORA, S/O-LATE SH JAGTAR SINGH ARORA, R/O H.NO A-103, PREET VIHAR, DELHI-110092, Registered Address: NAGAR OF APPLICANT CH-36185 under Rohini Residential Scheme-1981, had submitted FDR No- 07748 Dated-24/03/1981 Amounting to Rs-5000/- It is hereby informed that the aforesaid original FDR has been lodged/presented in this regard:- 1) NCR/FIR Lost Report No.1301/2012 Dated-24/07-2012 has been lodged at Police Station- Preet Vihar, 2) An Intermittent Bond has also been executed regarding the said FDR. If/ Anybody has any objection/Claim Regarding the aforesaid FDR or finds the same, kindly contact the undersigned within: 15 days from publication of this Notice. Mobile No: 92131 17727 Address: H.No. A-103, Preet Vihar, Delhi-110092

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my client, Mr. Sanjeev Kumar, S/o Sh. Rajveer, R/O C-969, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110062, disowned and debarred Mr. Sunny and Mr. Bhumiit, from his movable and immovable property due to irreconcilable differences, conduct of the sons and both are not in his control with effect from: 24.07.2026. It is further notified that neither my client nor his family members shall be responsible for any act, transaction, liability, or obligation incurred by them. Any person dealing with them shall do so at his or her own risk and consequences. Narendar Singh (Advocate) Ch. No. 258, Saket Court, New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC AT LARGE IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT MY CLIENT HAS A PREFERENTIAL RIGHT TO PURCHASE THE PROPERTY BEARING NO. B-133 MEASURING 62 SQ. YDS. FORMING PART OF KHARSA NO. 1359/292. MOHAMMED PUR AMIRKHA, NEW DELHI, WHICH IS PART OF ANCESTRAL PROPERTY OF MY CLIENT AND SMT. ASHA DEVI ON VARIOUS GROUNDS I.E. MUTUAL UNDERSTANDING AND COMMON ANCESTORSHIP AND ALSO ON ACCOUNT OF INTRINSIC SITUATION AND POSSESSION. ANYBODY DEALING IN RESPECT OF THE SAID PROPERTY SHALL BE DEEMED SO AT HIS/HER OWN RISK AND CONSEQUENCES. N.S. DALAL (ADVOCATE)

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public that my client, Smt. Murti Devi (aged about 75 years), W/o Shri Kamal Kishor Sharma, R/o H.No.1/3357A, Mandoli Road, MCD School Wali Gali, Ram Nagar Extension, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, had executed a Will Deed and General Power of Attorney (GPA) in respect of Property No. D-57, Gali No. 02, Ankur Enclave, Karawal Nagar, Delhi-110094 (Kharsa No. 6/14, 18, 19, 20, 20/1) in favour of her grandson, Shreshth Sharma (S/o Shri Yogesh Sharma) on 09/10/2024. My client has cancelled the said Will Deed and GPA on 18/05/2026. Therefore, her grandson Shreshth Sharma now has no right, title, interest, claim, or concern with the above-mentioned property. If any person or entity deals with Shreshth Sharma in relation to the above-said property, such deal/transaction shall be deemed illegal, null & void, and that person shall be solely responsible for the same, and my client shall not be liable in any manner. Pawan Chaudhary (Advocate) En. D-2236/2004

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients Sh. H. M. Malhotra and Smt. Manju Malhotra, resident of Flat No. 2504, Tulip Tower, 25th Floor, Gaur Saundaryam, Tech Zone-V, Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201009, have disowned/disbarred their son Sh. Varun Malhotra and his wife Smt. Rashi Malhotra from movable & immovable properties by all means and have served all relations to them, if any dealing to them by any one my clients shall not be responsible for the same in future.

NAVEEN KUMAR RAI (ADVOCATE) ENRL. No. 0/8676/2019 Ch. No.32, Supreme Court, New Delhi-01

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विरुध्द ...जाण देवार

गुल गोपालदास आणि इतर नोटीस देण्यात येते की, उपरोक्त अर्जदार यांनी इडियन सेक्शनर अंक्ट १९२९ कलम ३७२ / बांबे रेग्युलेशन अंक्ट १८२७ अन्वये या कोर्टाकडे ममत मूव् दिनांक २४/११/२०२४ यंचे हेअरशिप सर्टिफिकेट मिळयासेंबंधीचा अर्ज केलेला आहे.

ज्या कोणास सदहू अर्जसेंबंधी हरकत घ्यावयाची असेल त्यांनी नेमलेली तरीख ०५/८/२०२६ रोजी ठिक सकाळी ११.०० वाजता स्वतः किंवा वकिलांमार्फत या कोर्टात हजर राहावे. आज दिनांक २४/६/२०२६ रोजी माझे सही व शिक्क्यांमिशी दिला.

हुक्मान्वये अधिकार दिवाणी न्यायालय, पुणे

NOTICE

In the Court of Civil Judge, Junior Division (Additional), Cooch Behar, Title Suit No.53 of 1995

Plaintiffs: Sanchalal Bania and ors

VS

Defendants: Omprokash Agrahari and ors

NOTICE

It is hereby notified for general information that Sanchalal Bania and others have filed the above suit for declaration of Title, Rectification of Deed and Injunction regarding the below schedule property.

If you have any objection against the same you can file objection in the designated Court within 30 days from the date of publication of the notice. If no objection be made by that date, the suit will proceed ex parte against them.

Schedule (Sui property).

In District - Cooch Behar, P.S. Kotwali, Mouza - Sahar Cooch Behar, Thak No 914, R.S. Khatian No. 921, Total land 040 centimals at an annual rent of Rs. 30.44 paisa out of which 13/37th of the land is in P.S. Plot No. 4638, bounded by East- Ajodhya Prasad Agrahari, West- Municipal Road, South - Amritalal Bania and North - Hiratal Bania upon which Tin Shed structure covering the total area. Name of the Defendants - 1@ Smt. Sakuntala Devi, W/O Lalilal Gupta, 643/1 Triveni Road, Infront of Kudganj Police Station, Kudganj, Dist. Allahabad (U.P.) 1 (d) Smt. Sushila Devi, W/O Shiv Prosad Agrahari, Mejargang Chauraha, P.O. & Dist. Sultanpur (U.P.) 1(e) Smt. Ashokata Devi, W/O Shiv Prasad Agrahari, Joona Vegetable Market, Dishalwa Road, Dadar, Mumbai. 1(f) Smt. Hemlata Devi, W/O Raj Kumar Baisya, C/O Rajkumar Radheshyam Baisya, Gala No E 883, Dharambir Samjeeve Vegetable Market, Sector-19, Torba, New Mumbai. 3(a) Smt. Trnpi Paul, W/O late Dilip Kumar Paul, 3(b) Debarati Paul, 3(c) Debolina Paul, 3(d) Didipati Paul, No 3(b) to 3(d) are daughter of Late Dilip Kumar Paul, All of Raj Rajendra Narayan Road, P.S. Kotwali, P.O. & Dist. Cooch Behar(WB) 8. Smt. Girza Devi Bania, W/O Subhash Chandra Gupta , Distributor of Acid and Distilled Water, P.O. & Vill. Hanskhara, Dist. lucknow, Uttar Pradesh. 10. Smt. Malvi Devi Bania, W/O Sri Dinesh Agrahari, 977/523 Uchwargah near Blood Bank, Rajapur, Allahabad , Uttar Pradesh. 12. Smt. Jyoti Agrahari, W/O Rakesh Kumar Gupta , Mohalla Rani Baag, P.O. Bunkimganj, Dist. Mirzapur, Uttar Pradesh. 13. Smt. Roshni Agrahari, W/O Sangamial Agrahari, Muthiganj, Allahabad, Uttar Pradesh.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT No 07/2026-27)

Online tenders are hereby invited on behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan for the following works from bidders meeting eligibility as per criteria mentioned in detailed tender document which can be seen and downloaded from website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.rajinic.in>. The tenders are to be submitted online in electronic format on website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> as per schedule given below:

S. No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs in Lacs)	Bid Security @2% (Rs)	Last date of Submission of tender	Due date for opening
07/2026-27	Providing, laying, Jointing & Testing of 250mm DI K7 Pipeline 2300M, 150mm DI K7 RM Pipeline 500M. & 100MM DI K7 Distribution Pipeline 2500M With Construction of OHSR 200 KL, CWR 600KL & Pump House 20 SQM With Pumping Machinery and Other Associated Works for New Medical College Near Kayad Pushkar By Pass Under Deposit Works Ajmer.	332.03	6,64,065	17-08-2026	18-08-2026

The tender shall be received online and opened in the office of Superintending Engineer, PHED, City Circle Ajmer. The cost of each tender document is Rs 5,000/- (Rs Five Thousand only) by depositing through e-Challan at e-grass System. RISL processing charges of Rs 2000/- (Rs Two Thousand only) for each NITand Bid securities mentioned above shall be deposited through e-Challan at e-grass System as described in detailed NIT in tender Document and uploaded online on designated website above. This tender notification and other details can also be seen in NIT exhibited on web site <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.rajinic.in> from dated 27-07-2026

Nit No.	SPP ID No.	UBN No.
07/2026-27	PHE2627A1561	PHE2627WSOBO3053

Sd/- Superintending Engineer, PHED, City Circle Ajmer

DP/RC/13223/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mohd. Nihal Hassan, S/o Mohd. Noor Hasan R/o H.No.D-52, Sarai Kale Khan, Nagli, Razapur, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.58/2024 Dated 14.03.2024 u/s 129/55 G. Act, P.S. New Friends Colony, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mohd. Nihal Hassan cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mohd. Nihal Hassan has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mohd. Nihal Hassan of FIR No.58/2024 Dated 14.03.2024 u/s 129/55 G. Act, P.S. New Friends Colony, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.08.2026.

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
South East, Room No. 515
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/10547/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Amar Chand @ Pappu S/o Ved Ram R/o H.No. 213, Gali No. 1 Tomar Colony, Bhagwali Gali, Vill. Khera Garh, PS & Dist.: Agra, UP, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 212/2013 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC., has been registered at PS: Jahangirpuri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Amar Chand @ Pappu cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Amar Chand @ Pappu has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Amar Chand @ Pappu under FIR No. 212/2013 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC., registered at PS: Jahangirpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.09.2026.

By Order
Sahil Gupta
JMFC-07 (North), Room No. 06
Ground Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10310/NW/2026 (Court Notice)

SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LTD. e-Procurement Tender Notice (Paper Notification)

TGSPDCL intends to float tender for Supply, Operating and Maintenance of Automatic Meter Reading System for "LT Services with HT Metering" Energy Meters under TOTEX model in 21 circles covering in TGSPDCL in Telangana state on e-procurement platform.

For further details of above, please visit <https://www.tgssouthernpower.org> and <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> Phone: 040-23431321

Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER (PROJECTS)
DIPR R.O. No. : 364-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt: 30-07-2026 TGSPDCL, Hyderabad.

राजस्थान आवासन मण्डल

क्रमांक :- 117 दिनांक :- 30/07/2026

संशोधित ईपीसी निविदा सूचना संख्या: 09/2025-26

इस कार्यालय द्वारा जारी ईपीसी निविदा सूचना संख्या 09/2025-26 में संशोधन उपरान्त बिड़ प्रमज डाननलीड व अपलोड करने की अन्तिम तिथि 07.08.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक, मूल प्रमज कार्यालय में जमा करने की तिथि 10.08.2026 सायं 4.00 बजे तक, तकनीकी बिड़ खोलने की तिथि 12.08.2026 अपरान्ह 3.00 बजे एवं वित्तीय बिड़ खोलने की तिथि 25.08. 2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे रहेगी। अन्य शर्तें मूल बिड़ अनुसार यथावत रहेगी।

राज.संवाद/सी/26/8101 अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता-नृत्तीन, जयपुर

वेमता जिबाब टेक्नोलॉजिकल इंस्टीट्यूट (VJTI) Matunga, Mumbai – 400019

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

Tenders are invited from contractors/firms with relevant experience for the work "Providing and maintaining temporary barricading along the boundary of M P A Complex". The tender document & information is available on www.vjti.ac.in and <http://mahatenders.gov.in>

Last date for submission of Tender is 14th August 2026 by 5.00 pm Sd/- Registrar, VJTI, Matunga, Mumbai.19

Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation Limited

No.: RCOF/F1/Admn/Contract employee/2026/19162 Dated :- 27/07/2026

TENDER/BID NOTICE

RCDF invites tender/Bid online from the eligible agencies for providing the services of service points on job basis (Rate Contract) as mentioned below on outsourcing basis. The last date & time for submission of bid is 17.08.2026 upto 11.00 AM Technical bid will be opened on dated 17.08.2026 at 11.00 AM Relevant tender/Bid document containing detailed terms and conditions can be down loaded from the website i.e. <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> (Tender ID 2026, 57823, 1) [www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in](http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in) (UBN: CDF2627SLOBO00676) www.saramsilkfed.rajasthan.org.

Category	Total Service Point cost (In Rs.)	Bid Security (In Rs.)	Tender/Bid Processing cost including GST (in Rs.)	Tender/ Bid Processing Fees (Payable to MCD, RISL)	Tender Period
Service points	8.5 Crore	17.00 lakh	2950	2500	Two Year

Raj.Samwad/C-26/8007 GENERAL MANAGER (P&A) जिला जी मी रे-कमल पवार

Civil Surgeon Panipat

सिविल सर्जन पानीपत

Old Bus stand GT Road Panipat E-mail dhs.cspnp@hry.nic.in Dated:- 30.07.2026

No. NTEP/2026/446

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is for the information of all concerned that Advt. No. NTEP/PNP/2025-26/4768-69 Dated 05/08/2025 stands hereby withdrawn due to administrative reasons.

Sd/- Civil Surgeon Panipat

No. 47676/HR/Y

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PHED CITY

CIRCLE AJMER

LOHA KHAN TEMPO STAND, AJMER

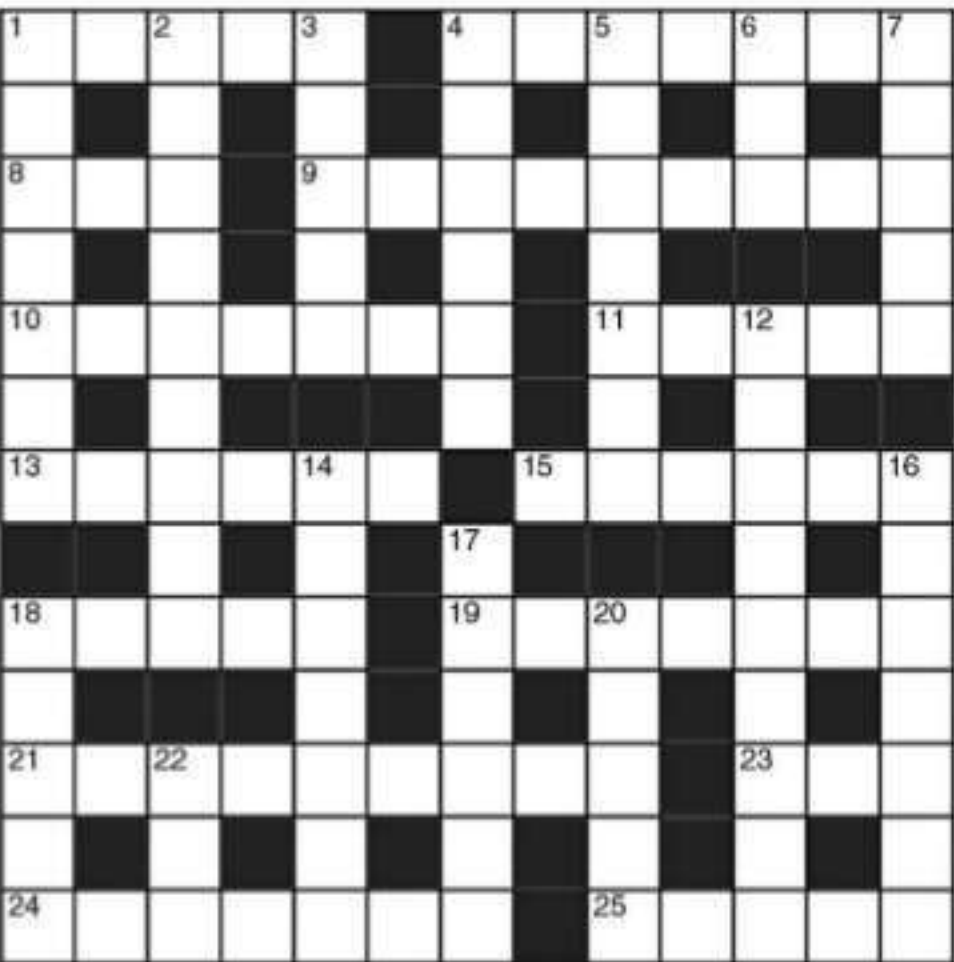
Telephone No 145-2970165 E-mail address: eamjer@gmail.com

S.No.: SE/Ajmer/City Circle/ Ar-City I/2026-27/4232-234 Date:- 27.7.26

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT No 07/2026-27)

Online tenders are hereby invited on behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan for the following works from bidders meeting eligibility as per criteria mentioned in detailed tender document which can be seen and downloaded from website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Act gladly for an audience (5)
4 Involves a silent order (7)
8 Objective I am out to get (3)
9 Not a game for sea horses (5,4)
10 The French mark all dice differently (7)
11 Is a girl's name for a child (5)
13 Performs a new ascent (6)
15 Time conceals a deserter's mistakes (6)
18 Legal acts? (5)
19 Turn round to become booming (7)
21 Overlooking a number inside working as blacksmiths (9)
23 Have to be won round (3)
24 Trickery of the French in a sense (7)
25 It's the herb season we hear (5)

DOWN
1 She's presumably met her match (7)
2 I'm to intercede without delay (9)
3 Sounds like a strange letter in the post (5)
4 Sex and art production films use them (6)
5 Row about stray dog (7)
6 Bio-chemistry for a Nigerian tribesman (3)
7 A number achieve success (5)
12 Remain outside a coach as required by law (9)
14 An oral test (7)
16 A go-slow which could be at an end (7)
17 Vote is for former Russian government (6)
18 Removes part of diseased offshoot (5)
20 Should prove uncommonly tough (5)
22 Regret moving on from Rouen (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6054 **ACROSS:** 1 Headmaster, 8 Basic, 9 Flutter, 10 Apostle, 11 Stoic, 12 Kaftan, 14 Adored, 17 Puffs, 19 Elector, 21 Control, 22 Flies, 23 Easy manner **DOWN:** 2 Ease off, 3 Ducat, 4 Alfred, 5 Trussed, 6 Ratio, 7 Procedures, 8 Blank space, 13 Asserts, 15 Ratline, 16 Bedlam, 18 Fence, 20 Elfin

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The opposite of talking isn't listening. The opposite of talking is ____ - Fran Lebowitz (7)

CGMAI

TOPIS

RANGER

ELLNUW

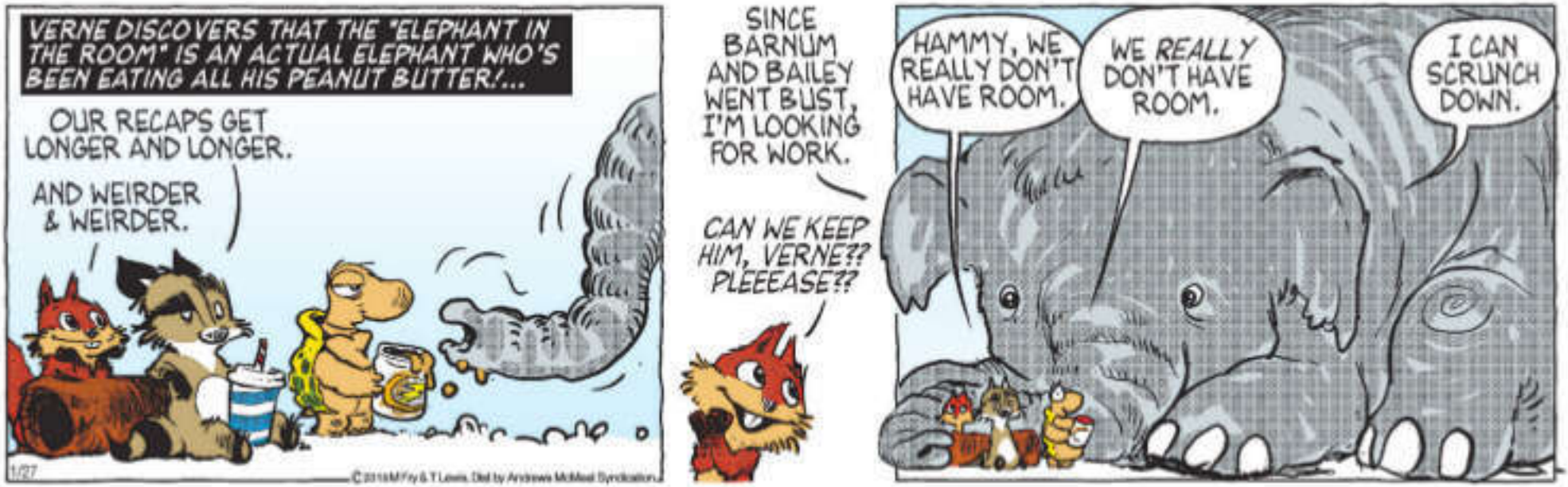
Waiting - Fran Lebowitz

ANSWER: The opposite of talking isn't listening. The opposite of talking is

SOLUTIONS: Magic, Post, Gamer, Unwell

6055

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6396

			8					2
4			6			5		3
		5	1			6		
	5	1						9
8								4
9						3	7	
		4			7	9		
7		9			3			6
	1				6			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6395

8	7	5	4	1	2	3	6	9
2	4	3	7	9	6	8	1	5
1	9	6	3	8	5	7	4	2
4	2	7	1	5	9	6	3	8
5	3	9	6	7	8	1	2	4
6	8	1	2	3	4	9	5	7
3	6	8	5	2	7	4	9	1
7	5	4	9	6	1	2	8	3
9	1	2	8	4	3	5	7	6

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This might be a restless day for you. You have options to socialise and have fun. You're full of different ideas today, which might create detours and surprises for you. Tonight: Enjoy your privacy.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a lovely day to socialise. A friend or a member of a group might do something that catches you off guard. You might meet a real character today. Tonight: Be friendly.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Tread carefully around authority figures today because something unexpected could happen. To be on the safe side, give authority figures a wide berth. Relations with relatives, siblings and neighbours are rewarding. Tonight: You're admired.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Sudden opportunities to travel might fall in your lap today. Planned schedules and itineraries might suddenly change at the last minute. Double-check all details to avoid unnecessary disappointments and glitches. Tonight: Explore and learn.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Make friends with your bank account, because something related to shared property, inheritances and the resources you share with others might be subject to a sudden change today. Tonight: Check your finances.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Be prepared for something unexpected from a partner, spouse or close friend today. For some, this could relate to a parent or another authority figure. Basically, something unusual or a bit out of the ordinary might occur. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Equipment breakdowns and technological glitches today might impact your work or even your health. Pet owners should be extra vigilant. Give yourself extra time so you have wiggle room for the unexpected. Tonight: Work efficiently.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Social plans are unpredictable today. You might receive an unexpected invitation. Or a planned event might be cancelled or changed. Parents should be vigilant to avoid accidents with their kids. Tonight: Socialise with others.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Your home routine might be interrupted today. Small appliances might break down. Someone unexpected might appear at your door. Take a breath and cope with whatever is happening. It's nothing you can't handle. Tonight: Relax at home.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is a mildly accident-prone day for you. Be mindful and aware when walking, jogging or driving. On the upside, you might have some clever, genius-like ideas. It's easy for you to think outside the box. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Do whatever you can to protect your belongings from loss, theft and damage today. You might either find some money or lose some. Tonight: Check your money and possessions.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today, you might feel rebellious. Certainly, you want to be free to do your own thing. You have a strong craving for excitement and adventure, which means there's a strong likelihood that's precisely what you will find! Tonight: You win.



provides a framework for collaboration under which EIL will offer its engineering, technical advisory, project management, and consultancy services to DGMA for the planning, development, modernization, and implementation of projects in the maritime sector. The scope of cooperation includes feasibility studies, infrastructure planning, technology integration, capacity enhancement, and other specialized technical services as may be mutually identified.

REC REC sustained a healthy NIM of 3.34%, reflecting the strength of its lending portfolio & disciplined financial management. Consequently, the company delivered an annualised EPS of ₹63.04 per share for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, underscoring its robust earnings performance. REC's standalone loan book stood at ₹5.90 lakh crore as on June 30, 2026 which is the largest for any CPSE-NBFC in India, demonstrating the strength and stability of its lending operation. The net worth has grown by 15% on Y-O-Y basis to ₹91,836 crore as on June 30, 2026. Driven by sustained initiatives to improve asset quality, the Company has reduced its Stage-3 loan asset to the total loan portfolio ratio to near-zero levels i.e., 0.11%.



Karan, Principal Chief Commissioner of Income Tax, UP & Uttarakhand in the presence of Sunita Singh, Principal Commissioner of Income Tax, Dehradun. This recognition reflects UGB's unwavering commitment to transparency, regulatory compliance, & excellence in public service.



University. The Convocation was graced by Atul Garg, Chancellor, KIET University & Member of Parliament from Ghaziabad; Prof. Nagaraj Ramrao, VC, KIET University & other officials. Presenting the annual report, Prof. Ramrao highlighted KIET's evolution into a multidisciplinary deemed-to-be university driven by academic excellence, research, innovation, entrepreneurship & engagement.

HUDCO has continued its strong growth trajectory in the first quarter of FY 2026-27. The board of directors of HUDCO, approved the financial results for the quarter ended on 30th June 2026. This reflected robust business growth, record operational performance and continued improvement in asset quality. Sanjay Kulshrestha, Chairman & MD, HUDCO, stated that the company has commenced FY 2026-27 with exceptional financial & operational performance reflecting the strength of its diversified lending portfolio, prudent financial management and sustained focus on infrastructure financing. With a strong opening quarter continued reduction in NPA, healthy balance sheet, robust asset quality & sustained profitability, HUDCO remains well-positioned to maintain its growth momentum during FY 2026-27.

BOOK LAUNCH Delhi-based entrepreneur, angel investor & author Gagan Dhawan has announced his second book, The New Me 2.0, slated for release later this year. A sequel to his award-winning 2022 debut, the book explores sustainable lifestyle transformation through the WISE Framework—Water, Intent, Sleep and Eating. Emphasising practical systems over motivation, Dhawan advocates preventive health by focusing on achievable daily habits, quality sleep, mindful eating and hydration to help readers build lasting well-being.

EIL EIL and EPC under the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, GOI, have signed a MoU with the DGMA. The MoU

CORPORATE BRIEFS



YASODHA MEDICITY Dr. Upasana Arora, MD, Yashoda Medicity & Chair, FICCI Medical Value Travel Committee, represented India's healthcare sector at the Business Forum România-India, a high-level bilateral forum held as part of the State Visit of the Hon. President of India to Romania. The forum highlighted the growing role of healthcare & medical value travel in strengthening India-Romania bilateral cooperation. With Romania's strategic position as a gateway to the European market & India's rapidly growing economy, discussions focused on opportunities for partnerships, knowledge exchange, & sustainable economic growth. The event was attended by H.E. Mr. Nicusor Dan, President of Romania, Hon. President of India, Droupadi Murmu, along with senior government officials, industry leaders, and business representatives from both countries.



PNB Government of Andhra Pradesh & PNB signed a MoU for the establishment of the PNB Quantum Finance Hub at AQV. The MoU was exchanged in the presence of Hon. CM of Andhra Pradesh, N. Chandrababu Naidu, & Ashok Chandra, MD & CEO, PNB. The MoU aims to foster innovation, research, talent development, & the adoption of next-generation technologies in India's banking & financial services sector.



SCOPE SCOPE & GIZ, Germany organised an interactive workshop with the MoEFCC, on India & Sweden partnership to encourage industrial decarbonisation through LeadIT. The workshop was addressed by senior officials from MoEFCC, GIZ, BEL & Volvo and brought together 40 senior officials from various PSEs. The event also entailed industrial insight into the net zero pathway of BEL and its sustainability & renewable energy initiatives while also reflecting on the technological pathways for decarbonization in the transport sector by Volvo. A major highlight of the workshop was Sustainability Exchange Visit at BEL.



The chief guest, Dr. Tripta, Hon. VC, Uttarakhand Technical University addressed the gathering and congratulated the newly admitted students on choosing hospitality as a career.

CONCOR recently organised CONCOR CONNECT 2026 – Dadri. The trade meet was held at The Address by Red Carpet, Greater Noida, bringing together exporters, importers, shipping lines, freight forwarders, CHAs, logistics partners & other stakeholders from the trade & logistics fraternity to strengthen customer engagement & understand evolving logistics requirements. The event was graced by Sanjay Swarup, Chairman & MD, CONCOR, as Chief Guest, Ajit Kumar Panda (Director, Projects & Services), Vijoy Kumar Singh (Director, International Marketing & Operations), Alok Kumar Singh, Commissioner, Customs, Noida Commissionerate & other officials. The session opened with a welcome address by Ritu Sharma, Cluster Head, TKD Cluster followed by an interactive session with trade representatives where MMLP Dadri's expanding portfolio of value-added services have been apprised. The interactive session witnessed valuable discussions with industry stakeholders on enhancing logistics efficiency, reducing supply chain costs and expanding multimodal connectivity.

NTPC NTPC Ltd, has announced its unaudited financial results for the first quarter ended on 30th June, reporting a strong performance driven by operational gains & continuing growth. They reported a total income of Rs 44,512 crore for Q1 FY27, registering a 3% increase as compared to Q1 FY26. PAT for Q1 FY27 rose to Rs 5,342 crore up from ₹4,775 crore for Q1 FY26. On a consolidated basis, NTPC Group's PAT for Q1 FY27 rose by 13% to ₹6,896 crore from ₹6,108 for Q1 FY26. The strong performance was bolstered by a 62% increase in the profit from group companies, which reached Rs 1,832 crore in Q1 FY27 from Rs 1,131 crore in Q1 FY26.

CCPA Digital insurance platforms have played a transformative role in expanding insurance awareness & penetration across India by making policies easier to compare, understand and purchase. Requiring a mobile number before displaying a personalised quote is a long-standing, transparent and regulator-supervised industry practice, not a deceptive design or "dark pattern" under the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) Guidelines, 2023. The mobile number enables personalised pricing, saves quotes, supports follow-ups, reduces policy abandonment, prevents fraud and ensures price continuity. Similar identity-first practices exist across insurance markets globally and in India's financial and digital ecosystems. Classifying this practice as a dark pattern would weaken digital distribution, increase acquisition costs, raise premiums, reduce consumer access and undermine investor confidence. The focus should remain on eliminating genuine deceptive practices, not consumer identification.

NHPC The rescue operation at the under construction Head Race Tunnel of NHPC's Teesta Stage - VI Hydroelectric Project in Sikkim has been concluded with the recovery of bodies of 25 personnel trapped inside the tunnel. The rescue operation was carried out with the coordinated support of the District administration, NDRF, SDRF, Ministry of Power, Ministry of Home Affairs, Ministry of Defence, Patel Engineering Limited, Eastern Coalfields Limited & many more. NHPC's Top Management remained present at the project site throughout the rescue operation for closely monitoring and coordinating with all the agencies involved.

SAIL The company reported a strong profitability in Q1FY27, with net profit rising by over 138% compared to the corresponding period last year. During Q1FY27, SAIL moderate volumes compared to CPLY by advancing certain scheduled repairs & maintenance during the quarter. Commenting on this, Chairperson & MD, SAIL, Dr. Ashok Kumar Panda said, "SAIL, through enhanced operational efficiencies, prudent cost management and focused marketing initiatives, has delivered a significantly profitable first quarter in FY27".

INDIA
watch

ATHLETICS

Men's Decathlon 110m hurdles: Tejaswin Shankar **2:35 pm**
Men's Decathlon discus throw: Tejaswin Shankar **3:20 pm**
Men's Decathlon pole vault: Tejaswin Shankar **5 pm**
Men's Decathlon 1500m: Tejaswin Shankar **1:05 am**
Mixed 4x400m Relay Round 1: Rajesh Ramesh, Vishal TK, Ansa Babu, Neeru Pathak, Rashdeep Kaur **4:05 pm**
Men's javelin throw final (medal event): Yash Vir Singh, Neeraj Chopra, Rohit Yadav **12:45 am (Saturday)**
Men's 400m hurdles final (medal event): Yashas Palaksha, Santhosh Tamilarasan **1:30 am (Saturday)**

BOXING

Women's 54kg semifinal: Preeti Pawar vs Catherine Mwape (Zambia) **3:15 pm**
Men's 80kg semifinal: Ankush Panghal vs Joshua Ofori (Canada) **4:30 pm**
Women's 57kg semifinal: Jaismine Lamboria vs Rapelang Maselela (Lesotho) **7:15 pm**
Women's 70kg semifinal: Arundhati Choudhary vs Rosie Eccles (Wales) **7:30 pm**
Men's 55kg semifinal: Jadumani Singh vs Philip Pumulo Mutakela Haoseb (Namibia) **8:15 pm**
Women's 51kg semifinal: Sakshi Choudhary vs Amber-Jane Wall (Canada) **11:30 pm**
Women's 75kg semifinal: Lovlina Borgohain vs Taronah Khanum Badi Pasoni Taafaki (Tuvalu) **12:45 am (Saturday)**
Men's 60kg semifinal: Sachin Siwach vs Owain Harris-Allan (Wales) **1:15 am (Saturday)**
Men's 90+kg semifinal: Narendra Berwal vs Nigel Paul (Trinidad and Tobago) **1:30 am (Saturday)**

CYCLING

Men's 4000m Individual Pursuit Qualifying: Dinesh Kumar, Harshveer Singh Sekhon **4:59 pm**
Men's Team Sprint Finals (Gold): Team India (David Beckham Elkatochoongo, Jemsh Singh Keithellakpam, Ronaldo Singh Laitonjam) (subject to qualification) **10:55 pm**

LAWN BOWLS

Men's pairs sectional play: Navneet Singh & Dinesh Kumar vs Ian Barnes & Oliver Thompson (Falkland Islands) **5:15 pm**
Women's singles sectional play: Nayanmoni Saikia vs Mildred Mkandawire (Zambia) **10:20 pm**

• BOXING WITH LINEAGE

Amin's grandson disqualified after headbutting opponent

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 30

SUCCESSSTORIES and tales of hardship are part of sport. The most extraordinary story at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games involved neither. Instead, it involved a headbutt, an angry tirade and a surname that still divides a nation.

In the quarterfinal of men's 90+ kg boxing, Ugandan boxer Aziz Abdul was disqualified for headbutting his opponent, England's Damar Thomas. As if Zinedine Zidane had descended at the SEC Centre.

Then came the outburst.

"I'm a black African, I know. It's God's plan," Aziz declared. Then alleged, "There was a lot of b*****r. Holding, elbowing. When other countries do this, they are disqualified. They decided the winner before the fight."

When a Press Association reporter attempted a question, Aziz cut him off.

"Not you. I don't like you." His explanation was startling; the journalist had written unfavourably about his grandfather.

The report in question stated his grandfather had killed half a million people. The grandfather being Idi Amin: A former Ugandan dictator in the 1970s.

Coach in film on Amin

Samuel Kabugo's dreams were modest in 2005. Winning a boxing competition, for instance. That he would feature in a Hollywood film, sharing screen with Forest Whitaker, was beyond his wildest imagination. Until director Kevin Macdonald arrived in Uganda.

While filming The Last King of Scotland, based on Amin's life, Macdonald needed real boxers to recreate the former president's years in the ring. Kabugo became one of them.

Two decades later, the past returned.

Now head coach of Uganda's boxing team and owner of Kololo Boxing Club, Kabugo met a towering teenager brought in by his elder brother Habib.

"Before boxing, Aziz had been doing martial arts and taekwondo. His elder brother Habib brought him to me and said, 'Coach, my younger brother wants to try boxing. He's a big, powerful boy.' He joined around June 2023. I didn't know about his family background when Aziz joined me. One day, Habib told me, 'Coach, do you know about our family? We are the grandsons of Idi Amin.' I was shocked," Kabugo tells The Indian Express from Uganda.

In Glasgow, Aziz surprised



Aziz Abdul (left) headbutted England's Damar Thomas. REUTERS

many by declaring himself proud of his grandfather. He later clarified that his admiration stemmed not from Amin's presidential rule, but from his boxing achievements.

"Idi Amin is one of the reasons why Aziz switched to boxing. He was inspired by his grandfather. Aziz is proud of his lineage. He didn't choose his family or the history attached to it, but he doesn't run away from it either," says Kabugo.

After disqualification, Aziz alleged the judges could not stand a black African beating a European. Decades ago, Amin had voiced similar feelings.

"Several of Aziz's victories have come by knockouts. He

loves nothing more than knocking his opponents out. There is an interesting story behind this. When Ugandan boxers complained about unfair judging at international tournaments, Amin told them, 'Don't leave it to the judges. Knock your opponents out.' In a way, Aziz is following that path," Kabugo said.

Aziz's Commonwealth Games debut was not remarkable, but his journey has been.

"Aziz is an exceptionally quick learner. It took him just four months to get into the National Championships, and only one year to win the National Boxing League. With only three years of training, he

“At times, the family history weighs on him. Even today, there are so many stories about the darker chapters of Idi Amin. The killings, the dictatorship and everything else from that period”

SAMUEL KABUGO, BOXER
AZIZ ABDUL'S COACH

is at the Commonwealth Games," his coach said.

Yet, having publicly voiced his desire to be the new 'King of Scotland' before the fight, as his grandfather once did, a disqualification for headbutting is rather unceremonious.

"Aziz has always been incredibly confident. He has the heart of a lion. He never backs down from anyone and never walks into a fight intimidated by an opponent. He also likes to speak his heart out. On most occasions, he backs his words with his punches. But at times, it goes awry," Kabugo said.

On Wednesday, it most certainly did.

Weighed by history
Uganda has taken a 55-

In cold and windy Glasgow, Chopra & Co qualify for final

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, July 30

IN A low 80s qualification of the javelin at the Commonwealth Games 2026, India packed in 1/4th of the 12-man final, led by Neeraj Chopra's 79.61 metres on 5th place. Rohit Yadav (78.37) on 10th place and Yash Vir Singh (78.36) on 11th, made it 3 Indians for the Friday finale.

Chopra improved on his first 76.28 to sit on fifth at 79.61m. A CWG champion from 2018, a harbinger of his Olympic gold, Chopra is returning from injury this time. He had missed the 2022 edition because of injury.

Chopra told the Olympic channel and other media, "I'm happy I'm in final. That was goal for final. Throw was ok. The goal is to go in final and give my best there."

India's greatest athlete would elaborate on conditions, "Conditions were not best for javelin throwers. Not only cold but windy. And wind also not from front. It's very hard to process. But sometimes I thought I'll throw there but wind would come from other side. Loads of throwers struggled. Nobody threw automatic qualification," he said.

Chopra sounded upbeat saying, "Happy all three Indians are in final."

Biggest threat

On his biggest threat Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage of Sri Lanka, Chopra said, "He is a good boy. He is a friend of mine. This year he really threw well. It's good he's doing something great for Sri Lanka." The last three CWG champions have gone on to win a gold or silver medal at the next Olympics.

Pathirage led the 18-man field with a strong first throw of 82.84m, as the windy conditions were completely treacherous for the throwers, with crosswinds rummaging the spear flights on Thursday morning. A 13 kph west-blowing gust ensured the basic Qualification mark of 84 metres wasn't cleared even once by a group that boasted the last two Olympic champions and assorted other World winners.

Yego exits

It meant that the likes of former world champion Julius Yego and the second best from Pakistan and Sri Lanka — Muhammad Yasir and Sumedha Ranasinghe — didn't make the cut.

2025 world champion Keshorn Walcott, a former Olympic champion from Trinidad Tobago, snuck in by a thread



Neeraj Chopra's best throw of 79.61 metres put him in fifth place. AP

“Conditions were not best for javelin throwers. Not only cold but windy. And wind also not from front. It's hard to process... Loads of throwers struggled. Nobody threw automatic qualification”

NEERAJ CHOPRA, AFTER ADVANCING TO JAVELIN FINAL

• Other results

Women's Shot Put: Manpreet Kaur finished fourth with a best throw of 17.49m.

Women's 3000m SC: Parul Chaudhary finished fifth with a timing of 9:26.75.

Men's triple jump Qualification: Praveen Chithravel and Selva Prabhu booked their berths for the final with best jumps 16.41 and 16.26m.

Men's Decathlon: Tejaswin Shankar is placed fifth after three events with 2258 points. He registered a personal best in long jump with 7.82m.

in 12th place, with 78.26m — as six of the last 12 were bunched between that and 78.91m.

Arshad Nadeem of Pakistan first throw of 78.63m ended up being the best. He remains a contender alongside Anderson Peters who tweaked his run-up to hurl from the edge of the kerb for 81.29 on his second.

Qualification distances don't matter beyond sealing a spot in the finals. But they give the competitors an accurate idea of what conditions could be like.

The finals though happen in evenings, and winds can easily blow the other way in those parts at Scotstoun. A 14 degree crisp morning, how-

ever, ensured warmups in cold, biting Glasgow.

South African Douw Smit (80.64) qualified a surprising third, and Englishman Ben East brought in a late third throw of 80.38, to become one of only 4 to cross 80 metres.

Smit who had finished runners up to Chopra at the Ostrava Golden Spike in 2025, has a season best of 84.57 from a Poland win at Irena Szewinska Memorial this May. The 27-year-old Saffer was a prodigy brought down by a 5-year-long back injury layoff he returned from in 2021. "I thought I would never throw again. But coach said let's check. I was done with studies. But I threw 81 so went ahead," he had told *Modern Athlete Mag* in 2023.

East had thrown above 80 only twice before this.

Walcott has been struggling with a side slip at release the whole of this year, but can never be ruled out. He has a mark of 82.52 at Rabat and 83.45 at Rome.

"No clean hits, but the feeling is there," he had posted back in June. The reigning World Champion, who won the 2012 Olympics with two fractures in his back (L1 and L3) and has framed his backbrace, edged in last moment thanks to Keyshawn Strachan bringing out a 78.60, remains a contender.

The 6-ft-5 Strachan from Bahamas has never crossed 80. But he boasts of breaking Peter's World U20 record.

But the biggest threat remains Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage, the season sensation from Kalutara, south of Colombo. His Rome Diamond League mark of 92.62 looms large on the field, but clearly the challenge will be the conditions in Glasgow.

2026 is led by the Sri Lankan, followed by American Curtis Thompson and then Rohit Yadav (87.05), who showed good adaptability to go from 77.04 to 78.37, but 80 was Glasgow's 90 on a challenging Q day.

Le Clos sets new record with 21st Games medal

Reuters
Glasgow, July 30

VETERAN SOUTH African swimmer Chad Le Clos won a 21st Commonwealth Games medal late on Wednesday to overtake Australia's Emma McKeon as the most decorated athlete in the Games' history. The 34-year-old swam the butterfly leg as South Africa took bronze in the men's 4x100 medley relay for his third of the 2026 Games after silver in the mixed 4x100 medley and bronze in the men's 4x100 freestyle relay.

His record tally is made up of seven golds, five silvers and nine bronzes across the last five Games, starting in Delhi in 2010 at the age of 18 where he earned five medals, and then followed by seven medals in Glasgow in 2014.

He continued with five more on the Gold Coast in 2018 and one in Birmingham four years ago.

"It was emotional, but I think those first two medals (in Glasgow 2026) were just a little bit more just because I had to get over the hump and tonight I just had to stay cool and bring it home," he said after Wednesday's relay.

"The way the boys and girls swam...they swam their hearts



out. They kept saying 'we're doing this for Chad' before they walked down and it just means the world to me."

Le Clos is also an Olympic champion. He stunned the sporting world when he pipped Michael Phelps by 0.05 seconds to win the 200m butterfly gold at the 2012 London Games.

At the time, American icon Phelps was a 14-time Olympic champion and he had not lost in the event since 2001.

Le Clos won medals at the Olympics in Rio in 2016 and has since competed in Tokyo and Paris. He has previously said he hopes to qualify for his fifth Olympics in Los Angeles in two years' time.

